

The Teacher Game
for the North Central High School
Bicentennial Class of 1976

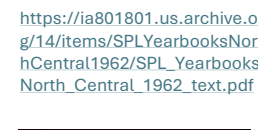
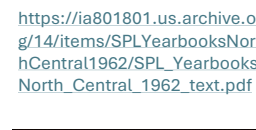
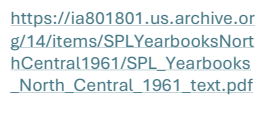
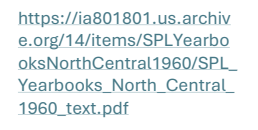
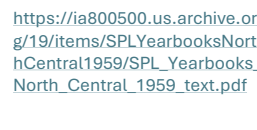
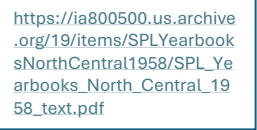
Bill Worstell

July 4, 2026

Table of Contents (Slides by Number)

- [1-12] Introduction – Links to all NC Tamaracks from 1976 and earlier, and some Spokane School District 81 history and context for NC.
- [13-118] Twenty Tributes to 20 Teachers whom I happened to remember and for whom I went through the Tamaracks from when they got there to our class in 1976 and cut and pasted any photos I found of them into a scrapbook. This is straightforward given the above links, and I used just a Windows Snipping Tool and PowerPoint to make the slides I then saved as pdfs and posted.]
 - The first slide in a sequence associated with a game where you try to remember the teacher’s name when given a fact you may not have known about them. This shows the Tamarack for the year this member of the set of 20 teachers joined the team at NC.
 - The next slide asks a question and reveals a perhaps unexpected fact about this teacher
 - The following slide shows a time series of photographs of this teacher from when they joined NC to 1976.
 - At this point I searched for obituaries and other public records and included them on a bio slide, using ChatGPT to assist with the search and recording pertinent links it found and its opinions.
 - Sometimes I included a personal anecdote from my memories of this teacher and the context.
- [119-123] Introduction and Links to Tamaracks from later than 1977
- [124-156] As for 1976 and earlier, I went through and cut and pasted photos from teachers among my chosen 20 who were still at NC by that year.
- [157-166] Sorted lists by Year of Birth, First Year at NC, Age at First Year at NC, Last Year at NC, Age at Last Year at NC, Year of Death, Age at Death, Years at NC, and Department, all of which I input into an EXCEL workbook as a sortable database.
- [167-200] I used the above database and photographs to make 20 single-slide Timeline and Summary slides with links where available. A similar procedure will work for any of our teachers beyond these 20, and we can collect and distribute such if we like – perhaps the Alumni association or our Class leaders can help us to collect and distribute contributions from those interested.
- [201-207] Red and Black as a new song, and some slightly dated humor from the 1912 Tamarack

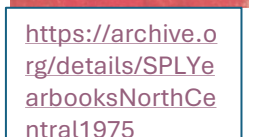
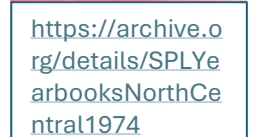
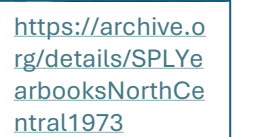
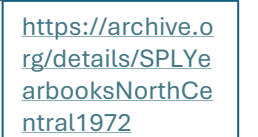
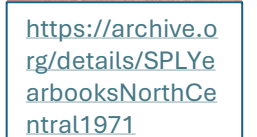
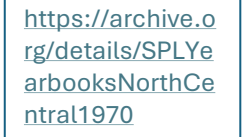
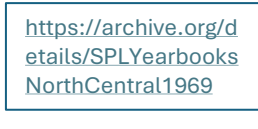
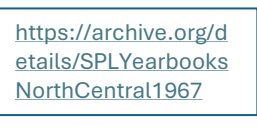
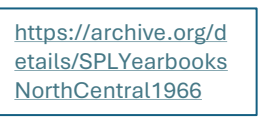
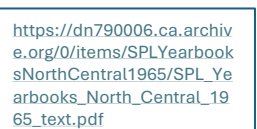
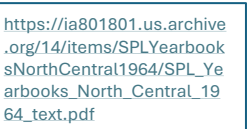
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		K	1964	53	1971	104
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1955	28	6	1970	89		
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2000	201					



tamarack

A stylized illustration on a dark blue background. On the left, a man and a woman are walking towards the viewer. The man is wearing a short-sleeved button-down shirt and wide-leg trousers with a grid pattern. The woman is wearing a light-colored tank top and wide-leg trousers, carrying a shoulder bag. Above them is a rotary telephone. To the right is an electric guitar with a pickguard. Below the guitar is the front of a car with a skull emblem on the grille. At the bottom right is a rocket with a star on its side, launching upwards. The entire illustration is framed by a thin white border.

1976



The evolution of **North Central High School (NC)** mirrors the transformation of American public education, shifting from an elite, classical academy into a modern, comprehensive institution. As you prepare to celebrate the landmark **50th anniversary of the Class of 1976**, looking back reveals how the school adapted across four distinct eras.

1908: The Era of Classical Academies and Civic Pride

When North Central opened its doors in September 1908, it stepped into a national educational landscape heavily influenced by the **1893 Committee of Ten report**, which standardized high school as a rigid, academic preparation ground for college. High school was still considered optional, and Spokane was experiencing a massive population boom fueled by the railroads and mining.

- The Educational Philosophy:** High school was meant to refine the mind through a strict, classical curriculum. Rote memorization, public speaking, and mental discipline were paramount.

- The Environment:** NC opened with just 12 classrooms in a magnificent structure that was a testament to civic pride. The academic atmosphere was elite and formal, emphasizing Latin, Greek, classical literature, rhetoric, and advanced mathematics. Early milestone events included visits from monumental historical figures like **William Jennings Bryan** and **Booker T. Washington**, highlighting the school's focus on oratory and civic responsibility.



A group of cheerleaders from North Central High School huddle under umbrellas in the fall of 1943. Photo courtesy of North Central High School (Photo courtesy of North Central High School / The Spokesman-Review)

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2026/mar/02/then-and-now-early-spokane-schools/>

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/North_Central_High_School_\(Spokane,_Washington\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/North_Central_High_School_(Spokane,_Washington))

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2008/jun/05/nc-marks-centennial/>



South Central was first: “We see your colors flying high, it’s Halloween!”

Spokane: Early Education

By **Stephen B. Emerson** | Posted 8/08/2008 | HistoryLink.org Essay 8723

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<https://www.historylink.org/file/8723>

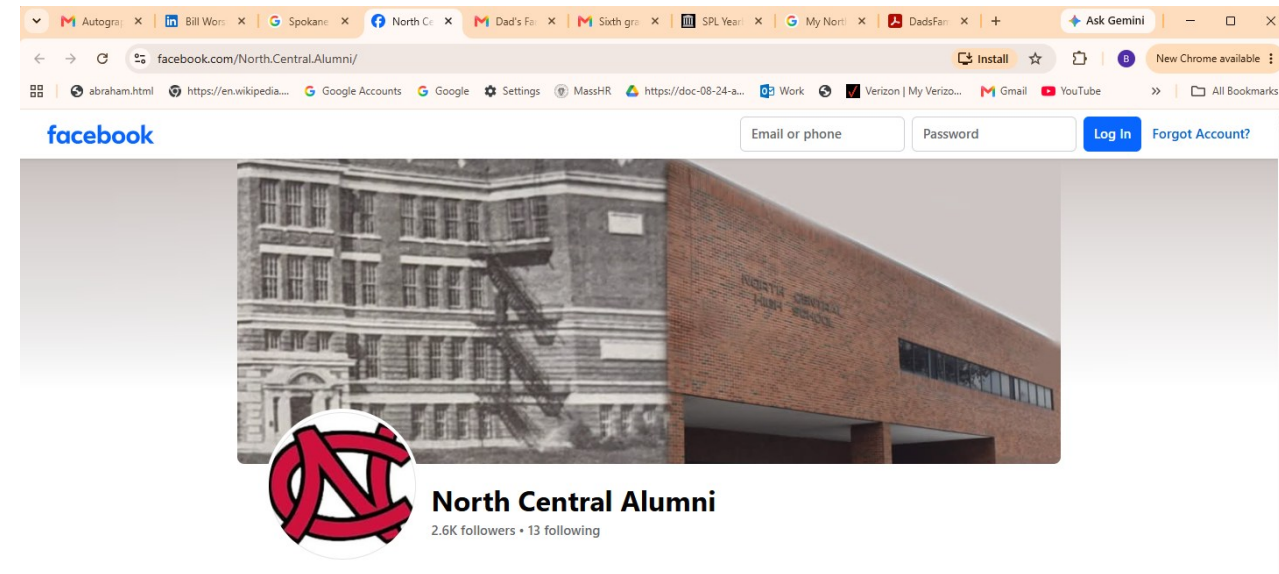


<https://www.spokesman.com/then-and-now/2022/jul/25/then-and-now-spokane-high-school/>

Q: I am a 1976 graduate of North Central High School in Spokane, Washington, with our 50th anniversary reunion coming up in a couple of weeks. Before North Central, I went to Salk Junior High School and before that Linwood Elementary. We lived at W. 816 Greta north of Francis west of Division (and of Wall) so in the County not the City but part of School District 81. From looking at online copies of Tamarack Yearbooks posted by the Boston Public Library, I have learned that the NC principal at the time of my graduation, Mr. Rodkey, first taught Social Studies and World History at NC before leaving to help found Shadle Park High School then returned to NC as Principal a few years later. Could I get a timeline and description of the organization of feeder schools at the elementary and junior high school level feeding into North Central and to Shadle Park (and maybe later to Mead). I would like to understand the Elementary school sources of my NC classmates who were Seniors in 1976, and maybe a little on the socioeconomics of the various arts of the city and county they represented at the time of Shadle and Salk's founding and thereafter.

Happy 50th High School Reunion to the North Central Class of 1976! For your upcoming milestone gathering on July 18, 2026, mapping out the historical shifts of your classmates' school journeys reveals a fascinating picture of Spokane's rapid post-war growth. [\[1\]](#)

The boundaries and socioeconomic profiles of Spokane Public Schools (District 81) on the North Side shifted significantly between the opening of Shadle Park in 1957 and the graduation of the Class of 1986.



The Evolution of the Feeder School Boundaries

The post-WWII housing boom caused North Spokane to expand rapidly past the traditional city limits up toward Francis Avenue. This growth created a massive shift in how elementary and junior high schools funneled students into high schools.

1. The Pre-Shadle Era (Up to 1957)

Before Shadle Park opened, North Central (NC) was the main high school for the entire northern half of Spokane. As neighborhoods like yours north of Francis Avenue grew, elementary schools like **Linwood Elementary** (which originally sat right near the edge of the city/county line) and **Finch Elementary** funneled hundreds of students directly into NC, causing severe overcrowding. [\[1\]](#)

2. The Shadle and Salk Openings (1957–1961)

To handle the suburban surge west of Division Street, the district built **Shadle Park High School (1957)** and **Salk Junior High (1961)**. Salk was deliberately built on Alberta Street to catch the kids from the booming northwest neighborhoods. [\[1\]](#), [\[2\]](#)

•**The Shadle Feeder Core:** Salk Junior High and elementary schools like **Balboa**, **Westview**, and **Ridgeview** became the primary feeder system for Shadle Park. [\[1\]](#), [\[2\]](#)

•**The North Central Feeder Core:** NC retained the central and northeastern corridors. **Glover Junior High (built 1959)** and **Shaw Junior High** took over as the main middle-tier feeders for NC. They drew from historic urban elementary schools like **Audubon**, **Garfield**, **Lidgerwood**, and **Longfellow**. [\[1\]](#), [\[2\]](#)

3. Why You Went to Salk but Graduated from NC

Your home at **W. 816 Greta Avenue** sits in a fascinating geographic "buffer zone" just west of the Division Street commercial corridor and north of Francis. Because you lived west of Wall Street, you were funneled into Salk Junior High for 7th–9th grade along with kids who would mostly head to Shadle Park. However, because Division/Wall acted as a flexible boundary line for the high schools, the district periodically shifted the eastern edges of Salk's boundary zone back into North Central to balance enrollment numbers. This is why you split from many of your Salk peers and became an NC Indian instead of a Shadle Park Highlander.

My youngest brother graduated from the New NC in 1986 ...

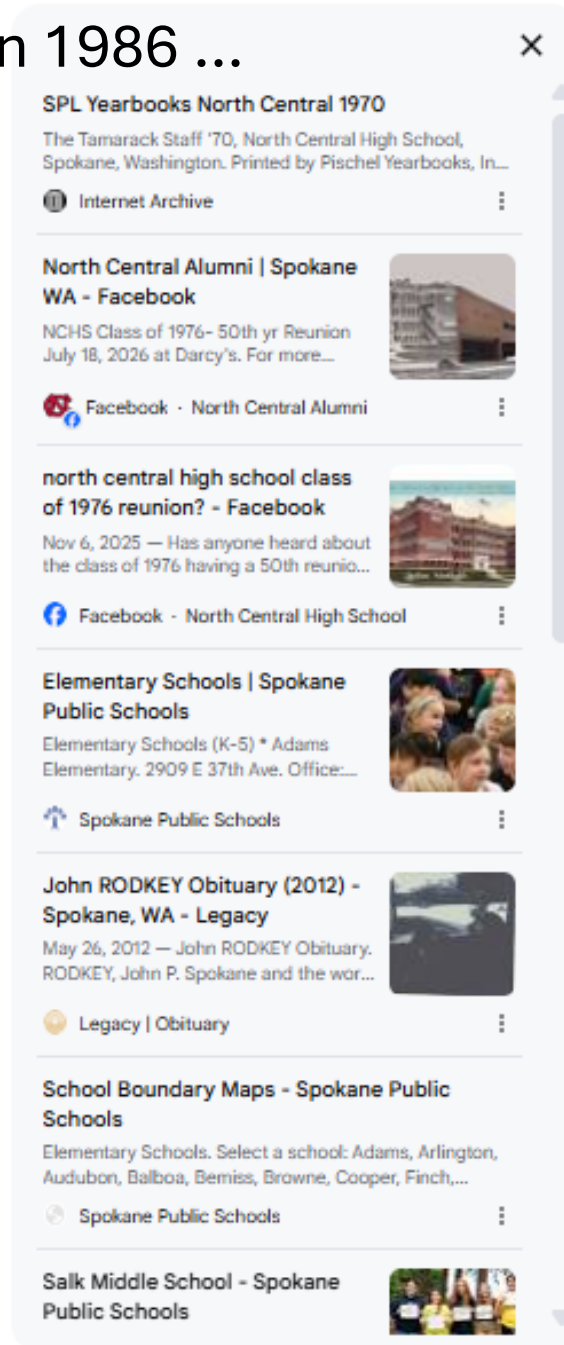
The Class of 1986: Where Did the NC Seniors Come From?

By the time the **Class of 1986** graduated—exactly 10 years after you—the district had executed a major boundary equalization plan around 1980. To understand where the '86 seniors came from, look at the elementary landscape of the late 1970s: [[1](#)]

•**The Urban Central Feeders:** A large portion of the 1986 class came up through **Glover Junior High**, drawing from neighborhood schools like **Audubon**, **Finch**, and **Willard**. These families lived in the established, dense grid of the city. [[1](#), [2](#)]

•**The Northeast/Hillyard Feeders:** NC also pulled heavily from **Shaw Junior High**, bringing in kids from **Lidgerwood**, **Whitman**, and **Bemiss**. [[1](#), [2](#)]

•**The County Boundary Exception (The Mead Factor):** Your neighborhood on Greta Avenue remained part of District 81. However, just a few blocks north and east, the **Mead School District** was experiencing its own massive suburban boom. By 1986, families moving further north past Lincoln Road went to Mead or Mt. Spokane high schools, meaning NC's northern boundary became tightly capped at the county line.



The Socioeconomic Landscape of the Era

The opening of Shadle Park and Salk created a distinct socioeconomic sorting mechanism across the North Side during your school years:

When Mr. Rodkey left NC to help open Shadle Park, he was leaving a classic, diverse, urban school to build a program in Spokane's newest, shiny post-war suburb. When he returned to NC as principal, he brought that organizational expertise back to a historic school that was fighting to maintain its identity as its wealthier western neighborhoods were stripped away by Shadle. [\[1\]](#), [\[2\]](#)

Have a wonderful time reconnecting with your fellow classmates at Darcy's in Spokane Valley! Your class represents the exact bridge era when Spokane turned from a dense railroad and lumber hub into a sprawling modern county. [\[1\]](#), [\[2\]](#)

<https://www.yumpu.com/en/document/view/51382135/sps-first-100-years-spokane-public-schools>

Region / Era	Dominant High School	Socioeconomic Profile (1960s–1980s)
Northwest Spokane (West of Monroe/Wall)	Shadle Park High	Post-War Suburban Middle-Class. Characterized by new ranch houses, mid-century developments, and rising white-collar or secure aerospace/aluminum industry families.
Central / County Buffer (Greta Ave / Wall / Division)	North Central High	Working-Class to Middle-Class Transition. A mix of older county plots, modest mid-century single-family homes, and booming commercial strip workers.
Northeast Spokane (East of Division / Hillyard)	Rogers High (and parts of NC)	Industrial Blue-Collar. Driven by the historic Great Northern Railroad yards and heavy manufacturing. It featured smaller, older, historic turn-of-the-century housing.

Q: Where do Ferris and the South Side/South Hill schools fit into all this? And how about St. Georges, and Gonzaga Prep?

A: The South Hill Split: Lewis & Clark vs. Ferris

Just as Shadle Park was built to siphon the massive post-war population away from North Central, **Joel E. Ferris High School was opened in 1963** to take the pressure off **Lewis & Clark (LC)**. [[1](#), [2](#)]

Before 1963, LC reigned as the sole public high school for the entire South Hill. The post-war housing boom pushed Spokane's boundaries southward into the "Upper" South Hill (past 29th Avenue out toward 57th). LC simply could not hold all the students.

1. The Public Feeder Systems on the South Side

- The Lewis & Clark Core:** LC kept the historic, affluent "Lower" South Hill neighborhoods closer to the city center. It pulled from **Sacajawea Junior High**, which was fed by iconic, established elementary schools like **Hutton, Roosevelt, and Wilson**.
- The Ferris Core:** Ferris was built way south at 37th and Regal. It captured the newer, sprawling suburban developments of the "Upper" South Hill. Ferris was fed heavily by **Libby Junior High** (and later **Chase Middle School**), pulling from elementary schools like **Franklin, Jefferson, Adams, and Moran Prairie**. [[1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#)]

2. The South Hill Socioeconomic Dynamic

There was a friendly but distinct socioeconomic rivalry between LC and Ferris:

- Lewis & Clark** represented Spokane's old-money establishment. The doctors, lawyers, and multi-generational business families living in the grand historic mansions of the lower hill sent their kids to LC.
- Ferris** represented the upwardly mobile, post-war middle-to-upper-middle class. These were the modern ranch-style and split-level homes stretching south toward the Palouse. It quickly became known for high academic testing and an elite music program. [[1](#), [2](#)]

The Private and Independent Factor: Gonzaga Prep and St. George's

While public schools were strictly bound by geographic grids, **Gonzaga Prep** and **St. George’s School** operated outside the neighborhood feeder ecosystem, drawing from the entire city based on religion, philosophy, and economic status.

1. Gonzaga Prep (G-Prep)

Originally located next to Gonzaga University, G-Prep moved to its current campus on North Cook Street in 1954—right in the heart of Northeast Spokane.

•**The Feeder System:** G-Prep drew from the massive network of Catholic parochial elementary schools spanning the entire city, such as **St. Aloysius** (central), **St. Charles** (northwest), **St. Paschal** (valley), and **St. Thomas More** (north county).

•**Socioeconomics:** G-Prep bypassed neighborhood lines entirely. It blended working-class Catholic families from Hillyard with affluent Catholic families from the South Hill. During your time in the 1970s, it transitioned into a co-educational school (merging with Marycliff High School), cementing it as a massive, city-wide private powerhouse that directly competed with public schools for athletic and academic dominance.

2. St. George's School

Founded in 1955, St. George’s took a completely different approach. Located on a secluded, beautiful campus along the Little Spokane River on the far north side of the county, it was designed as a non-religious, independent, elite college-preparatory school. [[1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#), [5](#)]

•**The Feeder System:** St. George’s had no natural geographic feeders. Instead, the school operated its own bus routes that picked up kids from the wealthiest pockets of the region.

•**Socioeconomics:** It drew heavily from the elite enclaves of the lower South Hill (the same families who would otherwise send kids to LC) and the sprawling estate properties of the North County. It represented the upper echelon of Spokane's educational socioeconomic ladder, offering small class sizes and an elite alternative to the rapidly overcrowding public high schools of the '70s and '80s. [[1](#), [2](#)]

Q: I notice my teachers in the Class of 1976 had educational backgrounds heavy on WSU and Eastern Washington College/University as well as Gonzaga, Whitworth, and the University of Idaho among some others. Some of the older teachers from the early 1950s did not seem to necessarily have the university training in education that the later teachers did and may have credentialed initially on experience rather than degrees perhaps. Could you comment on the educational ecosystem that produced my teachers?

A: The faculty of North Central High School in 1976 represented a fascinating intersection of two completely different generations of American educator training.

The differences you noticed between the older teachers (hired in the late 1940s and early 1950s) and the younger wave of teachers were driven by aggressive post-war state mandates, the professionalization of the "Education Degree," and a massive teacher shortage.

The Mid-Century Transition: From "Normal Schools" to Degrees

To understand why your older teachers seemed to lack standard university education degrees, you have to look at the history of teacher certification in Washington state.

1. The Normal School Legacy

Before WWII, teachers did not go to traditional four-year universities to get an "Education Major." They attended **Normal Schools**—institutions specifically designed to train teachers in pedagogy, teaching methodology, and basic subject matter. [\[1\]](#)

In Eastern Washington, the epicenter was the **Cheney Normal School**. These were often two- or three-year programs. A high school graduate could go to Cheney, earn a teaching certificate, and immediately get hired. The state grand-fathered these older certificates in permanently. Therefore, an older teacher at NC in the 1970s may have started teaching in 1950 with an old "life certificate" based on three years of normal school and excellent field evaluations, bypassing a standard university bachelor's degree. [\[1\]](#)

2. The Post-WWII Professionalization

Following the war, Washington State systematically dismantled the normal school system to elevate teaching standards:

- In 1947, normal schools were upgraded to **Colleges of Education** (e.g., Eastern Washington College of Education).
- By the 1950s, the state introduced the **"Provisional General Certificate."** This required a mandatory 4-year bachelor's degree from an accredited university, followed by a mandatory 5th year of college credits after their first year of teaching.

This explains the heavy concentration of degrees from regional powerhouses like **Washington State University (WSU)** and **Eastern Washington State College** among your younger faculty. They were caught in the new wave of highly regulated, university-certified education programs. [\[1\]](#)

The Normal School Alum: Mrs. Laura Lee Briscoe (Born 1917)

Looking directly at your record, **Mrs. Briscoe** fits the classic pre-1950s normal school transition era perfectly.

- The Timeline:** Born in **1917**, she started at North Central in **1957** at age 40. This means her early educational training took place right before or during World War II, a time when classic normal school certificates or general humanities degrees were the standard pathway before Washington State's massive 1950 education degree restructuring.

- The Specialty:** Her departments—**English and Latin**—depended heavily on classical foundation training. Latin instruction in public schools during the mid-20th century was fiercely traditional. Teachers who taught it were often deeply embedded in pure classical languages and literature rather than modern "education theory" or pedagogy majors, credentialing on their mastery of the language and early field practice. [[1](#)]

The Contrast: Mrs. Mary Haugen

As you pointed out, **Mrs. Haugen** was a much younger generation of teacher, arriving at NC in **1970** in her early twenties. [[1](#)]

- The Modern Track:** Because she entered the classroom in 1970, she was a direct product of the newly institutionalized 4-year university education pipeline (likely out of EWSC, WSU, or Whitworth).

- The Subject Shift:** Teaching **English and Literature**, her generation was trained using modern post-war instructional techniques, structural text analysis, and the rigorous state-mandated secondary teaching frameworks that became codified in the late 1950s and 1960s.

Which of our Teachers was a member of North Central's Class of 1947?

Theme Song: Good Rockin Tonight

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2nnOy_jbCa8&t=13s

Good Rockin Tonight

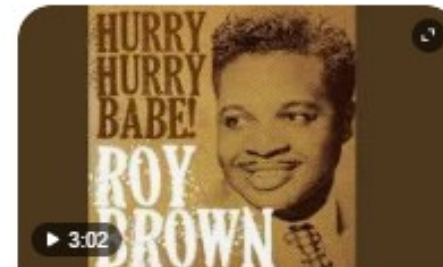
Song by Roy Brown



3:01

YouTube • TheBluesfan12

Roy Brown - Good Rockin' Tonight 1947



3:02

YouTube • Roy Brown - Topic

Good Rockin' Tonight

Provided to YouTube by Wnts Good
Rockin' Tonight - Roy Brown Roy Brown,...

May 28, 2018





1947 Tamarack

Taking Five



What was NC like in 1947?

Associated Student Councils – Boy's Federation and Girl's League; Junior Red Cross; Color Girls; Red Feathers; News Staff; Tamarack Staff;

Orchestra, Choir, Three Fives; The N.C. Band; "Rosamunde" Operetta; "Papa Is All" drama;

Sports, Princesses and Pageants

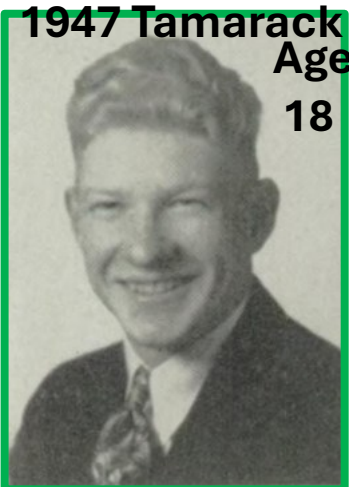
Science

Golf 2, 3; Baseball 3; Latin Club 2, 3; Traffic Squad 2, 3; A. S. C. 3; Federation Council 3.



The Prom "and Graduation Dancers"





1947 Tamarack
Age
18



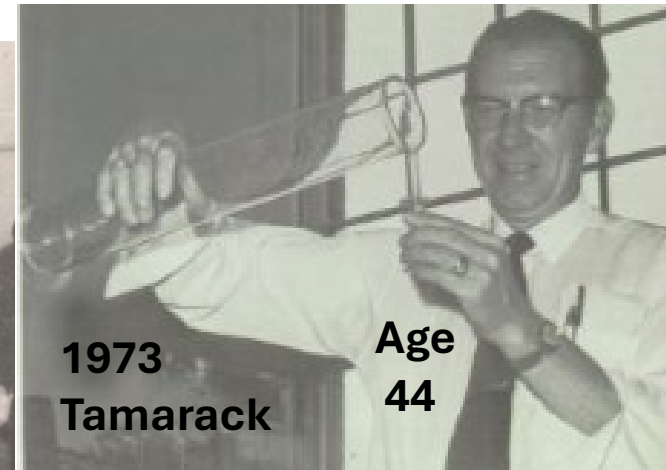
1954 Tamarack
Age
25



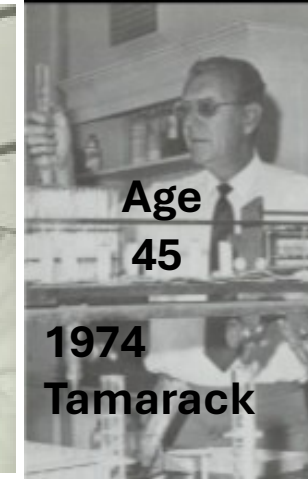
1955 Tamarack
Age
26



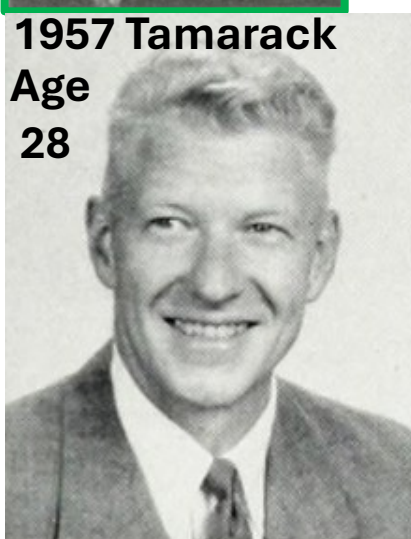
1956 Tamarack
Age
27



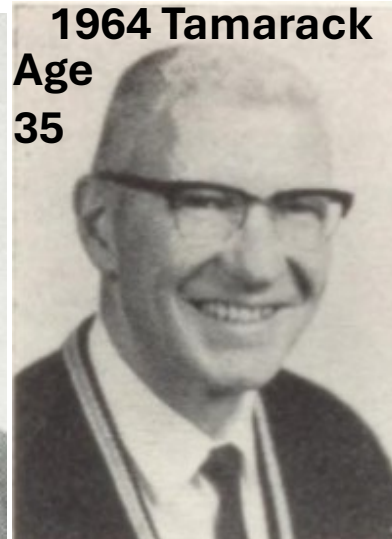
1973 Tamarack
Age
44



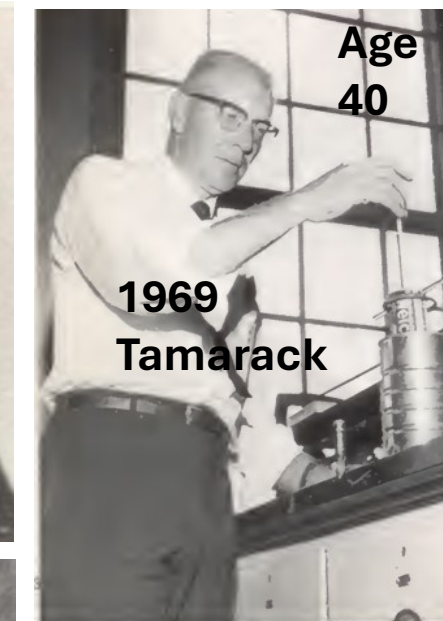
1974 Tamarack
Age
45



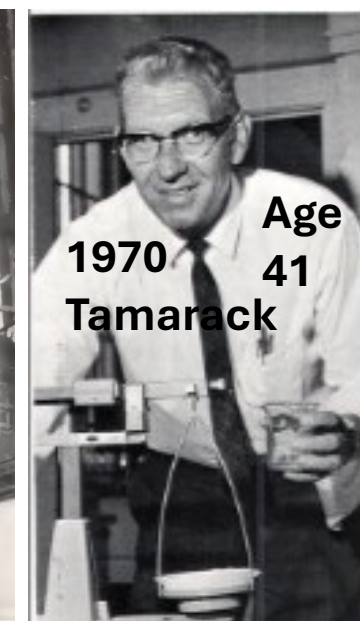
1957 Tamarack
Age
28



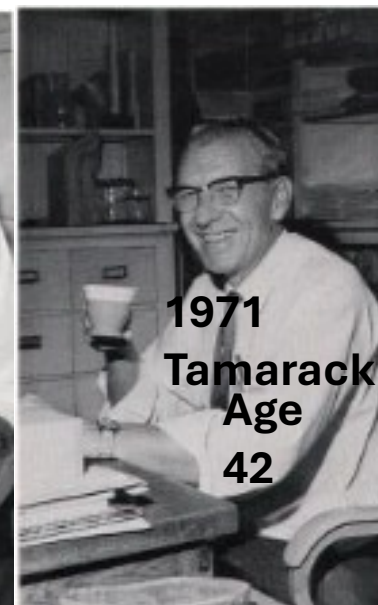
1964 Tamarack
Age
35



1969 Tamarack
Age
40



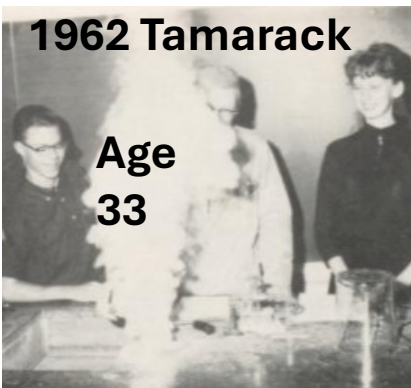
1970 Tamarack
Age
41



1971 Tamarack
Age
42



1975 Tamarack
Age
46



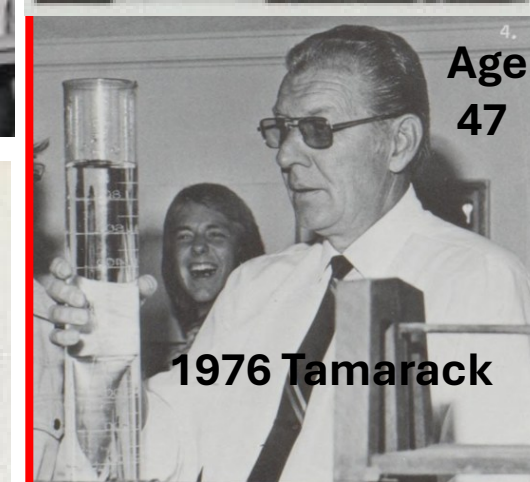
1962 Tamarack
Age
33



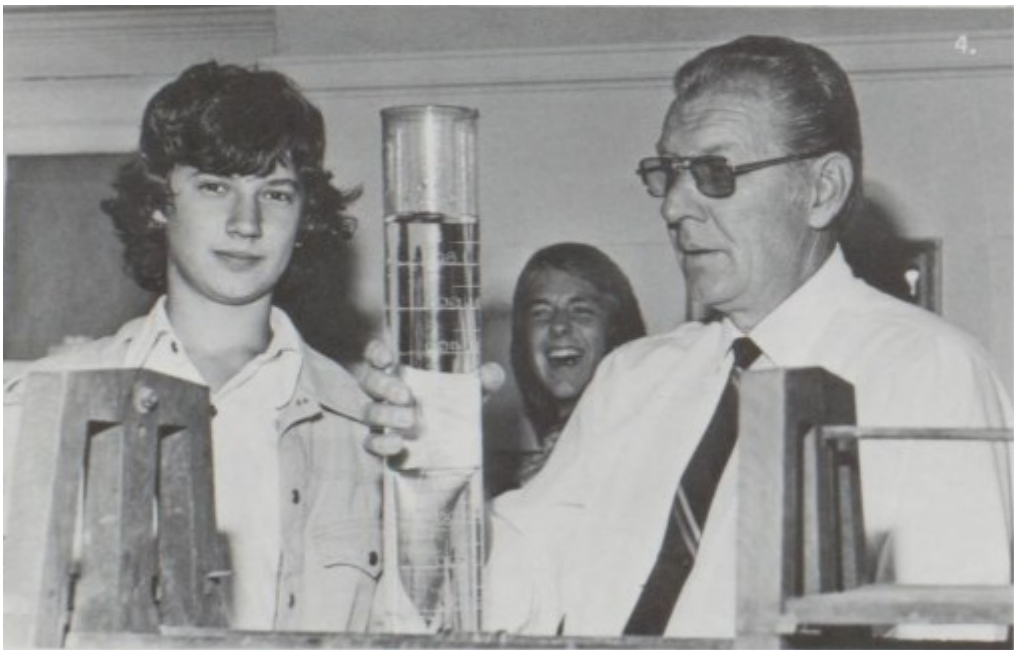
1972 Tamarack
Age
43



1976 Tamarack
Age
47



1976 Tamarack
Age
47

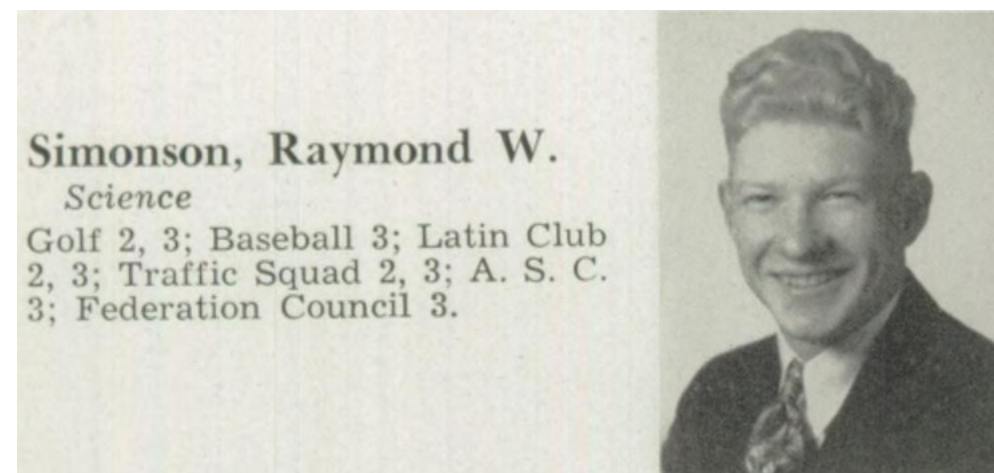


I found **yearbook and educational traces**, but **not a clean public obituary** for the North Central teacher Raymond Simonson in this pass. The public record trail is still useful. The strongest identification is that **Raymond Simonson was himself a North Central student before returning as a teacher**. The 1947 *Tamarack* lists **Raymond Simonson** among the January class students, and the 1952 Washington State College *Chinook* lists **Raymond Simonson, General, Spokane**, which fits a North Central graduate who later returned to Spokane Public Schools. ***For all I can find, he could be a near-centenarian and with us still.***

By **1954**, he was on the North Central faculty. In later yearbooks he is identified more specifically with **biology**, and sometimes **chemistry**: the 1956 *Tamarack* lists him in Science as **biology**; the 1958 *Tamarack* lists **Raymond Simonson, biology**; and the 1959 *Tamarack* lists **Raymond Simonson, chemistry**.

Age 18 in 1947, so born in 1929

He also had a substantial role in **boys' golf**. The 1959 *Tamarack* reports that a team coached by **Raymond Simonson** won the Lewiston Invitational Golf Tournament. The 1963 *Tamarack* says the varsity golf team, coached by Raymond Simonson, placed second in the fall All-City high-school tournament. In 1964 and 1965, he is listed with **Biology / Boys' Golf**, and in 1965 he is also listed with **Biology, Chemistry**. He was still present in the 1970s. The 1972 *Tamarack* includes **Raymond Simonson** in a science/biology context, and 1976 evidence is consistent with a career continuing at least that long.



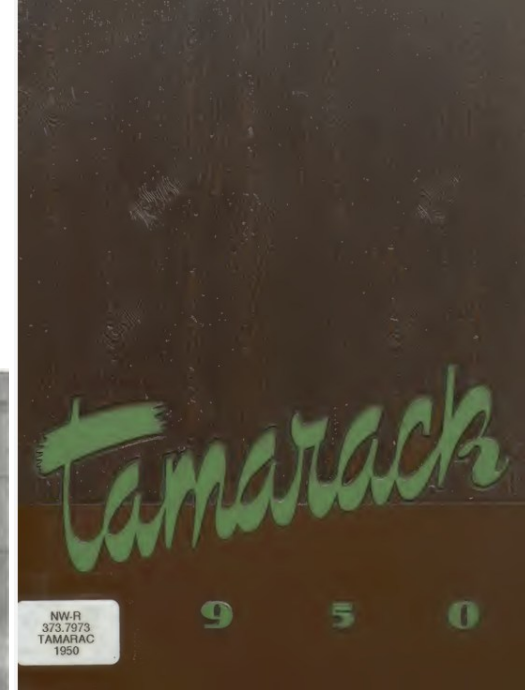
Who was the Earliest of our Teachers to Teach at NC?

Theme Song:

Sam's Song (The Happy Tune)

[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sam%27s_Song_\(song\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sam%27s_Song_(song))

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uwwu5zp9OhM>



The Clubs did get a little weird in 1950: Conform!



Front row, left to right: Lowell C. Bradford, adviser; Condie Quam, secretary; Mickey McHargue, president; Sunshine Gilman, vice president; Murlin Varner, ground squad commissioner; Joan Cochran, hall commissioner; Bill Finn, traffic squad commissioner.

THE CONDUCT BOARD, the judicial department, passes judgment on all school regulation offenders. Conduct officers were selected by League and Fed officers.



Front row, left to right: Beverly Groom, Doris Nelson, Nancy Dixon, Marilyn Shields, Joan Henle, Bunny Bartleson. Second row: Bill Jobb, Bob Foor, Jim Telft, Bud Woodbury, Bill Stewart, J. B. Hefner.

THE CON DEPUTIES supervise behavior at all convocations. They are appointed the con commissioner with conduct board approval.

Sam's Song (The Happy Tune)



Bing Crosby

Subscribe

2

1954 Tamarack
Age 33

John Rodkey
Social Studies
Senior Class Adviser



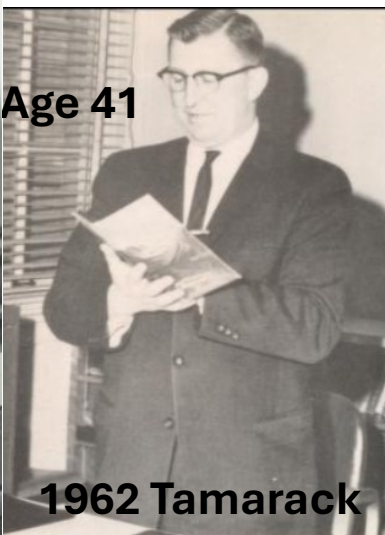
1960
Tamarack
Age 39

1961 Tamarack
Age 40



Age 41

1962 Tamarack



Age 46
1967 Tamarack



1966
Tamarack

Age 45



1964 Tamarack



Age 43

Age 42



1963 Tamarack

1971
Tamarack
Age 50



1972 Tamarack Age 51

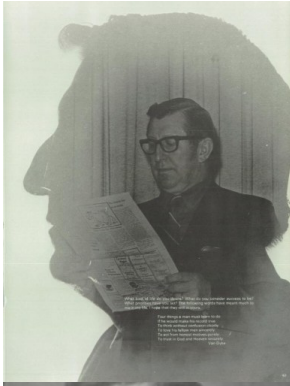


1970 Tamarack

Age 49



1974
Tama
rack
Age 52



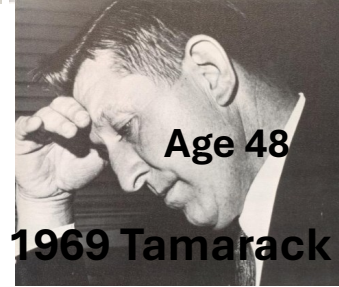
1974
Tama
rack
Age 53



1975
Tama
rack
Age 54



Age 48
1969 Tamarack



1968
Tama
rack
Age 47



Age 55



1976 Tamarack

John P. Rodkey served as the beloved principal of North Central High School in Spokane, Washington, from 1959 until 1979. Born in 1921, he passed away on May 16, 2012. Before his long career in education, he served as a radio operator in the Army Air Forces during WWII.

Life and Legacy:

- **Background:** Born on a farm in Colorado, his family relocated to Post Falls, Idaho, during the Great Depression.
- **Career:** He spent 20 years at the helm of North Central High School, bringing deep compassion, grace, and energy to the student body.
- **Personal Life:** He was married, raised three children, and was a dedicated member of his church who valued faith, learning, and storytelling.

You can read more about his remarkable life or pay tribute through the full [Obituary for John P. Rodkey](#) published by Heritage Funeral & Cremation, or explore his legacy feature in the [Spokesman-Review](#).

John graduated from Whitworth College with his BA degree in Recreational Leadership in 1947 and a BA in Psych / Soc / Education in 1948. He later received his Master's Degree in Administration in 1958. He remained a loyal and active alum of Whitworth University. After student teaching at North Central High, he was hired to teach there after his college years. He taught from 1948 - '57, then served as Vice Principal of Shadle Park for the two opening-years, '57-'59. He then came back to NC as principal from '59-79.





My NC Institutional Lifetime Achievement Award

This goes to the Captain of our ship, Mr. Rodkey, here shown astride his majestic steed and approving the inaugural Rowdy Squad Regalia, and to his staff. In September, 1976 I was flying to Boston with a layover in Chicago when I discovered they had pinball machines there (that's me on the wall over there, with plenty of hair but no beard). Being skilled in the art and never tilting, I won a few bonus rounds, and missed my connecting flight. Mr. Rodkey, who had a brother in the Boston Area, had arranged for his brother to meet me at Boston Logan Airport and get me to Harvard Yard. When I did not arrive, he somehow tracked me down and got me there after dark to drop me off 1000 miles from anybody I knew. I think it was students like me who drove Mr. Rodkey to his tricycle, but he was ever up to the job.

Life lesson learned: Focus! And Priorities!
Technical lesson learned: If you absolutely must multi-task, keep a sharp eye on the clock.



NAME WORSTELL, BILL A				SEX M	SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER 534-70-3315	REGISTRATION NUMBER 2664059	SCHOOL CODE 481275
DATE OF BIRTH 04/08/58		ETHNIC GROUP WHITE		ENGLISH BEST LANGUAGE YES	INTENDED FIELD(S) OF STUDY 1. MATHEMATICS		EDUCATIONAL OBJECTIVE DOCTORATE
ADVANCED PLACEMENT APPLICANT					CLASS RANK 1ST 10TH		CLASS SIZE 250-499
ENGLISH X	MATH X	FOREIGN LANGUAGE X	SCIENCE X	HISTORY	PART-TIME HOURS WORKED PER WK. UNDER 6		
TEST DATE				GRADE LEVEL		NATIONAL PERCENTILE RANK	
12		75		12		ALL STUDENTS 99 COLLEGE BOUND 99	
				2928		1000	
PERCENTILE RANKS FOR ENROLLED FRESHMEN IN THESE COLLEGES				PREVIOUS SCORES			
				MOST RECENT		EARLIER	
S A T VERBAL MATH Read. Vocab.				VERBAL 770		VERBAL	
				MATH 770		MATH	
				Read. 78		Read.	
				Vocab. 76		Vocab.	
				TSWE 60+		TSWE	
TEST OF STANDARD WRITTEN ENGLISH*				EXPECTED YEARS OF STUDY			
A C H EN 770 M2 800 PH 760				LATEST HIGH SCHOOL GRADES		HONORS COURSES	
				ENGLISH		A	
				MATHEMATICS		A	
				FOREIGN LANGUAGES		A	
				BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES		A	
				PHYSICAL SCIENCES		A	
				SOCIAL STUDIES		A	
				AVERAGE OF ABOVE GRADES (0=LOW 4=HIGH)		4.0	
						19 TOTAL	
Average of Achievement Tests				780			
H.S. Performance Based on				R = Rank A = Average			
				R-75			
ASSISTANCE GUIDE				EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES PARTICIPATION			
X X EDUC. FOR COUNSELING MATH SKILLS PART-TIME WORK PERSONAL COUNSELING READING SKILLS STUDY SKILLS WRITING SKILLS				X X X ATHLETICS ETHNIC JOURNALISM MUSIC CLUB RELIGIOUS SOCIAL STUDENT GOVT			
COMMUNITY OR CHURCH GROUPS 5				ATHLETICS 3			
SCHOOL ORGANIZATION 2				SCHOLASTIC HONORS & AWARDS 3			
1 = LOW 5 = HIGH							
01/09/76 DATE OF REPORT				DECEMBER 1975 Date Descriptive Information Provided			
PERMISSION GRANTED TO FORWARD INFORMATION TO COLLEGES AND SCHOLARSHIP SPONSORS INTERESTED IN STUDENTS LIKE ME:							
YES							
BILL A WORSTELL W 816 GRETA SPOKANE WA 99208							

**COLLEGE BOARD
ADMISSIONS
TESTING
PROGRAM**

**STUDENT'S
REPORT**

ACHIEVEMENT
TEST CODES

AH American History & Social Studies
BY Biology
CH Chemistry
EH European History & World Cultures
EN English
FR French
GM German
HB Hebrew
LR Literature
LT Latin
M1 Math Level I
M2 Math Level II
PH Physics
RN Russian
SP Spanish

*See reverse side.
**Absent or Scores Delayed

I.N. 372629

In the winter of 1975, a College Board Student's Report stamped with a perfect 4.0 GPA, twin 770s, and an 800 Achievement Test in Advanced Mathematics carried a very specific, almost unassailable institutional weight. To the administration of Spokane's North Central High School in 1976, led by Principal John P. Rodkey, these numbers were celebrated as an objective validation of public instruction. In an era when regional high schools fiercely defended their academic reputation against emerging suburban campuses, a transcript proving a student could outscore 99% of the nation was the ultimate proof of institutional efficacy. For public school educators of the mid-century, standardized testing was viewed not as an engine of exclusion, but as a democratic equalizer—a standardized scale that allowed a kid from Greta Avenue in Spokane County to stand on a level playing field with applicants from Exeter or Andover. [1, 2]

However, the decades that followed exposed the deep ideological vulnerabilities of this data-driven framework. By isolating human potential down to a singular, standardized axis, institutions inadvertently institutionalized a multi-generational sorting mechanism. By the time the Class of 1986 graduated a decade later, the sociological critique of standardized testing had moved from the margins of academia into mainstream educational policy. Critics successfully argued that a strict reliance on psychometric exams heavily favors affluent communities with access to preparatory resources, narrowing the democratic gate and stifling socio-economic diversity. This friction forced high school administrators and college boards to gradually abandon pure data projection in favor of holistic evaluation. The contemporary shift toward test-optional policies represents a historic reconciliation: an admission that while standardized metrics once broke open the doors of exclusive institutions for public school students, true democratic egalitarianism requires a lens wide enough to measure human excellence in all its varied, non-standardized forms. [1, 4, 5, 6]

[2] <https://www.linkedin.com>

[3] <https://www.nea.org>

[4] <https://civilrightsproject.ucla.edu>

[5] <https://www.ipl.org>

[6] <https://fordhaminstitute.org>

As we would have said to one another back in 1976, in a more athletic context perhaps, “No brag, just fact”. This was the resume that North Central launched me with to apply to and get admitted to every college I could ever have dreamt of. It was unbelievable. I picked Harvard because MIT was there too. And when I got there, NC had prepared me just fine.

Who was the Earliest of our Teachers to have Consecutively Taught at NC?

Theme Song: Rocket 88

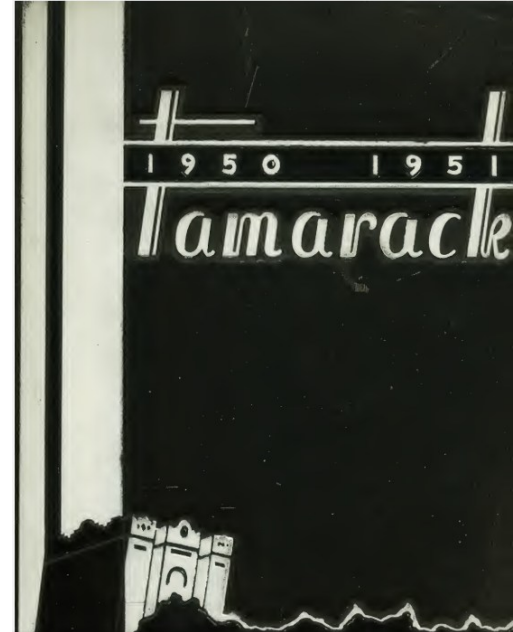


https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Rocket_88

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WcFlj8OuIEI&list=RDWcFlj8OuIEI&start_radio=1



https://ia600607.us.archive.org/23/items/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1951/SPL_Yearbooks_North_Central_1951_text.pdf

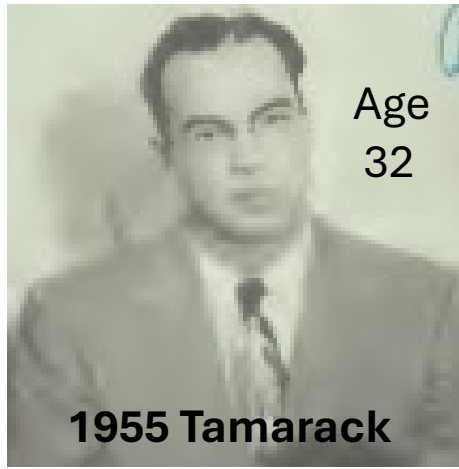


The Clubs are still a little weird in 1951: Conform!





Age
30-41



Age
32

1955 Tamarack



Age
33-40

1956-1963 Tamaracks



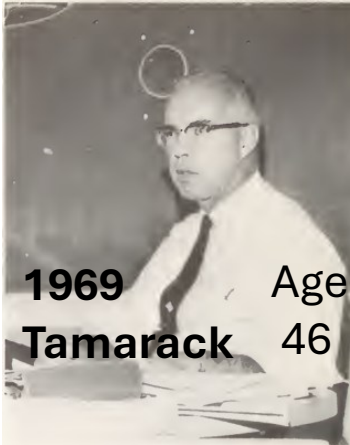
Age
41-42

1964-1965 Tamaracks



Age
50

1973 Tamarack

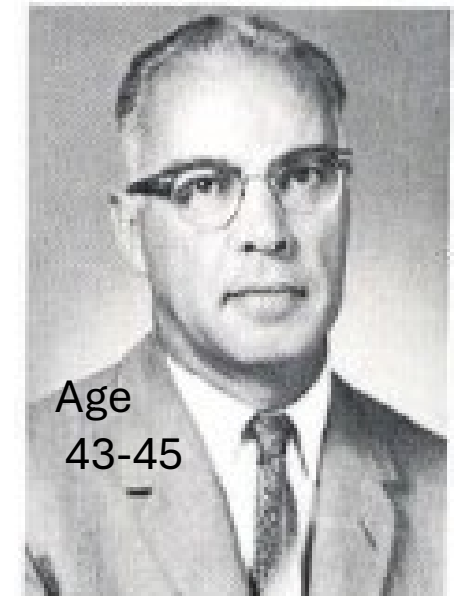


1969 Age
Tamarack 46

1971 Tamarack



Age
48



Age
43-45

1966-1968 Tamaracks



1970 Tamarack
Age
47



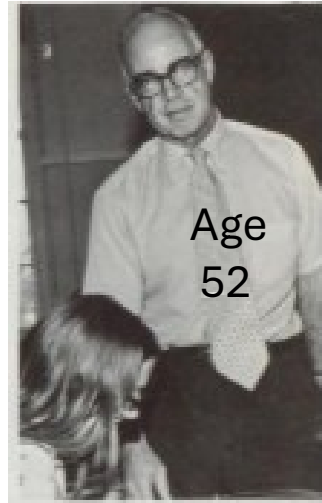
Age
51

1974 Tamarack



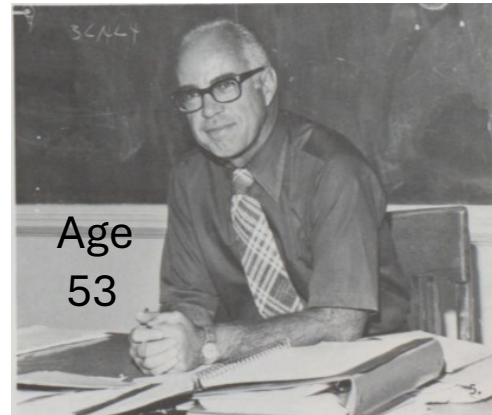
Age
49

1972
Tamarack



Age
52

1975
Tamarack



Age
53

1976 Tamarack



It's the 1953 Tamarack, and ladies and gentlemen, we have a winner!

Mr. Exley was the first of our teachers to have taught at NC! And it's not even close – except for Mr. Rodkey, who is a special case, with a gap in his tenure.

He had in fact been teaching there for more than 25 years, since 1950. We have photographic evidence that he did not age a day his first 3 years.



1953 – age 30

Mr. Exley -

Burrill Dean Exley (1923–1997) was a beloved math teacher, coach, and department head at North Central High School in Spokane from 1950 to 1978.

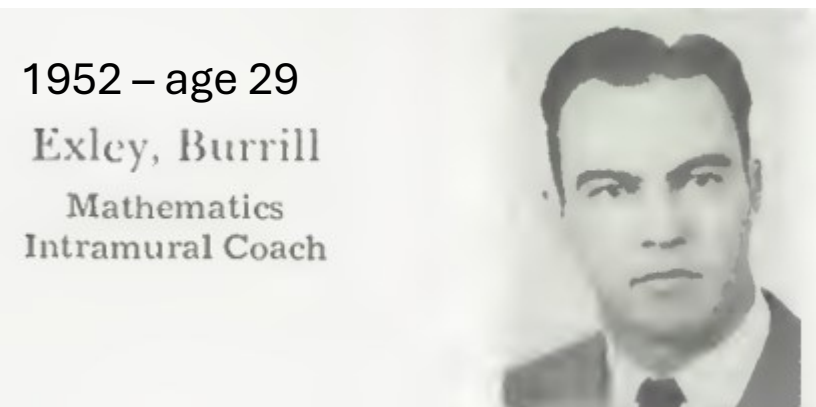
Biographical Highlights:

•Early Life &

Service: Born in Colville, Washington, he was a veteran of World War II.

•**Career:** He taught algebra and geometry at North Central High School for 28 years. Afterward, he taught at Kennedy High School in Burien, Washington, from 1980 to 1985.

1953 Tamarack



1952 – age 29
Exley, Burrill
Mathematics
Intramural Coach

1952 Tamarack

1951 Tamarack



Mr. Rodkey did not age for 2 years.

1949 Tamarack

1949 – age 28

JOHN RODKEY
English
Mathematics
Social Studies
Frosh Athletics



1950 Tamarack

John Rodkey
Social Studies
Whitworth College, B.A., B.Ed.





1976 Tamarack with Mr. Exley age 53

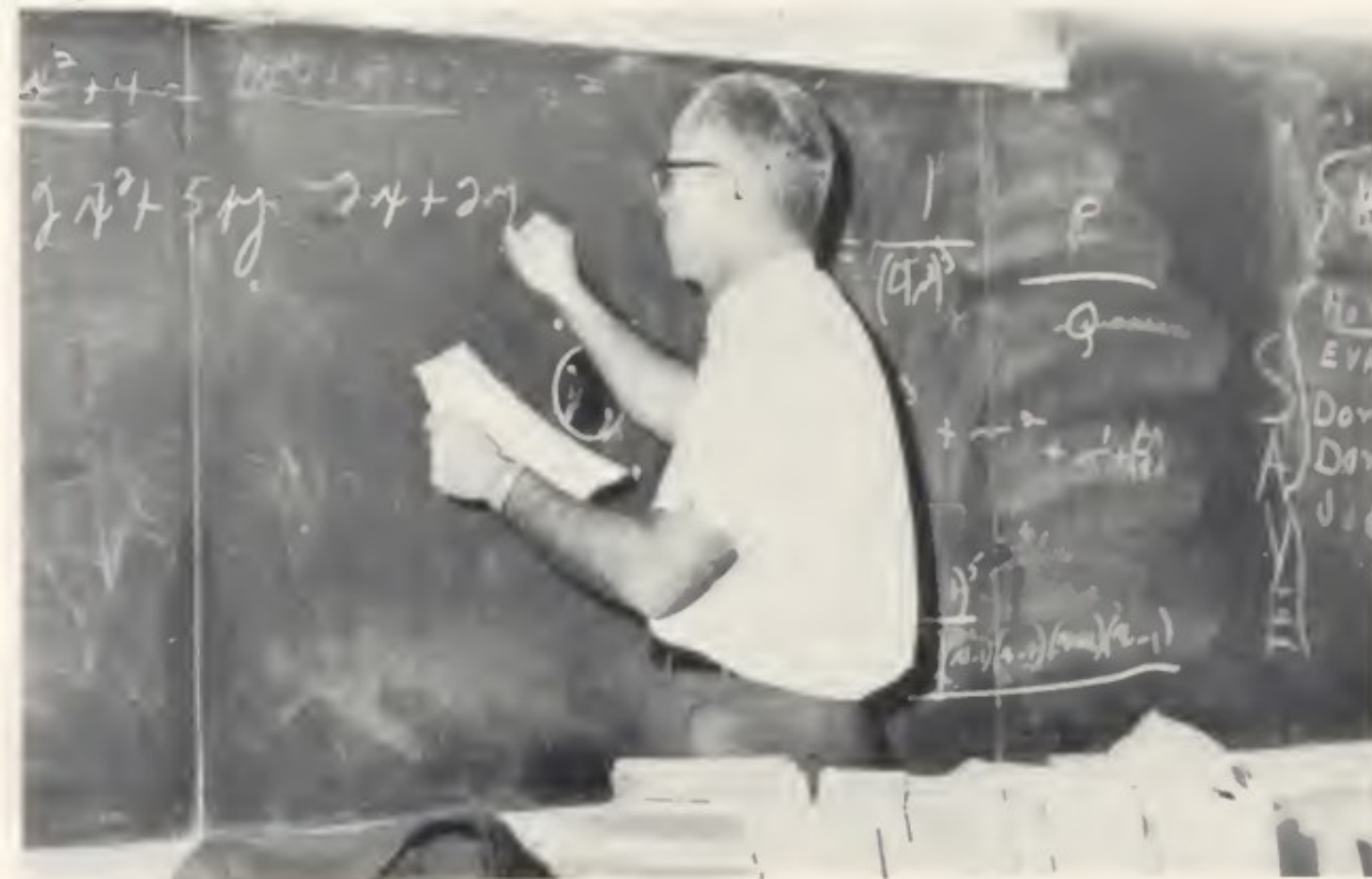
<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1997/jun/27/obituaries/>

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2025/aug/25/this-day-in-history-gerald-ford-calls-new-kootenai/>

Burrill Dean Exley was born **May 8, 1923**, in or near **Colville, Washington**, and died **June 19, 1997**, at age **74**. His obituary appeared in *The Spokesman-Review* on June 27, 1997, under “Burrill Exley, Seattle.” It says no service was held at his request and that Bleitz Funeral Home in Seattle handled arrangements.

The obituary gives the key North Central facts very clearly: he was a **World War II veteran** and served as a **teacher, coach, and math department head at North Central High School from 1950 to 1978**. After leaving North Central, he taught at **Kennedy High School in Burien, Washington, from 1980 to 1985**. He was survived by his wife **Marion**, daughter **Linda Rumans**, and a granddaughter. A Washington State University record lists **Burrill Dean Exley** receiving a **Bachelor of Education** on **October 4, 1950**, which aligns neatly with his beginning at North Central that same year. The 1951 *Tamarack* faculty listing gives a fuller educational line: **Washington State College, B.A., B. of Ed.; Whitman College; Murray State Junior College; Dayton University**, and identifies him as a mathematics teacher, senior class adviser, and involved with intramural sports. The yearbooks also document his long role in the math department. The 1967 *Tamarack* lists **Burrill Exley — Mathematics, Department Head, Scholarship Committee**, and the 1969 *Tamarack* lists him as **Math Dept. Head**. Earlier yearbooks show his coaching role as well: the 1958 *Tamarack* refers to “**Burrill Exley’s cross-country team**” taking honors, and the 1957 *Tamarack* mentions track activity under Coach Exley.

One charming extra: a 2025 *Spokesman-Review* “This day in history” item reached back to 1925 and described 27-month-old **Burrill Dean Exley** as a Spokane Valley “mental wizard” who knew the alphabet at 17 months and could spell more than a dozen words — a delightful foreshadowing for a future math teacher.



From the
**1968
Tamarack**
with Mr.
Exley at the
chalk board,
age 45.

Mr. Burrill Exley stumps his
new Math Seminar class
with a factoring problem.

My experience of the NC Math Department was a little unusual - I was allowed to sort of roam ahead in my earlier years, and by my Junior Year at NC I was taking Senior Math. This was not popular with some of the actual Seniors, as it undercut the natural order of things. One Senior Classmate in particular informed me of this in the boy's room down the hall after class, with a group of fellow-minded classmates who had had to put up with some wise-ass Junior in there, and that I had better shut up and quit raising my hand. I did.

From the **1951 Tamarack**

By Senior Year I was well-prepared by my NC Math teachers for the Math part of the SAT and the Math Achievement test which were the point of everything (770, 800). They also somehow enrolled me in Calculus over at Gonzaga (Math BC AP Exam: 5/5), to be Introductions to Linear Algebra and to Differential Equations at Gonzata (that last as a "High School Bowl Scholar").

They put huge (overly huge) significance on standardized tests back then, and these guys put me over the line. When I got to Harvard, I was good to go.



Chalk work--an integral part of any math class

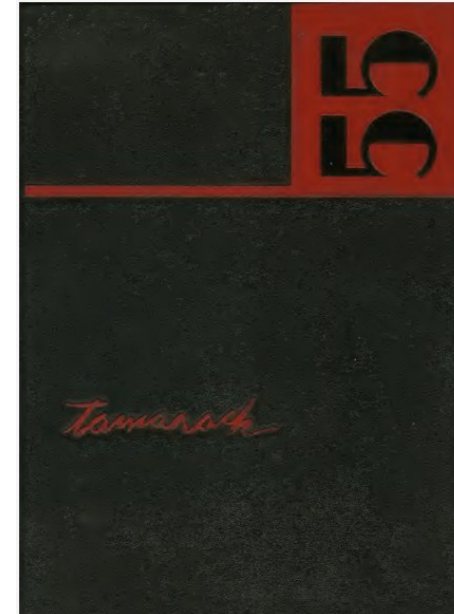
Who was a radio operator and gunner on B-17s in WWII, with 35 bombing missions over Central Europe?

Theme Song: Flip, Flop and Fly



Big Joe Turner Flip Flop & Fly

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aNpvOUmXglM&list=RDaNpvOUmXglM&start_radio=1



Faculty Helps Students Maintain Responsibilities

1972 Tamarack
Age 56



1955 Tamarack
Age 39



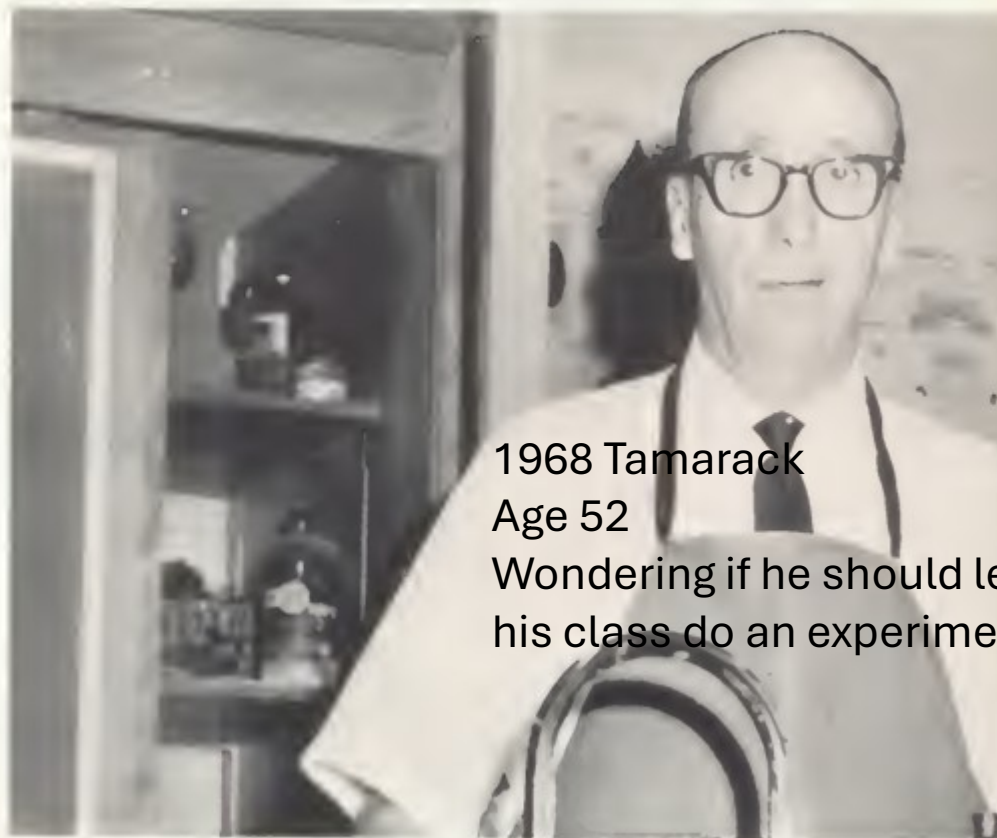
1956 Tamarack
Age 40



1958 Tamarack
Age 42



1963 Tamarack Age 47



1968 Tamarack
Age 52
Wondering if he should let
his class do an experiment.

1960 Tamarack

Age 44

Demonstrating
centrifugal
force with a
Hula Hoop.



1965



Orval Theisen
Senior Adviser
Physies

1969



1970



1971



1972



1975

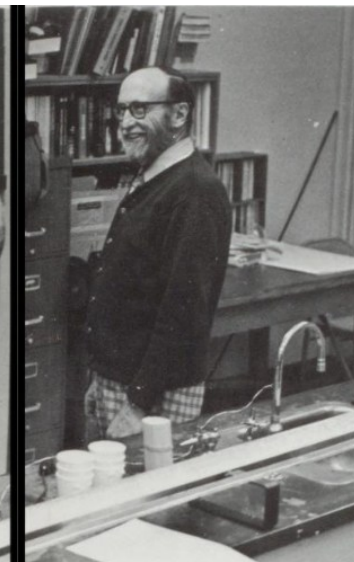
1977



1973

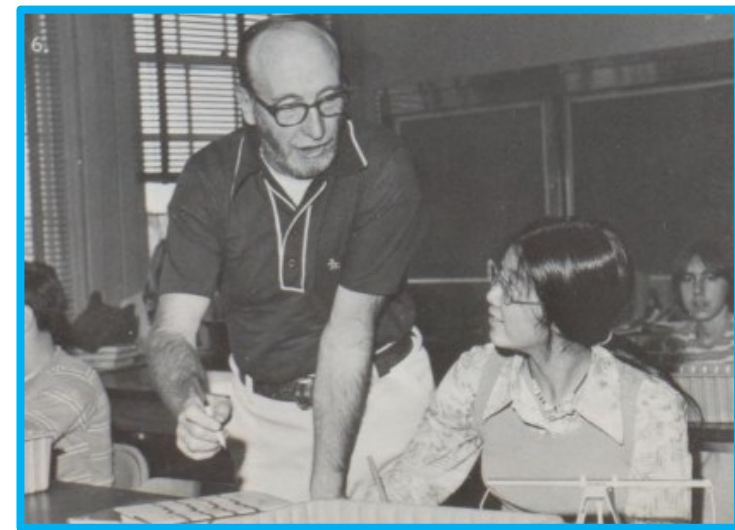


1974



1975

1976





1976
Tamarack

Age 60

The 1958 *Tamarack* lists “**Orval Theisen, physics**” in the science faculty, alongside Walter Spangenburg in biology and Donald Bonamy in biology. The 1959 *Tamarack* likewise lists “**Orval Theisen, physics**” in the science department. He remains visible in later *Tamarack* records: 1964 includes a caption referring to “**Orval Theisen, physics teacher,**” 1965 indexes him in the North Central yearbook, 1968 lists him among faculty, and 1976 indexes “**Theisen, Orval**” on page 30.

One nice professional detail: **Orval P. Theisen** published a letter titled “**Help Wanted!**” in *The Physics Teacher*, Volume 10, Issue 6, September 1972, page 301. That is a useful detail for your slide because it shows him not just as a local teacher, but as someone engaged with the national physics-teaching community.

I found a reasonably strong biographical outline for **Orval N. P. Theisen**, though I did **not** find a full newspaper obituary in open access.

Orval N. P. Theisen was born **January 14, 1916**, in **Erwin, Kingsbury County, South Dakota**, and died **August 7, 2007**, in **Spokane, Washington**, at age 91. FamilySearch gives his full indexed life span as **1916–2007**.

Your earlier NC Teachers notes summarize him as a longtime **physics and science teacher at North Central High School**, born in South Dakota, deceased in Spokane in August 2007, and associated with both physics teaching and *The Physics Teacher* journal.

Before his teaching career, he served in the U.S. military during World War II. The notes identify his service as **January 1943 to October 1945**, including Army Air Corps / Air Force service as a **radio operator and gunner on B-17s**, with **35 bombing missions over central Europe**. He married **Anna Aileene Cantlon** in Spokane on **January 5, 1946**.

Explosion in the Physics Lab

**Which of our
teachers
started at
NC in 1956,
before any
of us were
born?**



Age 31



Age <30

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1956/mode/2up>



Age 27



Age 40

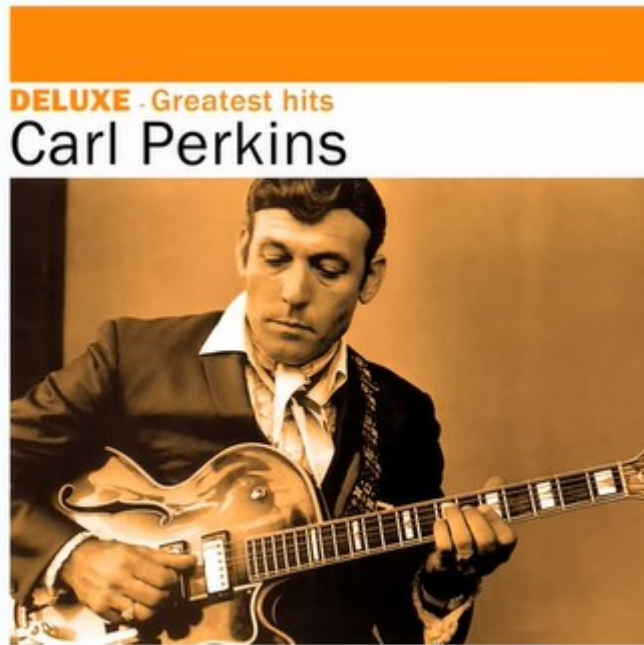


Age 39

1956
Tamarack

Who started at NC in 1956, before any of us were born, and was theoretical?

Theme Song: Blue Suede Shoes



Blue Suede Shoes

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mvsYRAc-BWA&list=RDmvsYRAc-BWA&start_radio=1



The most common offense was battery – oops, loitering – in the halls. Others included smoking on the school grounds, lunchroom offenses, and disobeying hall guards.



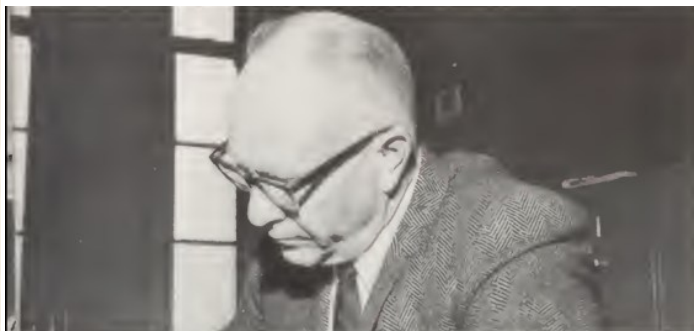
**1966 - 1967
Tamaracks**



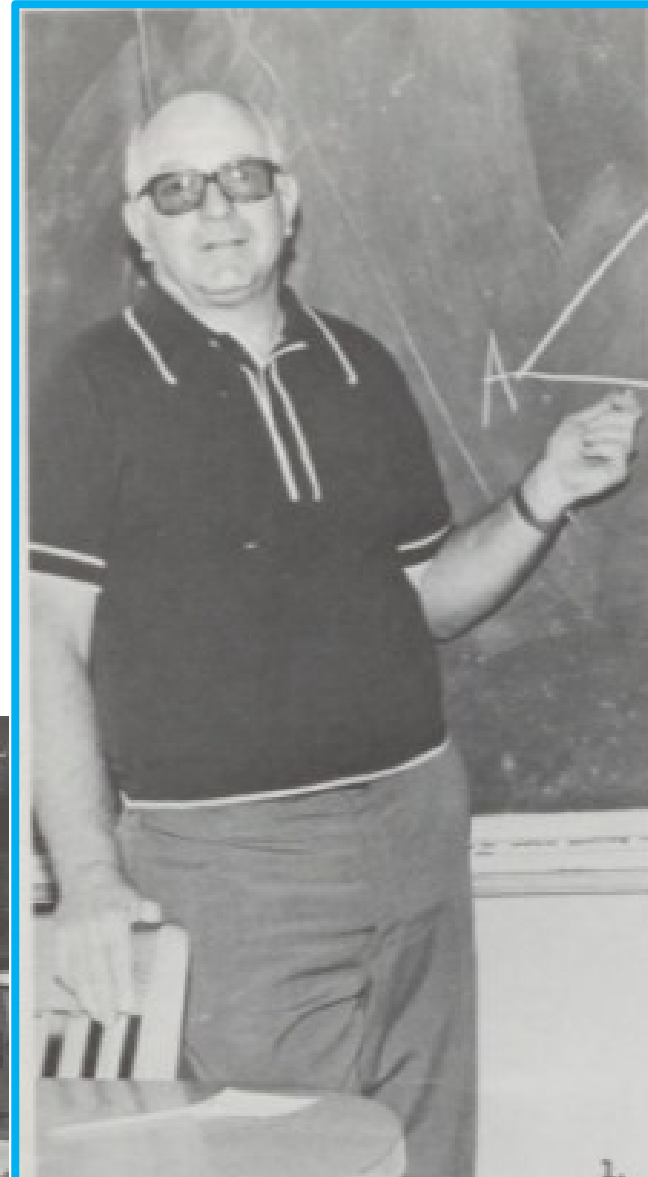
1970 Tamarack

1971 Tamarack

1969 Tamarack



1976 Tamarack



1972 Tamarack



**1963 - 1965
Tamaracks**



1973

Tamarack



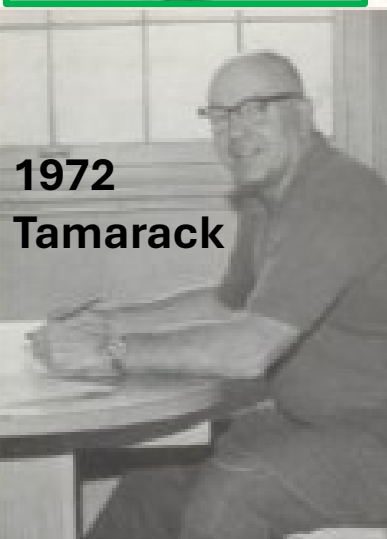
1974 Tamarack

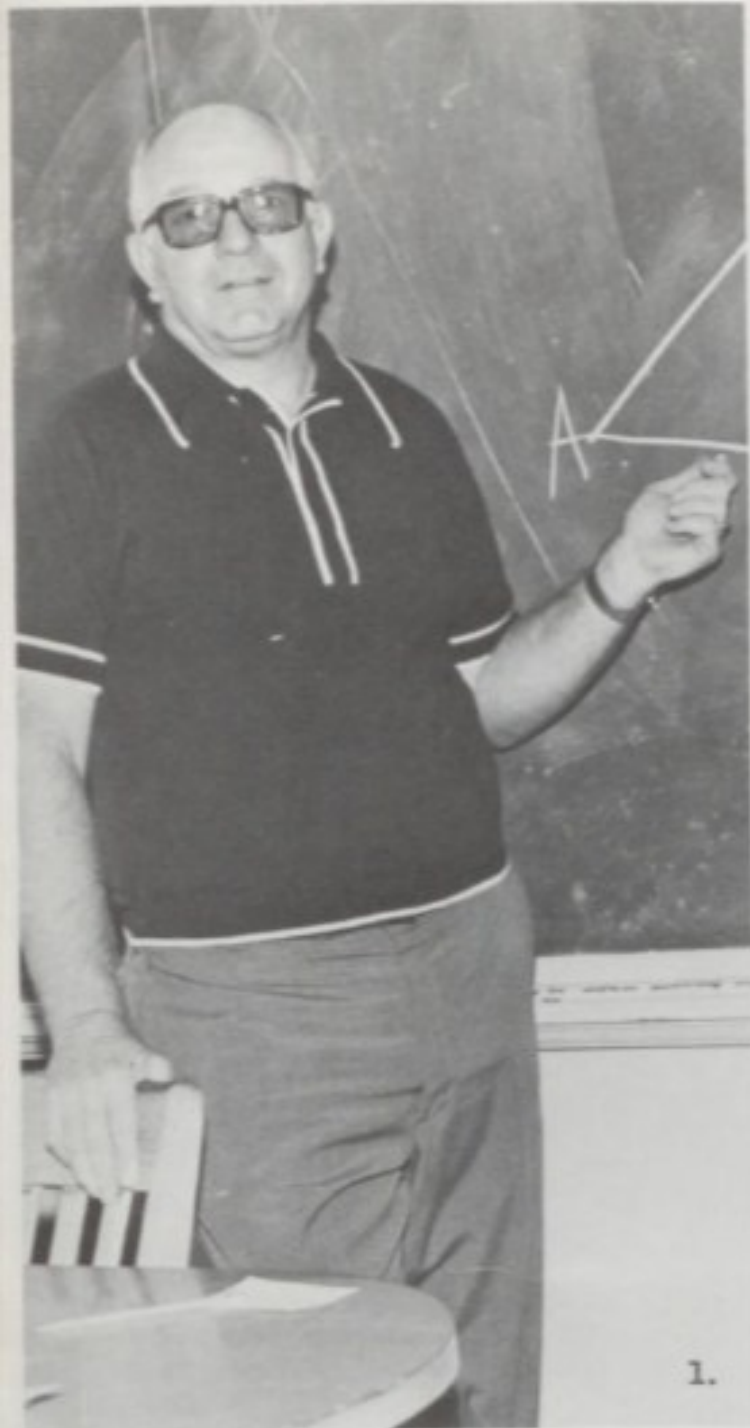


1975 Tamarack



**1972
Tamarack**





I found a good **North Central yearbook trail**, but **not a reliable public obituary** for this older NC mathematics teacher in this pass. There are newer Spokane Public Schools records for a different/current **William Nye**, so I would keep the biographical claims conservative.

William Nye appears in the North Central *Tamarack* by **1956**, where the OCR places him in the mathematics faculty group: “Standing: Robert F. Barnard, algebra: William Nye...” By **1958**, he is clearly listed as “**William Nye, algebra**” in the mathematics department, alongside P. H. Nygaard, Mack Saunders, Robert Barnard, Dorothy Congdon, and Burrill Exley.

In the early 1960s he is listed with **general mathematics**. The 1961 *Tamarack* page text identifies him in the faculty group as “**William Nye, general mathematics.**” The 1963 yearbook also places him in the math department context, with a nearby caption involving Burrill Exley explaining an algebra equation.

He also appears to have coached or supervised **tennis**. The 1969 *Tamarack* says North Central’s tennis team was “**led by Mr. William Nye.**” The 1970 *Tamarack* similarly reports that the tennis team, under **William Nye**, ended in a tie for third place.

The 1975 *Tamarack* lists **William Nye** in the faculty material near Gene Rostvold, Burrill Exley, Gilbert Baker, and others.



1956 Tamarack Age >30?



1957 Tamarack Age >31?

Assuming he was 30 in his first year at NC in 1956, that would make him a centarian if with us.

"Stick 'em up!" Enthusiastic Rifle club members are -- standing: Brad McHenry. Kneeling: Karen Rickette, Sandra Jensen. Prone: Dennis Armstrong, Charles Rodman, Gordon Smith.



The key to success, according to the girls in the Commercial Club, is found on the keyboard of a typewriter. Although the club was organized to stimulate a creative interest in commercial courses, the group also enjoys various social activities.



FNA

FTA

1956-1968 Age 40-52
Tamaracks



Age
50



1966 Tamarack

1971 Tamarack

Age
55



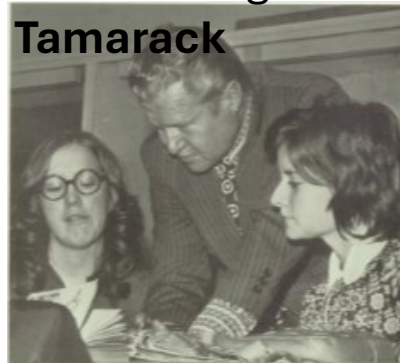
Age 53



1969 Tamarack



1973 Age 57
Tamarack



Age 54
Age 54

1970 Tamarack

1972 Age 56
Tamarack

1976 Age 59
Tamarack

1974 Tamarack

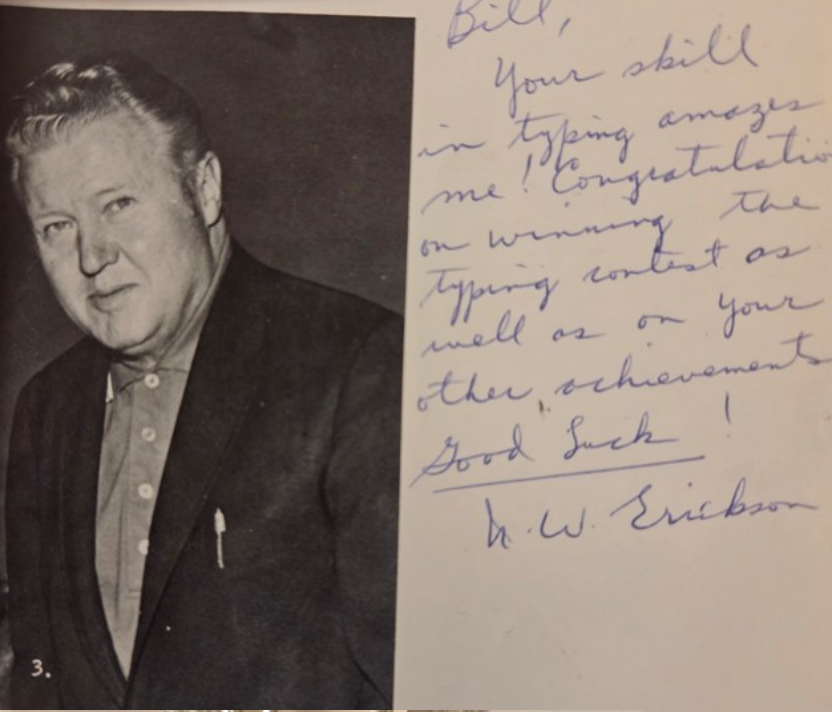


Age 58



1975 Tamarack Age 5





Bill,
Your skill in typing
amazes me!
Congratulations
on winning the
typing contest as
well as your other
achievements.
Good Luck!
N. W. Erickson



I may have lettered in Wrestling, but in Typing I was an actual champion. 84 words per minute, and that was on a manual typewriter. My secret was that I had been playing piano since first grade when my sister taught me since she had had lessons. It built great dexterity and finger strength. Later it got me a job at Harvard in the Geology Library, where they called me “Whiz”.

Norman W. “Norm” Erickson died **July 8, 1999**, at age **81**. His memorial service was held at Sunset Chapel at Fairmount Memorial Park, and [The Spokesman-Review obituary](#) identifies him as a **52-year Spokane resident** born in **Oakes, North Dakota**.

His education and early career make a nice story arc. He graduated from **Fargo High School in 1935**, attended **Concordia College** and the **University of Minnesota**, served as a **lieutenant in the Navy during World War II**, and after discharge in 1946 completed a bachelor’s degree in business at the University of Minnesota. He moved into Spokane work first with **Madison Lumber** in 1948 and then as an accountant for **Watson Management** in 1950.

He married **Marjorie Henniger** in **1949**. He later returned to college, attending **Washington State University** and then graduating from **Eastern Washington University with a teaching degree in 1956**.

The key North Central fact is explicit in the obituary: Erickson was a **business and mathematics teacher at North Central High School from 1956 until his retirement in 1979**. Your own NC Teachers notes also summarize him as a business/math teacher at NC from 1956 to 1979, with death in July 1999 and survival by his wife, children, and grandchildren.

North Central’s *Tamarack* records place him in **typing / business education** contexts: the 1961 OCR lists “**Norman Erickson, typing,**” the 1964 page places him in business education near bookkeeping and office-practice material, and the 1969 *Tamarack* discusses typing contest awards in the business-education setting.

His obituary lists memberships in the **Retired Teachers, Spokane Education Association, Washington Education Association**, and the **Moose Lodge**. He was survived by his wife, two sons, two daughters, and five grandchildren.

Who could read Latin poetry to you in the original and understand it, and started at NC in 1957?



Mr. Theisen- Physics



Mr. Simonson - Biology



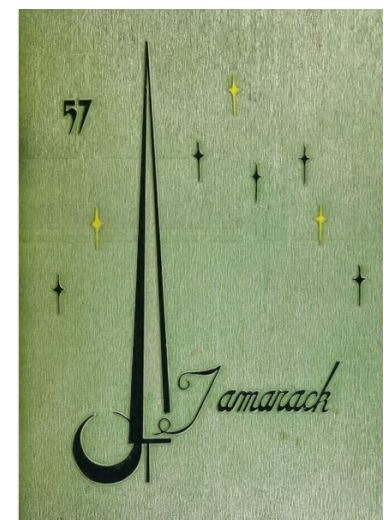
Mr. Exley - Geometry



Mr. Nye- Algebra



Mr. Erickson –
General Math



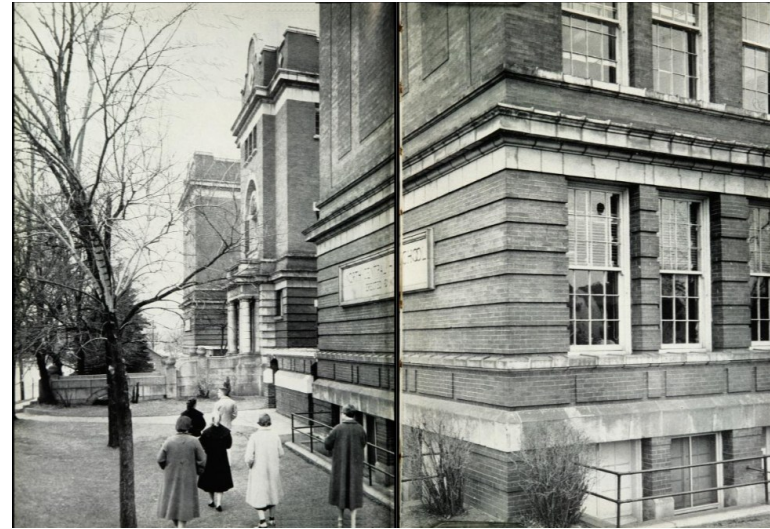
Who could read Latin poetry to you in the original and understand it, and started at NC in 1957?

Theme Song: Gaudeamus igitur

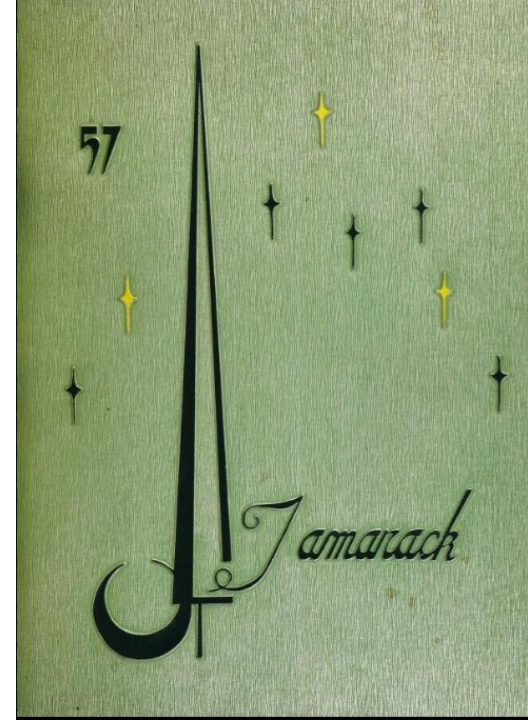


Gaudeamus Igitur - recorded June 2021

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ha6pGK6ZnXE&list=RDha6pGK6ZnXE&start_radio=1



Which of our Class of 1976 teachers was an NC Senior during this teacher's first year?





Age 40-43

1957-1960
Tamaracks



Age 44-48

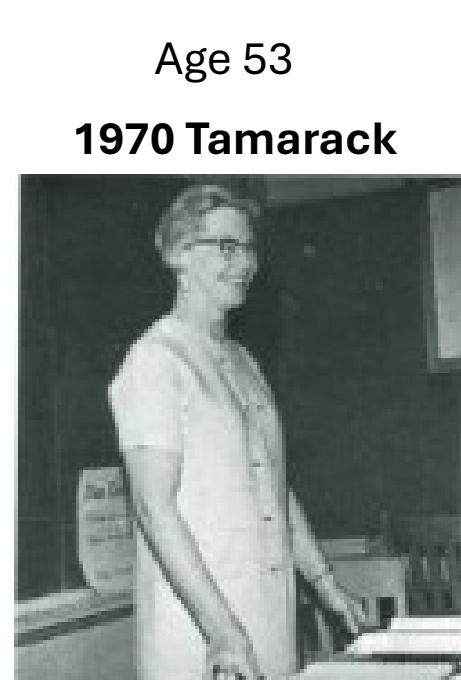
1961 - 1965
Tamaracks



1966- 1968 Age
Tamaracks 49-51



1969 Tamarack
Age 52



Age 53
1970 Tamarack



1971 Tamarack

Age 54

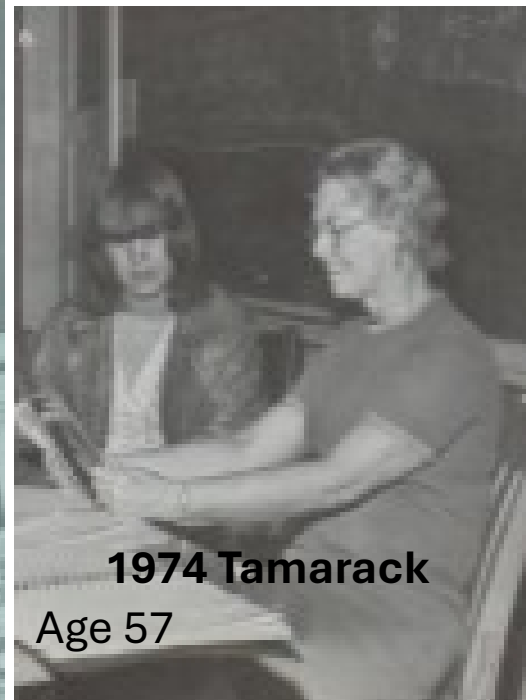


1972 Tamarack

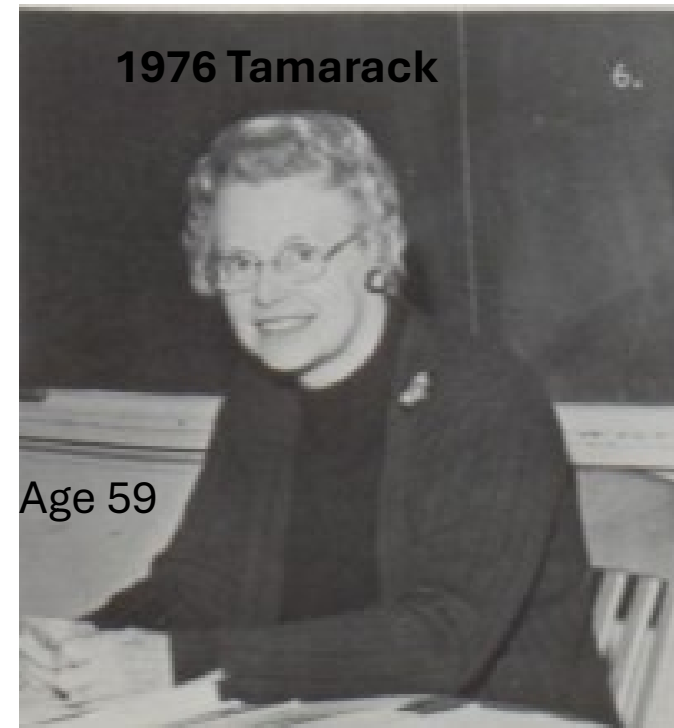
Age
55



1973 Tamarack
Age 56

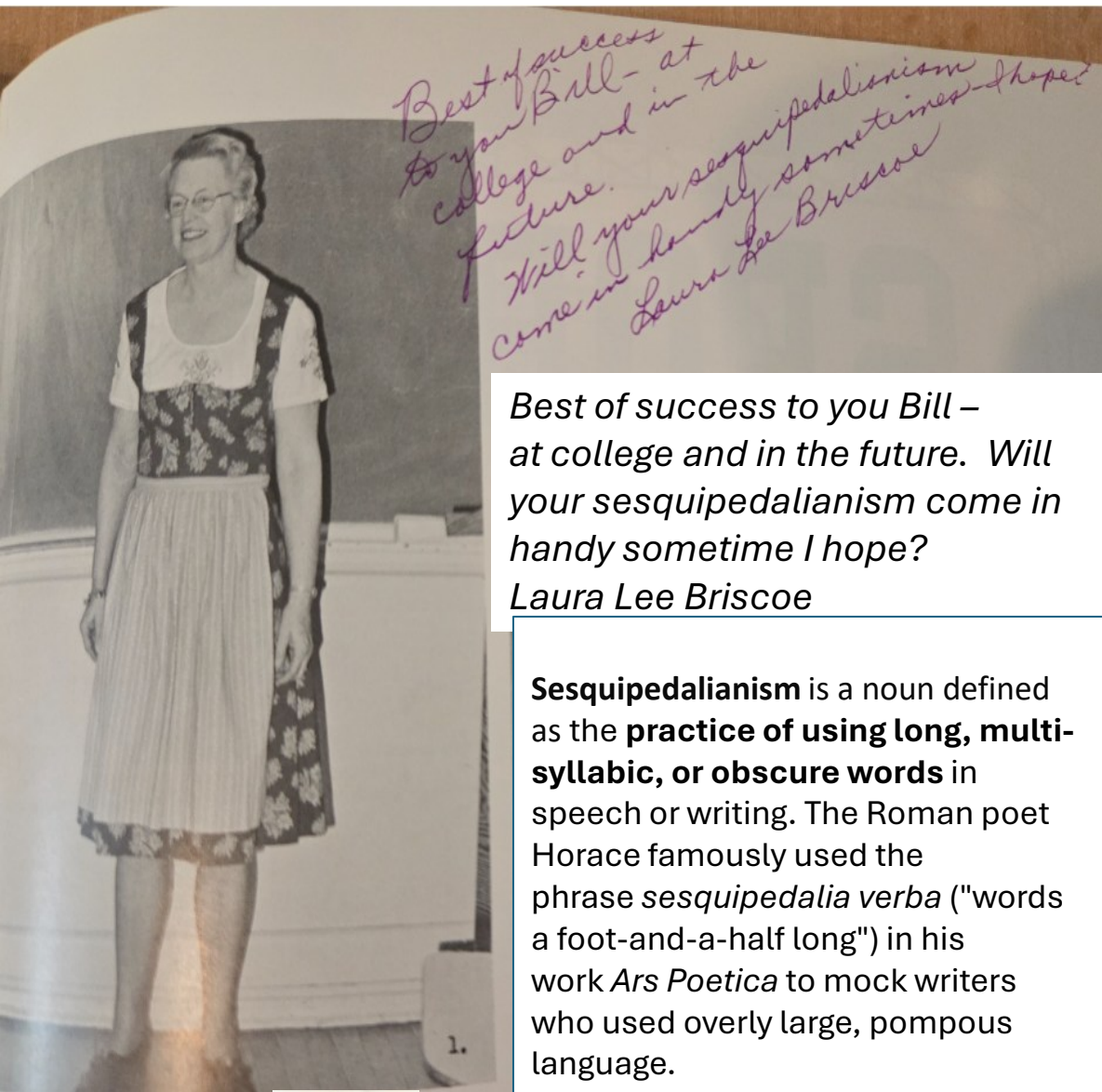


1974 Tamarack
Age 57



1976 Tamarack

Age 59



Sesquipedalianism is a noun defined as the **practice of using long, multi-syllabic, or obscure words** in speech or writing. The Roman poet Horace famously used the phrase *sesquipedalia verba* ("words a foot-and-a-half long") in his work *Ars Poetica* to mock writers who used overly large, pompous language.



1957
Age
40



Laura Briscoe
Latin
Latin Club

1964
Age
47



Laura Briscoe
Latin Club

1966
Age
49



1976
Age
59

Laura Lee Mohn Briscoe appears to have been born in **1917** and died in **1999**. FamilySearch indexes her as “Laura Lee Mohn (1917–1999)” and connects her records to the names **Laura Lee Briscoe**, the 1950 Census, Washington county marriage records, and Find A Grave.

She married **Robert Herman Briscoe** in Spokane in **1939**. A newspaper marriage notice indexed by Newspapers.com lists “Miss Laura Lee Mohn” and “Mr. Robert Herman Briscoe,” with Spokane as the marriage place.

She was teaching **Latin at North Central High School** by at least **1957**. The 1957 *Tamarack* OCR lists “Laura Lee Briscoe. Latin” among faculty. The 1959 *Tamarack* likewise lists “Laura Lee Briscoe, Latin.”

By the mid-1960s she was still part of the foreign language faculty. The 1965 *Tamarack* page identifies **Laura Briscoe** with **Latin** and **Latin Club**, in a Foreign Languages section headed by Helen Oscarson. The 1968 *Tamarack* says that under Laura Lee Briscoe, Latin Club worked on increasing members’ knowledge of Latin and its origins.

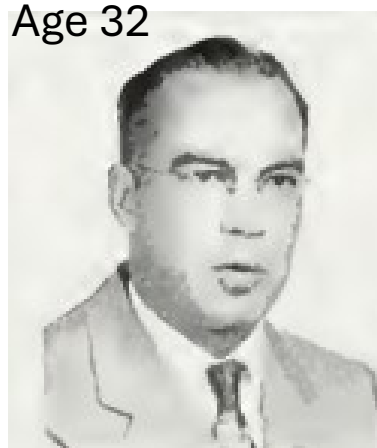
By the early 1970s she appears in the **English** department rather than foreign languages. The 1971 North Central yearbook OCR lists “Laura Lee Briscoe” in an English-related faculty list. The 1975 *Tamarack* also indexes “Laura Lee Briscoe,” consistent with your statement that she was still at NC into the 1970s. The 1976 yearbook OCR includes a caption: “Laura Lee Briscoe wears a costume from Germany for International Week,” matching the attached photo context.

Her husband, **Robert H. Briscoe**, died in 1995. His Spokesman-Review obituary says he was a former Spokane resident, a WSU graduate in mathematics and physics, a former Whitworth teacher, later connected with Expo ’74 and Eastern Washington University, and that after retirement he and his wife **Laura Lee** spent summers at Priest Lake and winters in San Diego before moving to La Mesa, California in 1987. Their son Barry Don Briscoe’s obituary also identifies him as one of five children born to **Robert and Laura Lee (Mohn) Briscoe** in Spokane.

Which teacher of ours had a half dozen of our other teachers as teachers when he graduated from NC in 1957?



Age 18



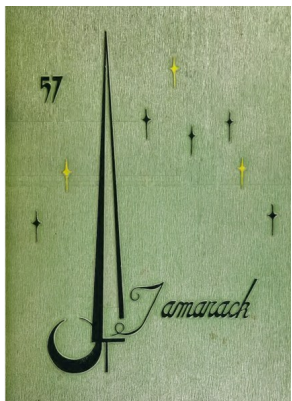
Age 32



Age < 31

Mr. Exley -
Geometry

Mr. Nye -
Algebra



Age 40

Mrs. Briscoe -
Latin



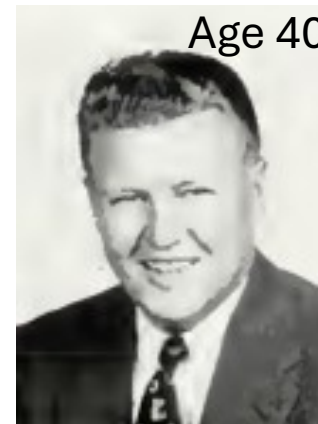
Age 28

Mr. Simonson -
Biology



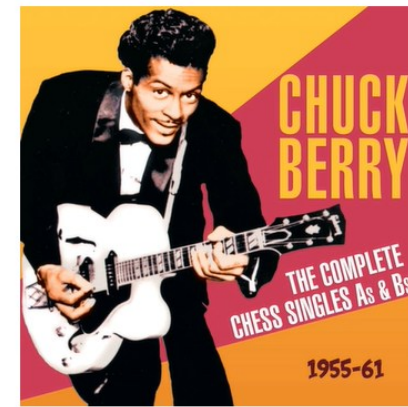
Age 42

Mr. Theisen -
Physics



Age 40

Mr. Erickson -
General Math



School Day (Ring! Ring! Goes the Bell)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vNrfXJ-WnE0&list=RDvNrfXJ-WnE0&start_radio=1



Chuck Berry "School Days"

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6d1mZJsZGXg>

1958: The Mid-Century Boom and Post-Sputnik Science

By the year of my birth in 1958, the educational landscape had been completely upended by the **1944 G.I. Bill**, the post-war Baby Boom, and the dawn of the Space Age. The Soviet Union's launch of Sputnik in late 1957 sent shockwaves through American education, prompting the **National Defense Education Act of 1958**.

•The Educational Philosophy:

High schools pivoted violently toward rigorous math, engineering, and foreign languages to compete globally. Concurrently, the "comprehensive high school" model took root, designed to offer both college-prep tracking and vocational training.

The Environment:

The iconic old collegiate-Gothic building was bursting at the seams with the first wave of Baby Boomers. The environment was highly structured, defined by mid-century social conformity, traditional gender roles (such as home economics for girls and industrial arts for boys), and a booming subculture of high school athletics, pep clubs, and marching bands.

“Our educational thinkers in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries saw the schools as the central and main hope for the preservation of democratic ideals and the endurance of the nation as a republic,” writes education scholar E. D. Hirsch.

<https://www.city-journal.org/article/when-high-schools-shaped-americas-destiny>



Paul Beston

When High Schools Shaped America's Destiny

An early-twentieth-century grassroots movement for mass secondary education positioned the nation for world leadership.

WIKIPEDIA 25 years of the free encyclopedia

History of education in the United States

Article Talk Read Edit View history Tools

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

For broader coverage of this topic, see *History of education* and *Education in the United States*.

The **history of education in the United States** covers the trends in formal education in America from the 17th century to the early 21st century.

Colonial era [edit]

See also: *Education in the Thirteen Colonies*, *Latin school* § *Latin schools in colonial North America and the USA*, and *Literacy in the United States*

Schooling was a high priority in Puritan *New England*, which set up strong systems, especially in the colonial-era *Province of Massachusetts Bay*. It was a lower priority elsewhere, with many short-lived small local private academies and some schools for pauper children.^[1]

This article is part of a series on **Education in the United States**

Summary

By state and in insular areas
By subject area

History

California · Chicago · Kentucky · Massachusetts (Dedham) · Missouri · New York City · Southern United States · Texas

Curriculum topics

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/History_of_education_in_the_United_States



A 1768 depiction of **Harvard College** engraved by **Paul Revere**

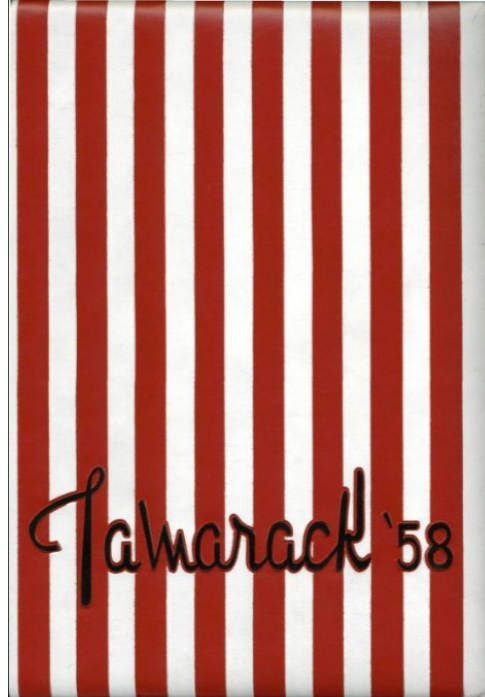


Age 33



Age <32

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1958/mode/2up>



Age 41



Age 29



Age 42



Age 41

1958
Tamarack

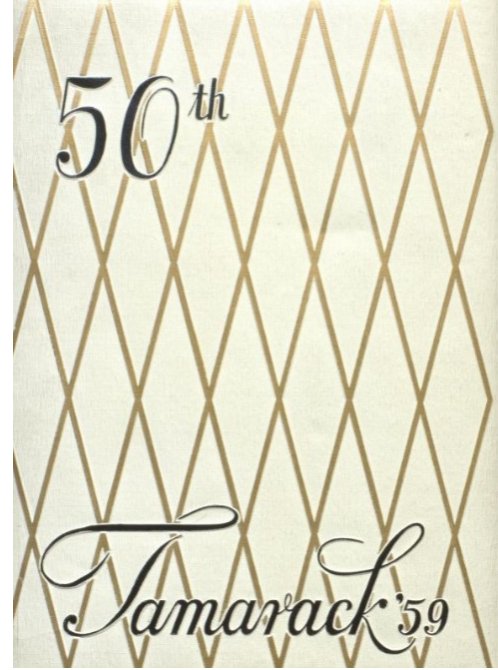


Age 34



Age <33

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1959/mode/2up>



Age 42



Age 30



Age 43



Age 42

1959
Tamarack



Age 39

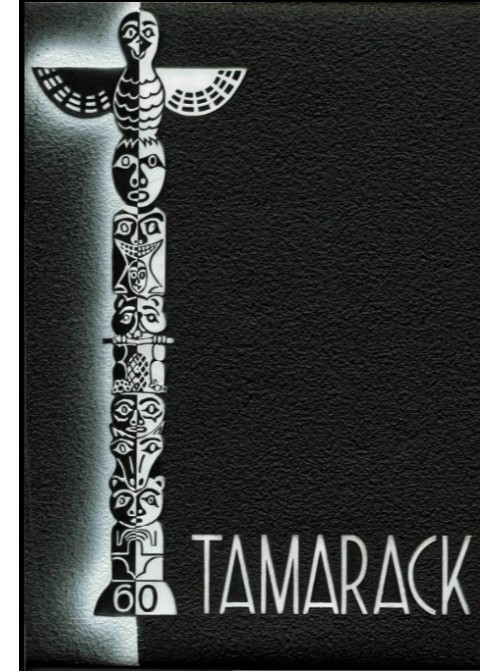


Age 35



Age <34

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1960/mode/2up>



Age 43



Age 31



Age 44



Age 43

1960
Tamarack



Age 40



Age 38



Age <35

1961
Tamarack

Age 38



Age 44



Age 32



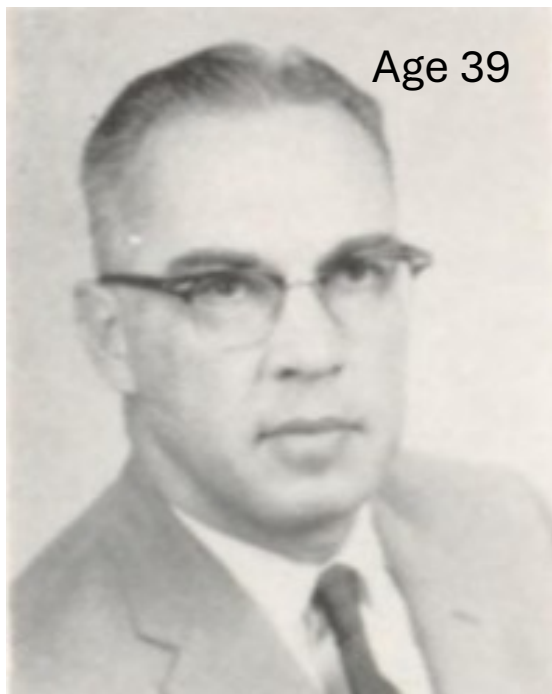
Age 45



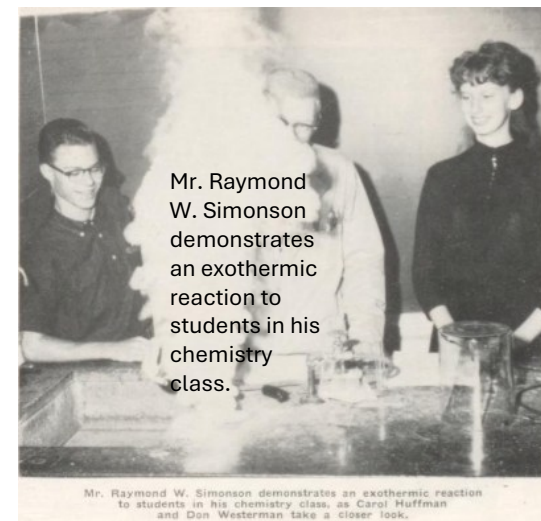
Age 44



Age 41

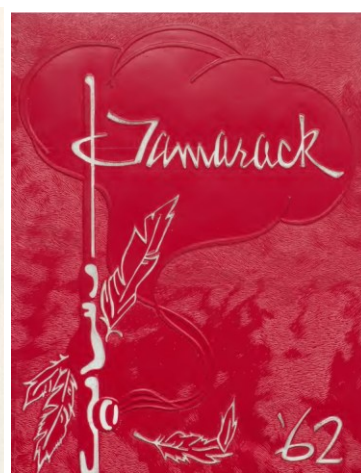


Age 39



Mr. Raymond W. Simonson demonstrates an exothermic reaction to students in his chemistry class.

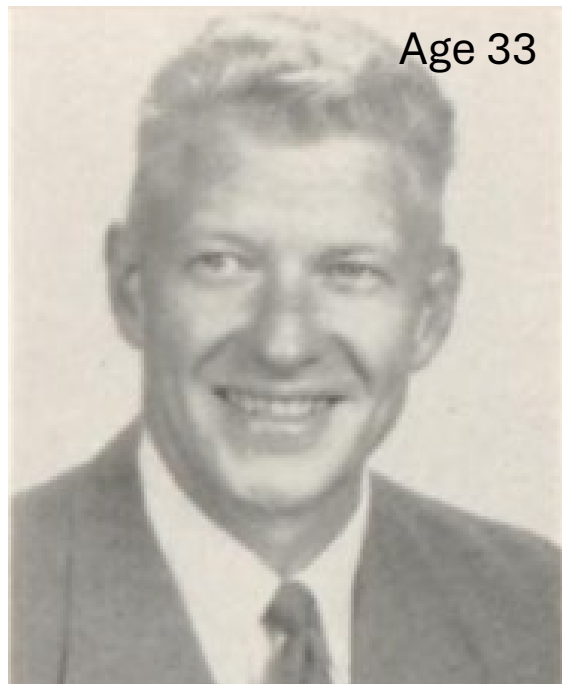
Mr. Raymond W. Simonson demonstrates an exothermic reaction to students in his chemistry class, as Carol Huffman and Don Westerman take a closer look.



1962
Tamarack



Age 45



Age 33



Age 46



Age 45



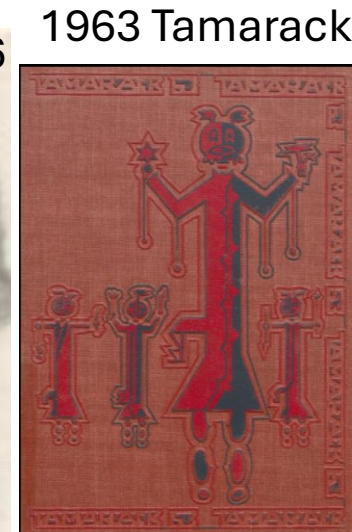
Age 40



Age <37



Age 46



1963 Tamarack



Age 34



Age 47



Age 46



Duane David



Teresa Kienzel



Rosemary Como



Susie Fiksdahl



Bill Worstell



Jeff Blackwell



Kindergarten, 1964, ~6 years old

Public historical and obituary archives confirm that your kindergarten teacher from [Linwood Elementary School](#) was **Mabel Helen Melin Cain**. [1]

Biography & Life Summary

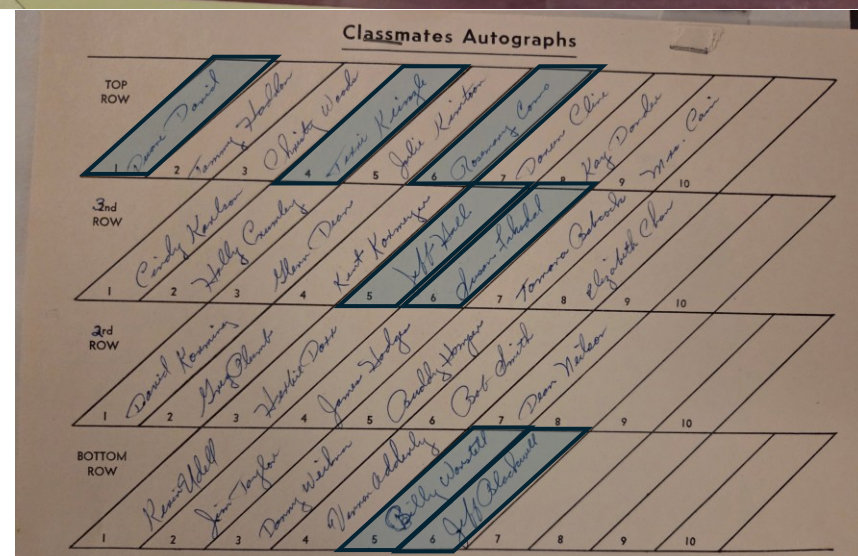
•**Early Career:** Mabel began her teaching career in Danberry, Wisconsin, where she famously spent a decade teaching inside a traditional **one-room schoolhouse**. [1]

•**Moving to Spokane:** She and her family relocated to Spokane in 1948. Shortly after, she joined Spokane Public Schools and worked as a dedicated kindergarten teacher at both **Willard Elementary** and your own **Linwood Elementary**. [1]

•**Retirement:** She retired from teaching in 1974, meaning your 1963–1964 kindergarten class got to experience her during the prime of her long-time career. [1]

•**Family & Community:** She was a deeply active, 45-year member of Spokane's Emmanuel Lutheran Church. She was married to her husband, Clyde Cain, for 52 years, and raised three children: David, George, and Betsy. [1]

Obituary Notice If you would like me to help verify more student portraits from your 1976 senior yearbook or help transcribe any other names from the autograph sheet, just say the word [1] <https://www.spokesman.com>





Age 43

1964 Tamarack



Age 41



Age <38



Age 47



Age 35



Age 48



Age 47



First
Grade,
1965.

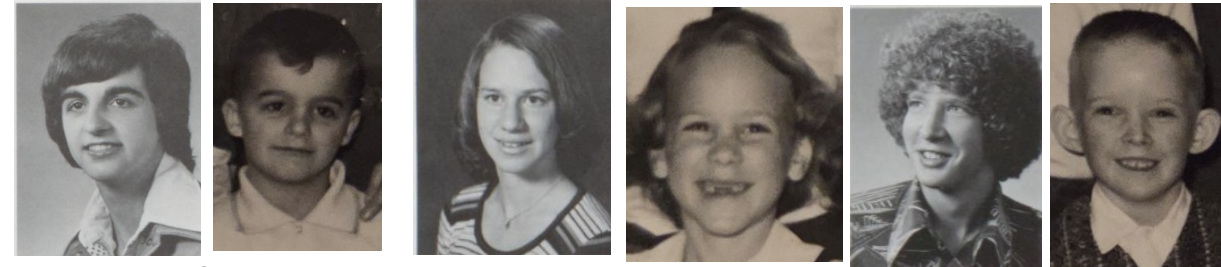
~7 years
old



Ray Newcomb

Bill Worstell

Susie Fiksdahl



Mark Sutton

Gloria Marshall

Mike Othmer

Public archival and obituary records confirm your first grade teacher 's name as **Dorothy Jane Craig**. [1]

Biography & Life Summary

•**Lifespan:** March 27, 1915 – January 1, 2019. Like Mrs. Gibeault, she was a centenarian and lived to be **103 years old**. [1]

•**A Lifetime of First Graders:** Teaching first graders was her true lifelong passion. Over a teaching career that spanned more than 40 years, she taught first grade at Arlington, Balboa, and your very own **Linwood Elementary School** in Spokane. [1]

•**International Educator:** Beyond Spokane Public Schools, she actually traveled overseas to teach first grade to military family children in **Okinawa, Japan**, and **Bitburg, Germany**. [1]

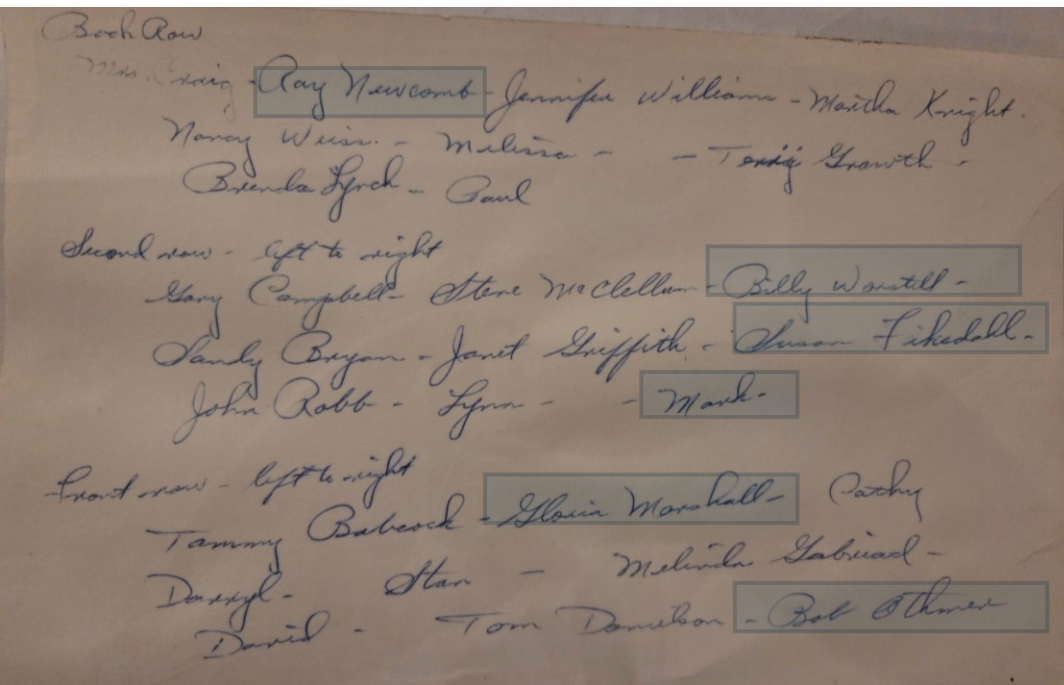
•**Phonics Pioneer:** Later in her career, she helped develop, write, and produce educational phonics teaching tapes and lessons that were distributed and sold nationwide by the Ideal School Supply Company. [1]

•**Community & Faith:** She was a founding charter member of the Country Homes Christian Church in Spokane (established in 1958). Over many decades, she served as their choir director, pianist, organist, and Sunday school teacher. [1]

Obituary Notice

Her official memorial notice was published locally in *The Spokesman-Review*. You can view her full life timeline and read the original tribute text via the [Dorothy Jane Craig Legacy Memorial Page](https://www.legacy.com). [1]

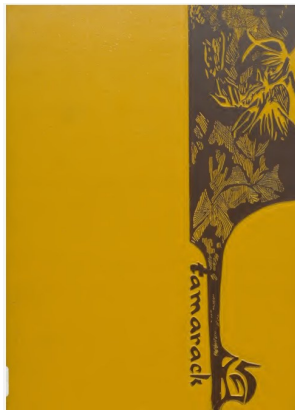
[1] <https://www.legacy.com>





It's the **1965 Tamarack** and a seventh has joined our stalwart six!

Mrs. Briscoe waits for a class response from the students in a question and answer period.



One of my Math teachers from Salk Junior High School, Mr. O'Leary, makes a guest appearance teaching Freshmen.



Who performed at Carnegie Hall?

Theme Song: “I Hear a Symphony”
by the Supremes



I Hear A Symphony

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aKG89jm79kc&list=RD aKG89jm79kc&start_radio=1





1965-1969 Tamaracks

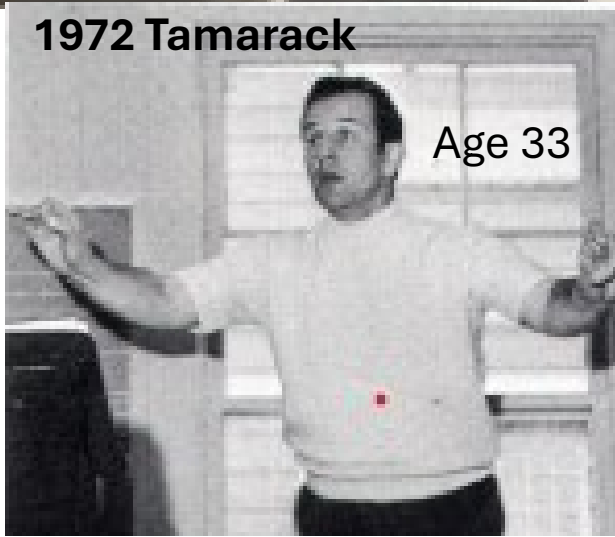
Age 26-30

Who performed at Carnegie Hall?

1974 Tamarack



Age 35



1972 Tamarack

Age 33



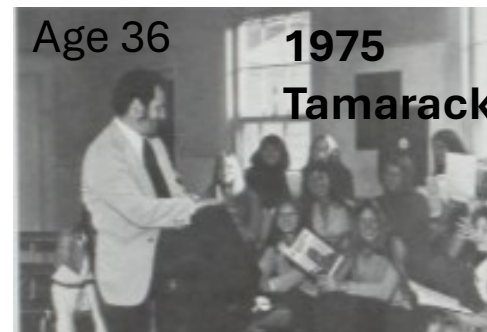
1970 Tamarack

Age 31



**1973
Tamarack**

Age 34



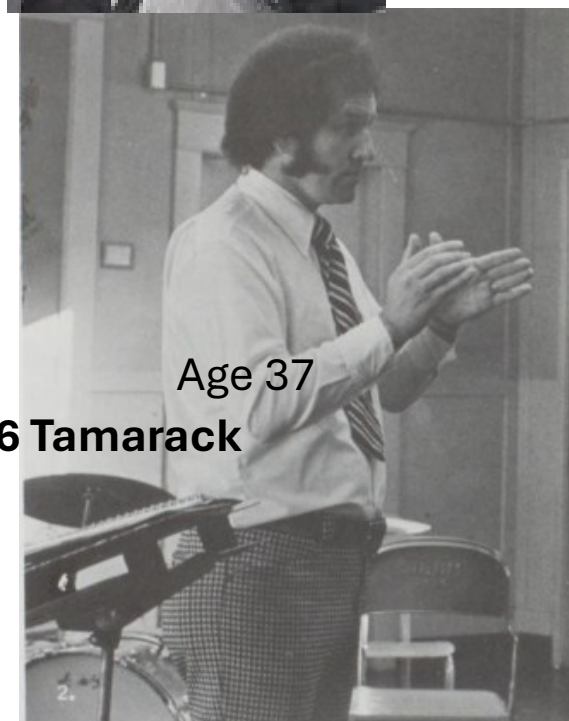
Age 36

**1975
Tamarack**



**1971
Tamarack**

Age 32



Age 37

1976 Tamarack



Michael W. Caldwell was born **June 6, 1939**, in **Wenatchee, Washington**, and died **May 14, 2018**, in Spokane at age 77. His obituary says he graduated from **Wenatchee High School in 1957** and from **Washington State University in 1962**, where he studied music and was active in Theta Xi fraternity; he later earned a master's degree from **Eastern Washington University**.

His teaching career began at **Sumner High School**, but he spent the bulk of his career at **North Central High School**, where he taught **choir and singing for more than 30 years**.

He was also a major presence in Spokane's broader musical life. His obituary says he directed church choirs, directed the **American German Society Choir**, sang with the **Spokane Chorale for 50 years**, performed with the **Spokane Civic Light Opera** and **Spokane City Theater**, helped direct a joint American/Canadian choir for **Expo '74**, and performed at **Carnegie Hall**.

A 1976 University of Idaho Jazz Festival program lists **North Central High School, Spokane, WA — Mike Caldwell** in the vocal jazz ensemble schedule. Later records show that his work continued: a 1991 University of Idaho Jazz Festival program again lists **North Central High School — Mike Caldwell**, and a 1995 *Spokesman-Review* article identifies **music teacher Mike Caldwell of North Central High School** as coordinating the mixed choir for an All-Northwest student performance event.

<https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/spokesman/name/michael-caldwell-obituary?id=16901545>

Who performed at Carnegie Hall?



1. The Primetime Choice (1965): "I Hear a Symphony" by The Supremes

Released in October 1965 on Motown Records, this masterfully structured pop-soul song shot straight to #1 on the Billboard Hot 100.

- The Vibe:** Written by Holland–Dozier–Holland, the track moves away from standard verse-chorus formulas, instead structurally building like a classical symphony with shifting key modulations and multi-layered, intricate backing vocals.

- The Choir Connection:** The song's literal lyrics—associating the overwhelming feeling of love with complex musical arrangements, symphonies, and rhapsodies—makes it a perfect, high-energy homage to a lifelong choir director and classical vocalist.



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OEZ6CwPSy9s&list=RD0EZ6CwPSy9s&start_radio=1

2. The Great Choral Crossover: "Amen" by The Impressions

If you want a 1965 track that leans directly into the rich, traditional vocal blending that Mr. Caldwell taught his students every day, look to Curtis Mayfield and The Impressions' massive hit "**Amen**" (which peaked on the charts in early 1965).

- Why it works:** Styled precisely like a traditional gospel choral piece, it features a solo lead vocalist trading lines with a swelling, layered backing choir. It became a unifying, uplifting anthem across the country that year.



Ives: Symphony No. 4: III. Fugue. Andante moderato con moto

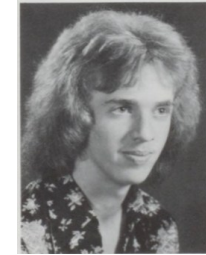
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=s31b8zXc_o0&list=RDs31b8zXc_o0&start_radio=1

3. The Classical Debut Nod: "Symphony No. 4" / The Leopold Stokowski Vibe

For a fun historical crossover, April 26, 1965 marked one of the most famous avant-garde events in Carnegie Hall's history: the world premiere of Charles Ives's incredibly complex *Symphony No. 4*, performed by Leopold Stokowski and the American Symphony Orchestra. Including a stylistic nod to mid-60s orchestral or chamber vocal recordings captures the high-caliber academic classical world Mr. Caldwell operated in.



Second Grade 1966 ~8 years old



Ray Newcomb



Mark Sutton



Jeff Funk



Mark Sutton



Bill Worstell



Gloria Marshall



Susie Fiksdahl



Joni Butler



No info found on Mrs. Bennett

Left to right
Top Row - Keith G. - Sandy Bryan - Mike Lewis -
Nancy Weir - Gary Campbell - Terry Smith
Ray Newcomb - Martha Knight - Mrs. Bennett
Middle Row - Jeff Funk - Betty Hille - Timmy Brown -
Barbara Sue Shawman - Terry Bowler - Mark Sutton -
Steve McClann - Billy Worstell - Brad Hunt
Bottom Row - Brenda Gabriel - Stan Bunker - Gloria Marshall -
Tom Danilson - Shirley - Tammy Balcock -
Susan Lakstall - Joan Butler - Jennifer Williams



Age 45

Mr. Rodkey, Principal,

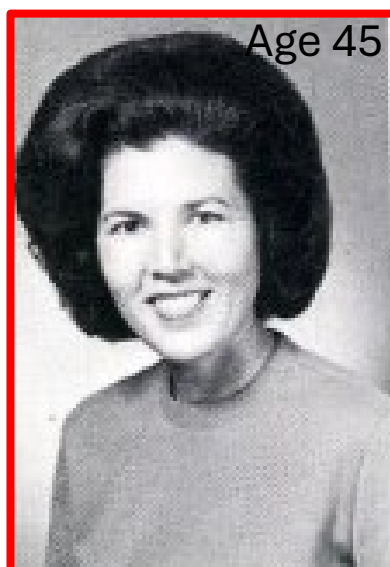


Age 27

Michael Caldwell
Music Production

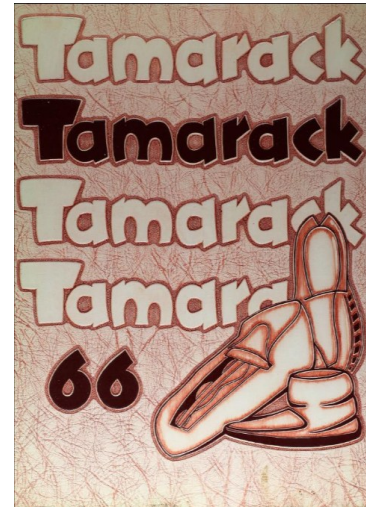


Age 28



Age 45

It's the **1966 Tamarack** and two new faces have joined the team! Mr. Ericksen helps out his substitute while he convalesces.



Age 43



Burrill Exley
Department Head

Age 37



Raymond Simonson
Boys' Golf Coach

Raymond Simonson

Age <40



William Nye
After-school Bowling

Age 50



Orval Theisen
Senior Class Advisor
S.E.A. Representative

Age 49



Laura Briscoe
Latin Club



Age 49

Mrs. Evans confers with Mr. Erickson on the material she is teaching for him while he convalesces.

1966

Tamarack

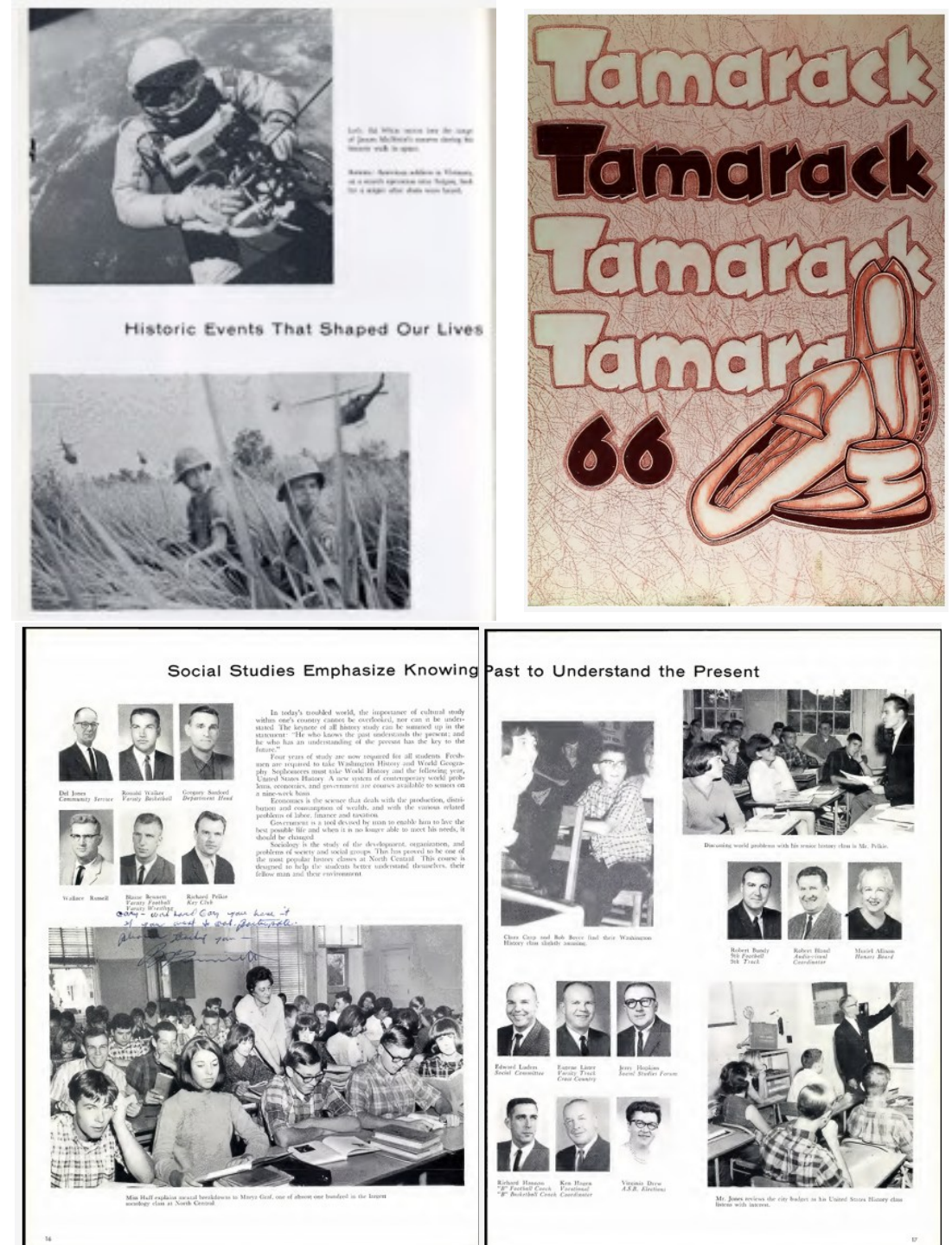
Who was president of the Spokane Education Association, and ran for the State Legislature?

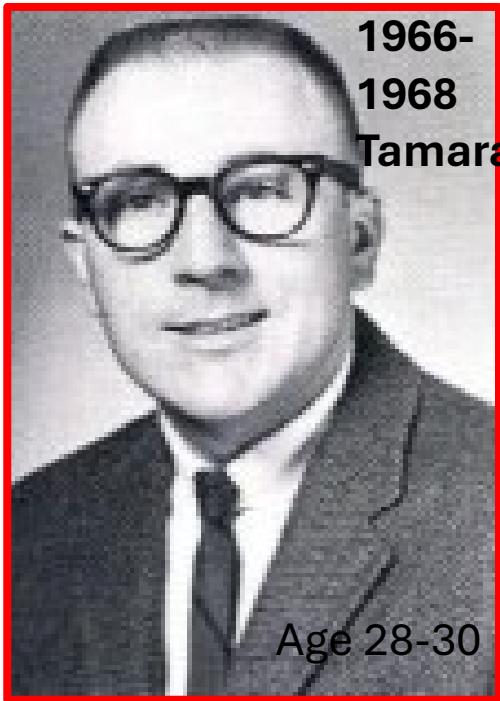
Theme Song: “A Change is Gonna Come” sung by Aretha Franklin, written by Sam Cooke 1964



Aretha Franklin - A Change Is Gonna Come

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=k6YCxXQ6Scw>





1966-
1968
Tamarack

Age 28-30



Age 31

1969
Tamarack



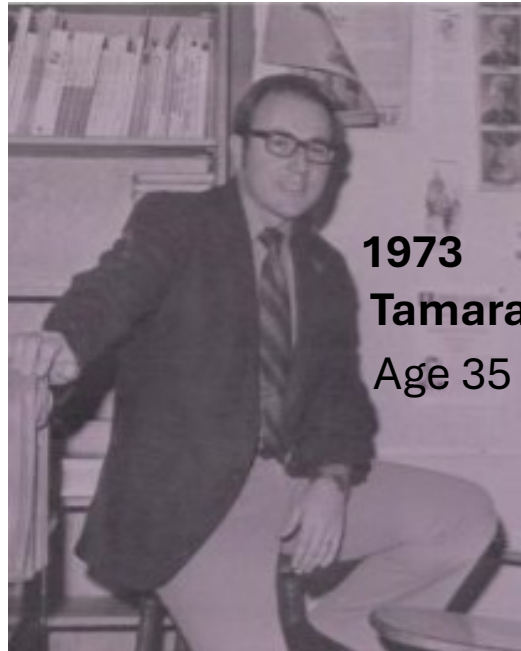
1970
Tamarack
Age 32



1971 Tamarack
Age 33



1972 Tamarack Age 34



1973
Tamarack
Age 35



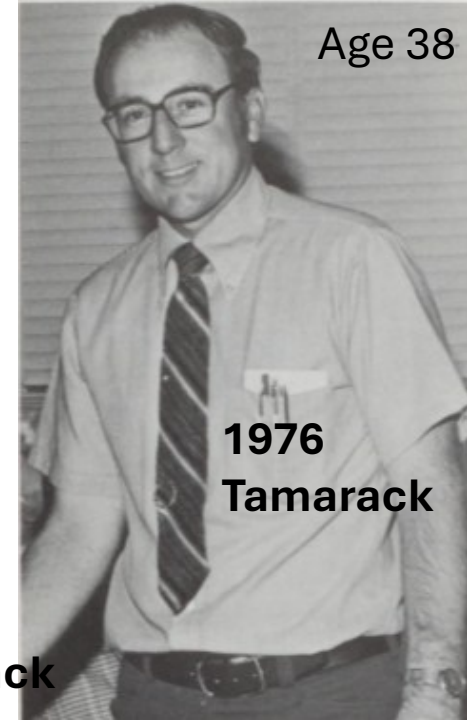
1974
Tamarack

Age 36
Age 36



Age 37

1975
Tamarack

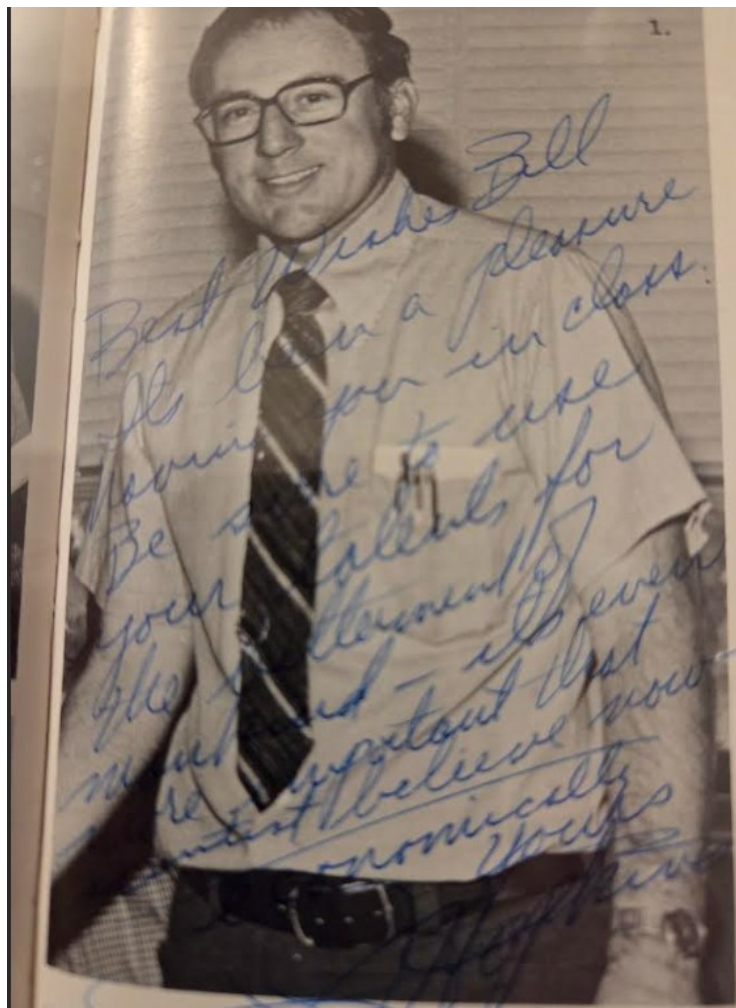


Age 38

1976
Tamarack



Jerry Hopkins
Social Studies Forum



Jerry Hopkins was a longtime North Central social studies teacher. In 1996, *The Spokesman-Review* described him as age **58**, raised on a farm in Eastern Washington, and having moved to Spokane in **1965**. That same profile says he taught **economics, world affairs, and social studies at North Central High School for 27 years. Current Age 88?**

His later public résumé adds that he had **bachelor's and master's degrees in education from Eastern Washington University**, administrative credentials from **Whitworth College**, and six years in the **Air Force Reserve**. It also says he had recently retired as president of the **Spokane Education Association**, had served **10 years on the Spokane City Park Board**, and was a member of the **Spokane Area Empowerment Committee**. <https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1996/oct/27/jerry-hopkins-d>

The 1967 *Tamarack* confirms him in the North Central faculty record as **Jerry Hopkins — Social Studies**, associated with **Social Studies Forum** and **ASB Committee**. A 1996 letter to the editor describes him as having “recently retired after **30 years as a teacher and social studies department chairman at North Central High School**” and as president of the Spokane Education Association for the previous year. That slightly differs from the newspaper candidate profiles’ “27 years,” but both agree on a long NC career ending around 1996.

<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1996/sep/12/letters-to-the-editor>

He also ran for the Washington State Legislature in **1996** as a Democrat in the **6th District, Position 2**. *The Spokesman-Review* covered the primary and general election; the general election report described him as the former president of the Spokane Education Association and showed him trailing Republican Duane Sommers.

https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1996/sep/19/lets-shoestring-caign-appears-to-have-won/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

Best Wishes Bill,
It's been a pleasure
having you in class.
Be sure to use your
talents for the
betterment of
mankind – it's ever
more important that
a scientist believe
now.
Economically yours,
J. Hopkins

Who was a head of the NC Drama Department, back when it had one?

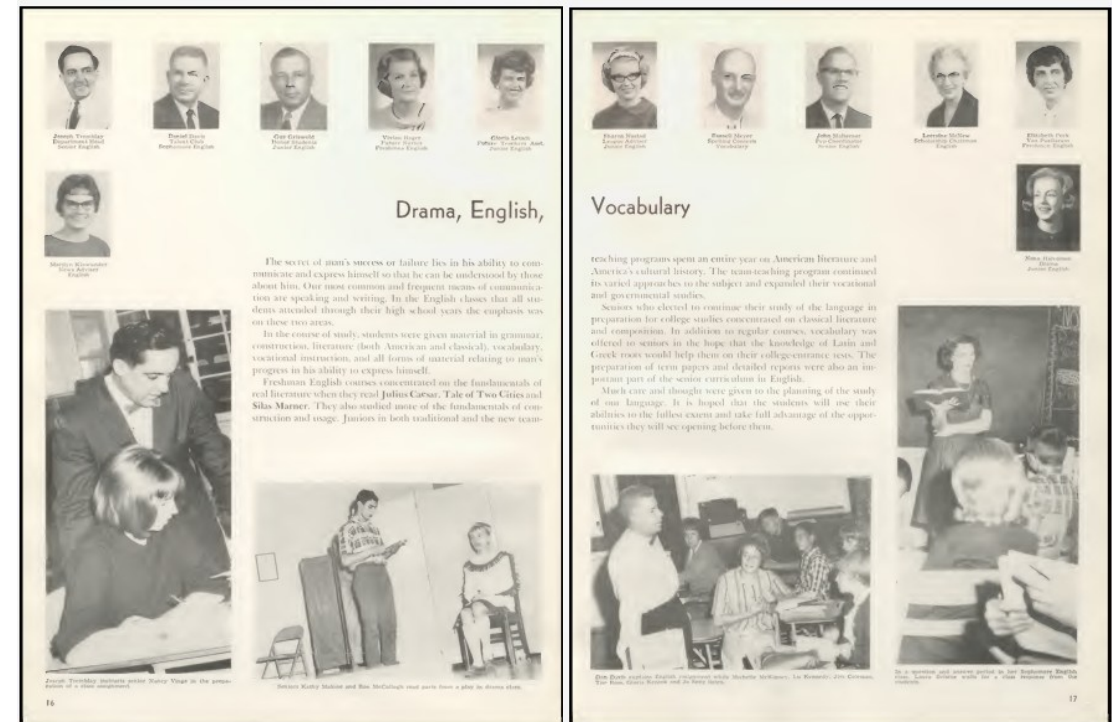
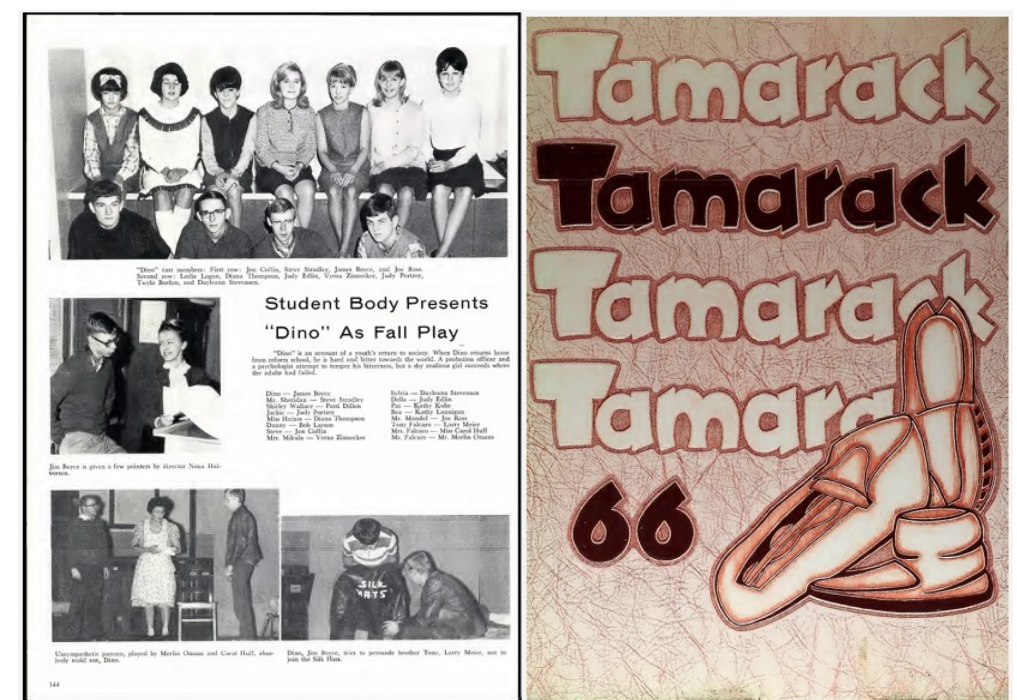
Theme
Song:
“Wouldn’t
It Be Nice”
by the
Beach
Boys

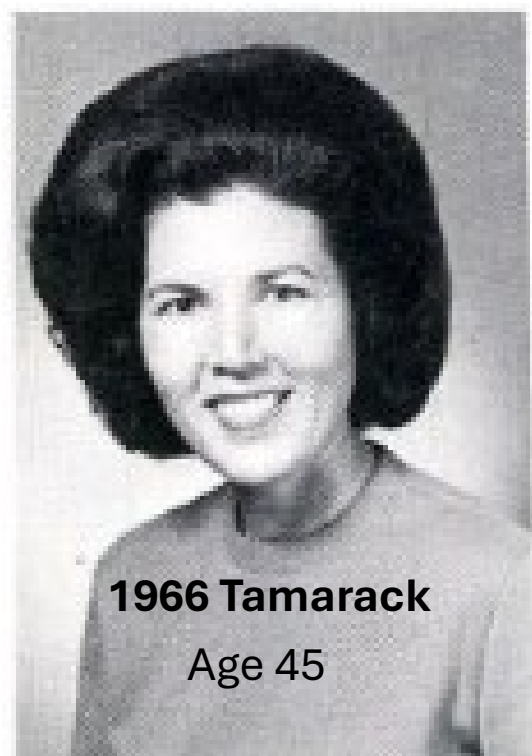


Play K

Wouldn't It Be Nice

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6Vv_dkDwZeQ&list=RD6Vv_dkDwZeQ&start_radio=1

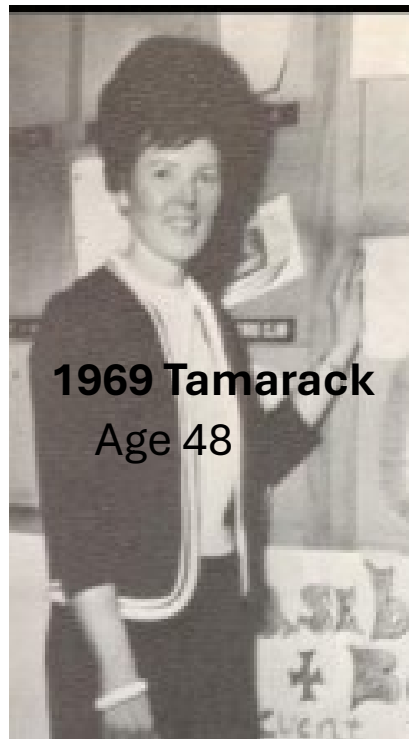




1966 Tamarack
Age 45



Age 46-47
1967- 1968
Tamarack



1969 Tamarack
Age 48



1970 Tamarack

Age 49

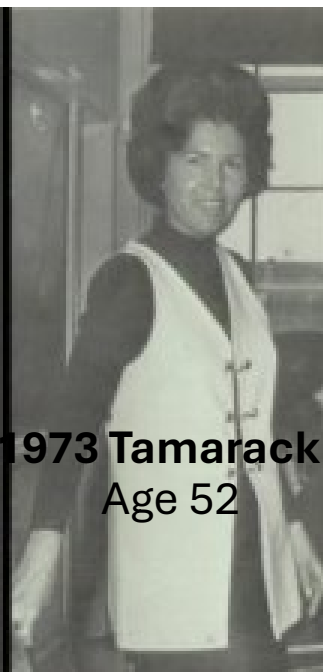


1971
Tamarack

Age 50



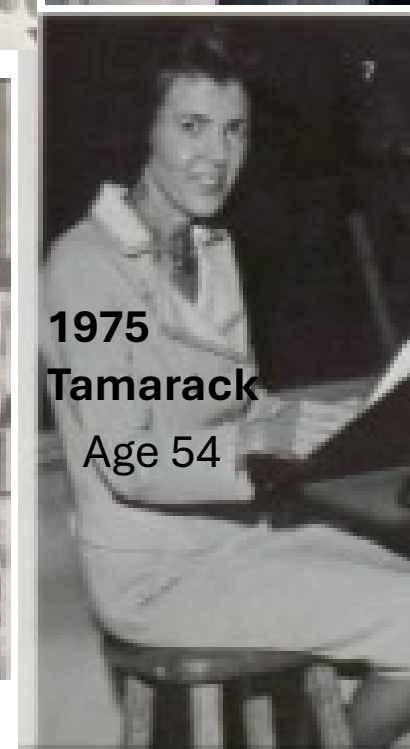
1972 Tamarack
Age 51



1973 Tamarack
Age 52



1974 Tamarack Age 53



1975
Tamarack
Age 54



1976 Tamarack
Age 55



Dorothy Murray
Girls' League

Age 44 in 1965



Age 55 in 1976



[https://obits.oregonlive.com/us/obituaries/oregon/name/donald-howard-and-dorothy-elliott-murray-
obituary?id=19666674](https://obits.oregonlive.com/us/obituaries/oregon/name/donald-howard-and-dorothy-elliott-murray-obituary?id=19666674)

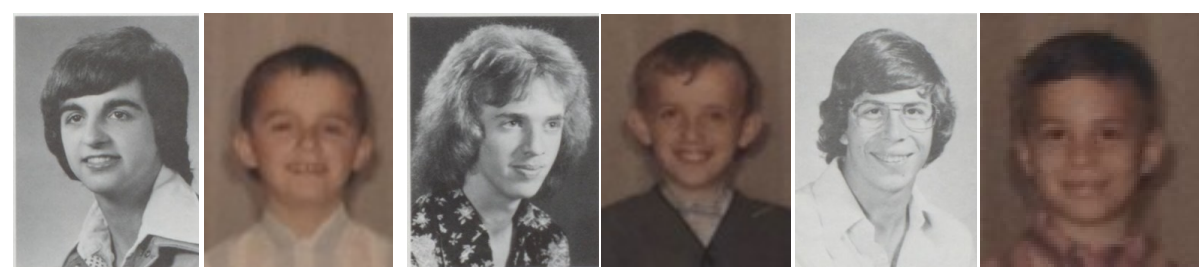
Dorothy Mae Elliott Murray died on **March 2, 2004**, at age **83**, the same day as her husband, **Donald Howard Murray**, who was 84. Your notes correctly capture the striking shared obituary: Donald had been his wife's primary caregiver during her later health difficulties, and the couple had been married for about 60 years. Her obituary says she grew up in **Colfax, Washington**, began musical training at age 8, and graduated from **Washington State University** with a degree in **music**. She was classically trained as a **concert pianist** and later earned teaching credentials. During World War II, while Donald was away, she taught **music appreciation**; after the war the couple moved to Spokane to raise their family.

Her North Central connection is very well documented in the obituary: she taught **English at North Central High School for many years** and was also **head of the drama department**. The obituary gives a lovely classroom detail: every Monday, Donald had a flower delivered to her classroom. It also describes her as a teacher with a "fierce love of language" and a passion for teaching, remembered warmly by peers and students.

In the **1965 *Tamarack***, she is shown as **Dorothy Murray — Girls' League**, and by the **1976 *Tamarack*** she appears in the English department context. The 1976 North Central yearbook OCR also includes "**Dorothy Murray-advisor**" in a club/adviser listing.

Her obituary also emphasizes her lifelong intellectual and artistic life: she continued to read, play piano, and write letters to children, grandchildren, and friends despite serious physical difficulties later in life. It lists affiliations including **Rainbow, Beta Beta Chapter of Chi Omega**, and **Mu Phi Epsilon**, the honorary music society.

Homeroom,
Vocabulary,
and Reader's Theater



Mark Sutton

Ray Newcomb

Bill Worstell



Jeff Funk

Nancy England

Tom Orth



Joni Butler

Susie Fiksdahl

Third Grade
1967
~9 years old

RM. E 3 RD. GRADE - LINWOOD SCHOOL - APRIL 1967 CHATEAU

1. <u>Tim Brown</u>	2. <u>Richard McCracken</u>	3. <u>Crenda Lynch</u>	4. <u>Russell Kagan</u>
5. <u>Mark Sutton</u>	6. <u>Garry W.C.</u>	7. <u>Jenny Williams</u>	8. <u>Ray Newcomb</u>
9. <u>Billy Worstell</u>	10. <u>Terry Barden</u>	11. <u>Brad Worsham</u>	12. <u>Bobby</u>
13. <u>Betsy R.</u>	14. <u>Jeff Funk</u>	15. <u>Brad Hall</u>	16. <u>Nancy</u>
17. <u>Tom Orth</u>			18. <u>Sandy</u>
19. <u>Joni Butler</u>			20. <u>Susie</u>
21. <u>Susan B.</u>			22. <u>Gloria</u>
23. <u>Belinda</u>			24. <u>Miss Maddux</u>
25. <u>Sandy Hildner</u>			
26. _____			
27. _____			
28. _____			
29. _____			
30. _____			
31. _____			

Autographs

No info found on Miss Maddux



Age 46

Dorothy Murray
English
Vox Puellarum



Age 29

Jerry Hopkins
Social Studies
Social Studies
Forum
ASB Committee



Age 44

Burrill Exley
Mathematics
Department Head
Scholarship
Committee



Age 33

It's the **1967 Tamarack** and a new face has joined the team! Mrs. Murray is rockin' the 1967 big hair.

Mr. Rodkey is entertaining guests from Japan, and Mr. Theisen is handling dangerous acid.



Age 46

Presenting Mr. Rodkey (center) with a gift from our Japanese sister city, Nishinomiya, are Mr. Kobayashi, vice chief supervisor of the Nishinomiya Educational Board, and Mr. Inuki, principal of our sister high school, who spent some time during October visiting Spokane schools.



Age <411

William Nye
Mathematics
Equipment
Manager



Age 38

Raymond Simonson
Science



Age 51

Orval Theisen
Science
Sr. Class Advisor
Scholarship
Committee



Age 50

Laura Lee
Briscoe
Language Arts
Latin Club



Age 50

Norman Erickson
Business
Education
Junior Homeroom
Chairman



Age 28

Michael Caldwell
Music
Music Productions
Ensembles



Age 51

"Now, how will this experiment turn out?" wonder Skip Garrett and Mike Albee, as Orval Theisen adds acid to the mixture.

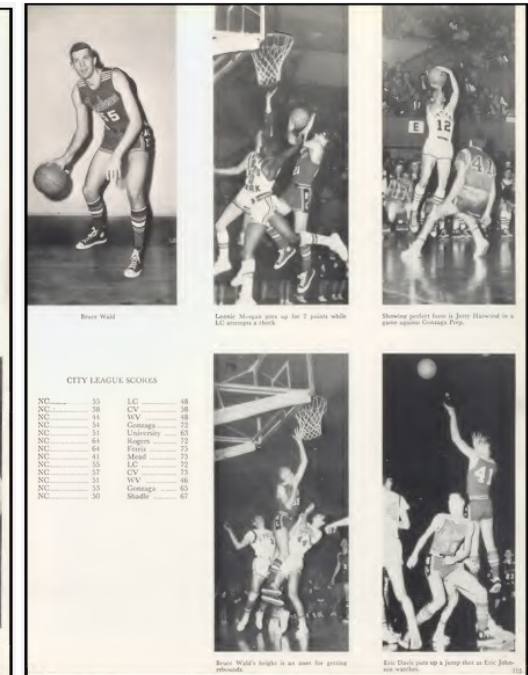
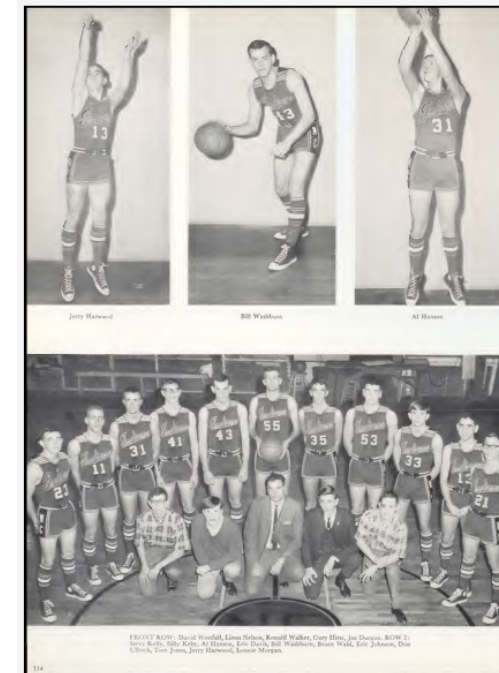
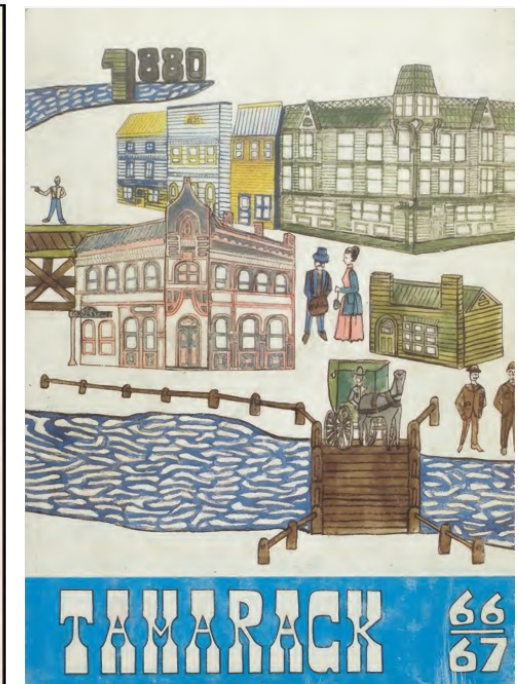
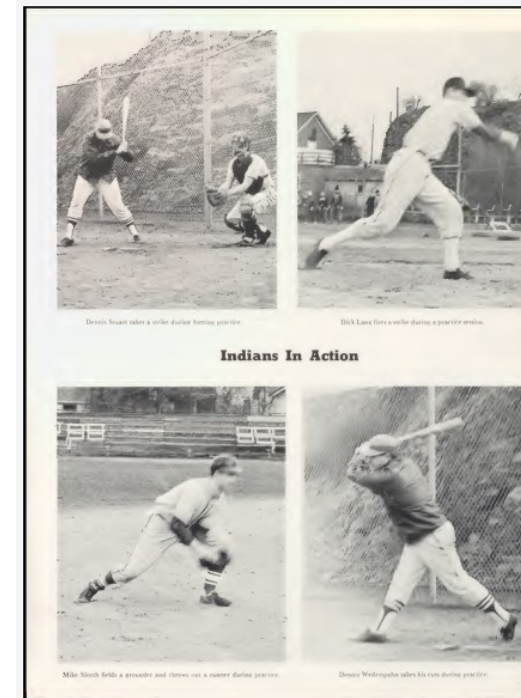
Who was one of the only set of three brothers to ever play basketball for the Zags, and he also played baseball for four years at Gonzaga?

Theme Song: “Sweet Soul Music”
by Arthur Conley



Sweet Soul Music

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SaphQafq3NQ&list=RD_SaphQafq3NQ&start_radio=1



1969 Tamarack



**1967-1968
Tamaracks**
Age
33-34



1970 Tamarack

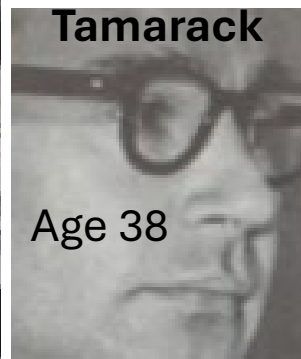


1971 Tamarack



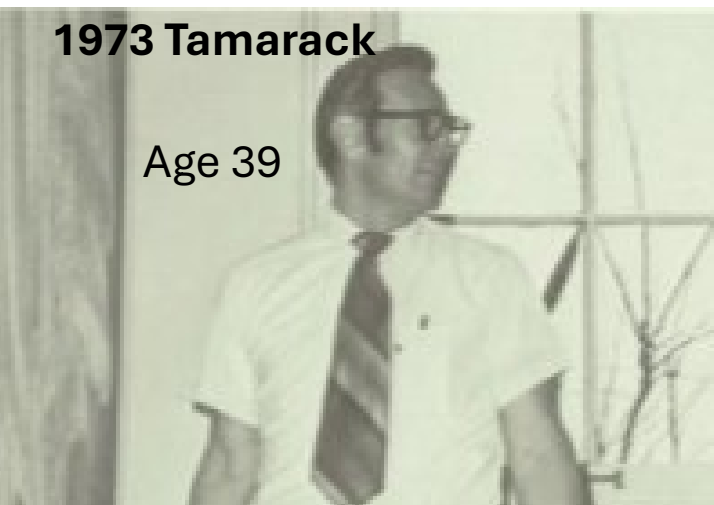
1972 Tamarack

1972



Age 38

1973 Tamarack

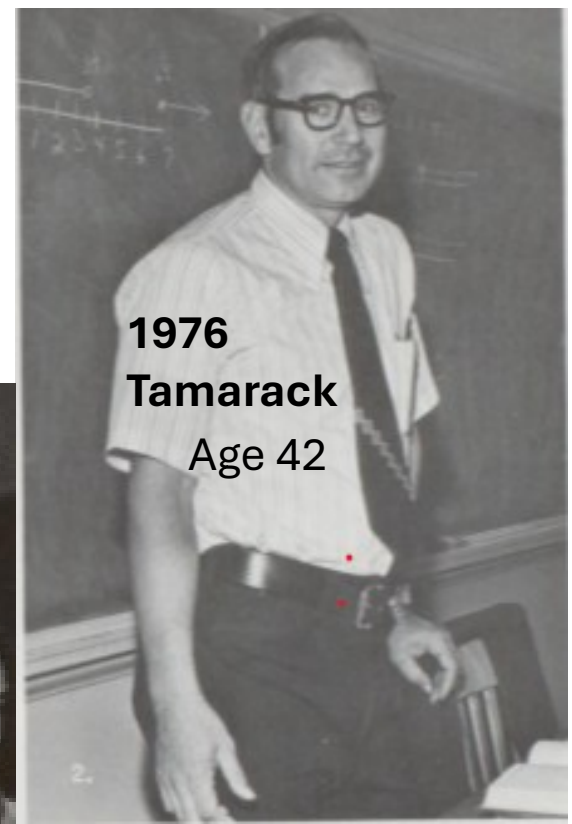


1974 Tamarack

Age 40



Age 41

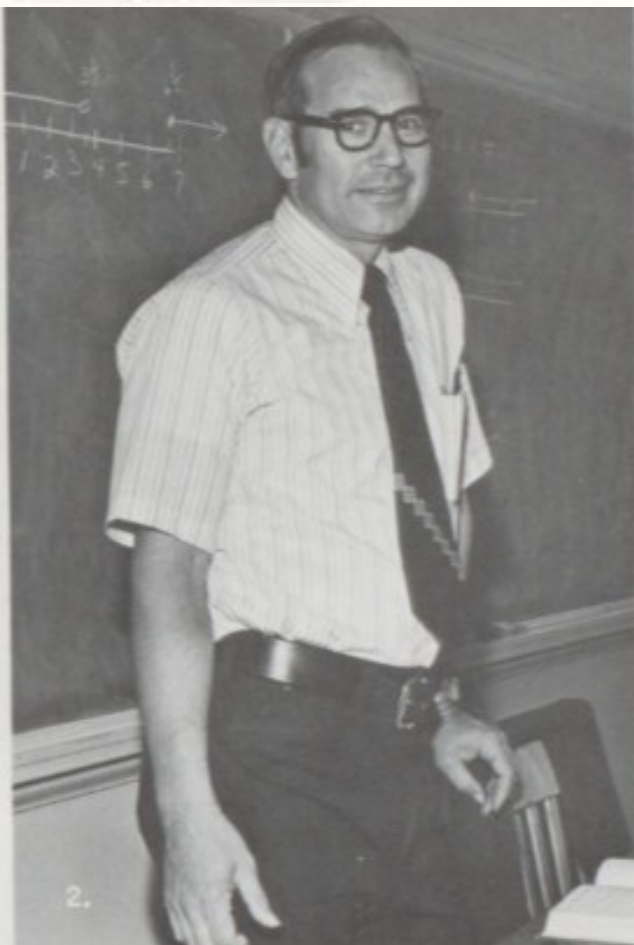


Age 42



Age 33 in 1967

Joe Schauble
Mathematics
Fresh Football



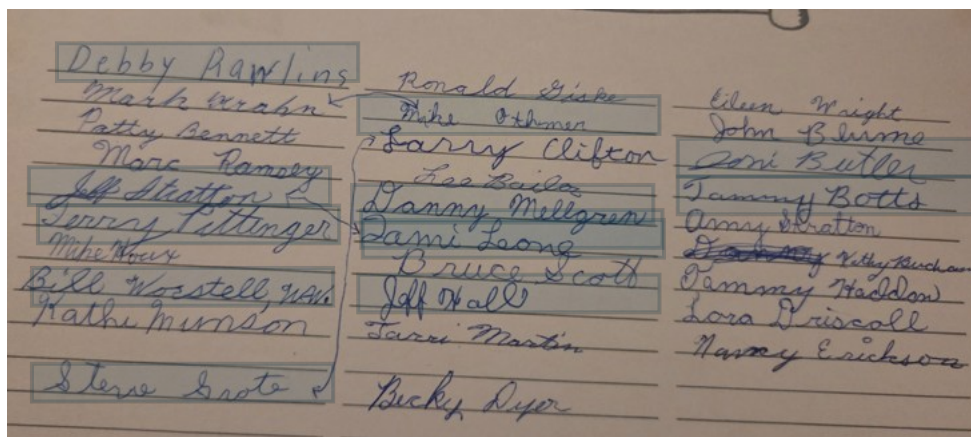
Age 42
in 1976

Joseph J. / Joseph Juneau Schauble was born **June 14, 1934**, in **Killdeer, North Dakota**, and died peacefully at home on **February 7, 2024**, at age **89**. His family moved from North Dakota to **St. John, Washington**, in 1937, where he grew up. https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/spokesman/name/joseph-schauble-obituary?id=54344483&utm_source=chatgpt.com

He attended **Gonzaga University** on a partial basketball scholarship and graduated in **1956**. His obituary notes that he and his older brothers **Bill** and **Rollin** were the only set of three brothers to play basketball for the Zags, and that Joe also played baseball for four years.

Professionally, he was both a **math teacher and coach**. His obituary says he taught for **38 years**, with the final **30 years at North Central High School**, retiring in **1996**. He earned a master's degree in school administration, but apparently preferred the classroom and court to administration.

His coaching career was unusually broad. A 1996 *Spokesman-Review* retirement article says that after **43 years of coaching**, Schauble had reached “the finish line” of that career. The same article describes him as versatile, noting that he coached across multiple sports and levels, served as co-director of Gonzaga summer sports camps for eight years, and worked for 11 years as a Spokane Parks Department recreational leader coaching baseball teams. https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1996/jul/04/north-central-coach-retires-after-varied-career/?utm_source=chatgpt.com



Public historical and obituary records confirm that your fourth grade teacher from **Linwood Elementary School** was **Esther Selena Halliwell Gibeault**. [1]

Biography & Life Summary

•**Lifespan:** June 14, 1917 – November 30, 2021. She lived to be **104 years old**. [2]

•**Career:** She was a dedicated career educator and taught fourth grade at Linwood Elementary School for many years. In guestbook memories, former students from both the early 1960s and your late 1960s era remembered her fondly as a deeply inspiring teacher who motivated many of them to pursue careers in education themselves. []

•**Advocacy & Affiliations:** Outside of the classroom, she was a passionate feminist, a voracious reader, and an active leader in the community. She was notably active in the American Association of University Women (AAUW) Spokane Branch, where she advocated for establishing community-focused educational funds. [1, 2]

•**Family:** She was preceded in death by her husband, Arthur Gibeault. She left behind a family that included her children (such as Paul and Karen Gibeault), grandchildren (like Chrissie Beavis Johnson), and great-grandchildren. [1, 2]

Obituary and Tributes

Her official obituary notice was published in *The Spokesman-Review*. You can view her memorial timeline, share your memories, or read tributes left by other former Linwood students on the [Esther Gibeault Legacy Memorial Page](#). []



Age 51

Briscoe, Laura Lee
Language Arts
Foreign Language
Latin Club



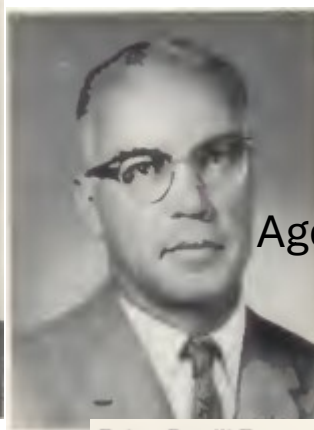
Age 29

Caldwell, Michael
Music
Music Productions
Ensembles



Age 51

Erickson, Norman W.
Business Education



Age 45

Exley, Burrill D.
Mathematics
Department Head



Age 37



Age 38



Age 30

Hopkins, Jerry
Social Studies
ASB



Age 47

Murray, Dorothy
Language Arts
Vox Puellarum



Age 39

Schauble, Joseph J.
Mathematics
Frosh Football



Simonson, Raymond W.
Science
Junior Class



Theisen, Orval P.
Science
Senior Class
Advisor

It's the **1968 Tamarack** and our team
has three new additions! Can you
guess who?



Age 29



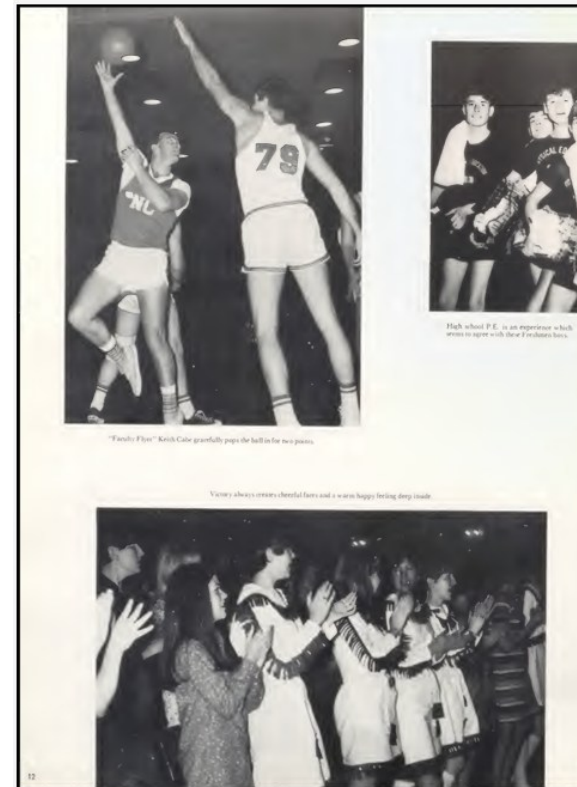
Who played college basketball at both the University of Washington and at Gonzaga?

Theme Song: “Born to be Wild” by Steppenwolf



Steppenwolf - Born to Be Wild (2023 Remaster)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KVvidKyTwB8&list=RDKVvidKyTwB8&start_radio=1



1968 Tamarack



Age 38

1969 Tamarack



Age 39

1970 Tamarack



Age 40

1971 Tamarack



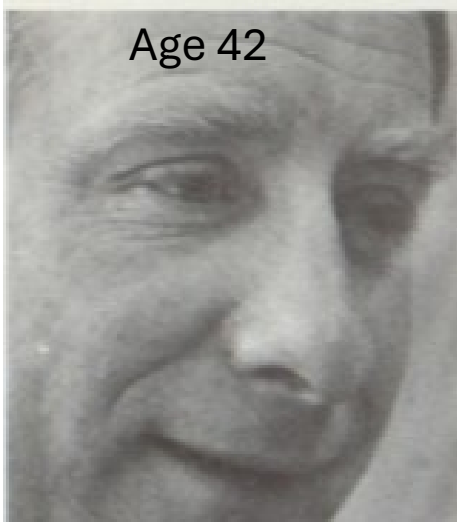
Age 41

1972 Tamarack



Age 42

1972 Tamarack



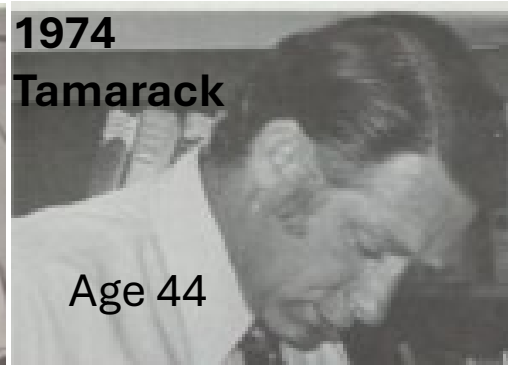
Age 42

1973 Tamarack



Age 43

1974 Tamarack

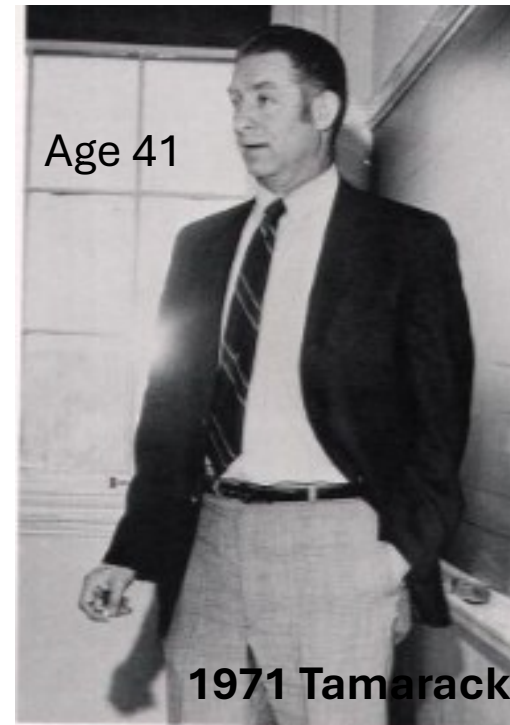


Age 44



Age 45

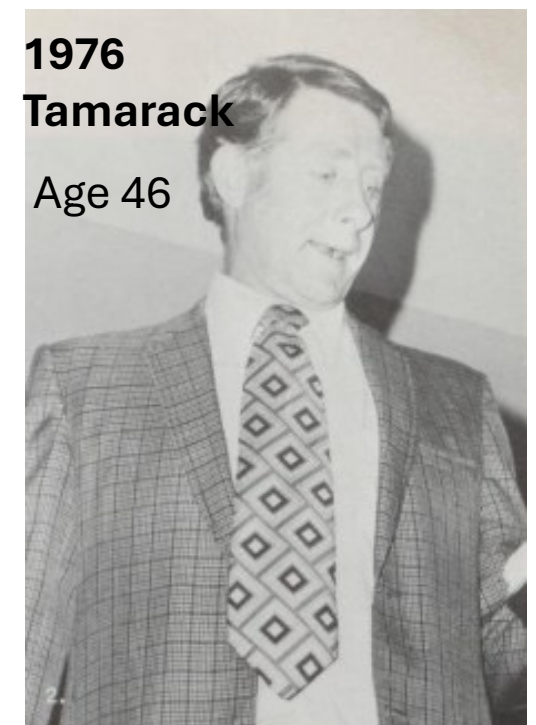
1975 Tamarack



Age 41

1971 Tamarack

1976 Tamarack



Age 46



Age 38
in 1968

https://www.pnwcremation.com/obituaries/George-Chalich?obId=2912317&utm_source=chatgpt.com

Who played college basketball at both the University of Washington and at Gonzaga?

George Chalich was born **March 23, 1930**, in **Butte, Montana**, and died **January 15, 2017**, in **Spokane Valley, Washington**, at age 86. His family moved to the Spokane Valley in 1938, and he attended Vera Grade School and **Central Valley High School**, where he competed in football, basketball, track, and baseball.

He was an outstanding athlete. His obituary says he was a first-team all-league basketball player as a sophomore, junior, and senior, led the league in scoring twice, and later played college basketball at both the **University of Washington** and **Gonzaga University**. He also walked on to the University of Washington baseball team and was offered a professional contract with the Seattle Rainiers, but chose to finish his degree.

Professionally, he taught and coached for **28 years** at **Oakesdale, Mead, and North Central High Schools**. His obituary includes the memorable line that he said he “**taught life**,” which would make a very good reunion-slide phrase. The 1968 North Central *Tamarack* confirms him in the NC faculty record as **George Chalich — Social Studies**, with **B-Squad Football** and **B-Squad Basketball**.



Age 46
in 1976

https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2012/sep/11/mom-had-their-backs/?utm_source=chatgpt.com

His sports life continued well beyond school coaching. He officiated college-level baseball and basketball, including Pac-8 basketball, and officiated throughout the Inland Northwest at high-school and youth levels for about **40 years**. He also played AAU basketball and softball with the Spokane Diesel team and remained active in golf. A 2017 *Spokesman-Review* column by John Blanchette remembered him as one of Spokane’s “heart-and-soul” sports figures, someone widely known in the local athletic community even if not always formally labeled an icon. Another *Spokesman-Review* piece from 2012, when he was being recognized on Central Valley’s Wall of Fame, described the Chalich siblings as a major athletic family in the Valley and noted that George had been a four-year, four-sport letter winner at Central Valley.

Coach Chalich ran US History fact drills like they were wind sprints, and it was good preparation for High School Bowl as it turned out – Harvard too.

Who taught Humanities as one of a set of new classes introduced in 1970 at NC?

Theme Song: "Classical Gas" by Mason Williams



Mason Williams - Classical Gas - ORIGINAL STEREO VERSION

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KVvidKyTwB8&list=RDKVvidKyTwB8&start_radio=1

Mrs. Yvonne Carter and Mr. Edward Luders are seen teaching Humanities, one of the new classes introduced this year to North Central.



"Ideas of March" Highlights Year
The proper name for what is commonly known as Little Club is *Seniors Populorum Romanorum*, or the *Seniors and the Roman People*. To become a *senior*, a student must have a year or more of Latin and a GPA of 2.5.
The club's annual "Ideas of March" luncheon consisted of the *Seniors* members dressing in togas, a dinner of Roman food and a play performed by the members. With the help of their faculty adviser, Mrs. Laura Lee Benson, the club worked on increasing the members' knowledge of Latin and its origin.

Spring officers were Tim Caron, Karen Propp, Michele Carpen, Debbie Larkin, and Lisa.



Art Club Holds Joint Installation

This year, Art Club, carried out their installation in a new way: making it a dinner meeting with the Shadle Park Club. This gave both schools a chance to exchange their artistic ideas and get acquainted.

The main project for Art Club is the production of the mural on the side of the band room.



"Mollie Morgan" Produced by Thespians

At the first of the year Thespians produced the play "Mollie Morgan" by John Steinbeck. Following the initiation everyone went to see the play "Antonia" at the Civic Theatre.

Kathy Fisher, Carol McGik, and Nancy Huse discuss plans for their new meeting.



1968 Tamarack



Age 37

1969 Tamarack



Age 38

1970 Tamarack



Age 39

1971 Tamarack



Age 40

1972 Tamarack



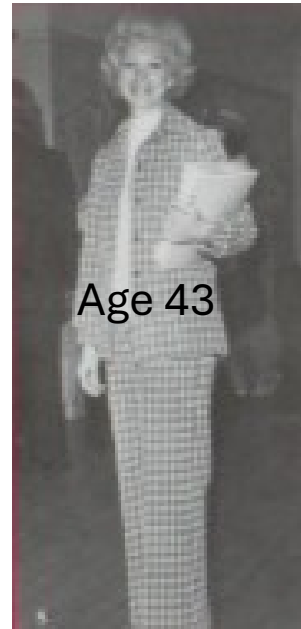
Age 41

1973 Tamarack



Age 42

1974 Tamarack



Age 43

1975 Tamarack



Age 44

1976 Tamarack Age 45



Who taught Humanities as one of a set of new classes introduced in 1970 at NC?



Age 37
in 1968

<https://www.dignitymemorial.com/obituaries/spokane-wa/yvonne-edmunds-4509346>



Age 45
in 1976

She got remarried during our graduation year of 1976...

Yvonne L. Edmunds, formerly **Yvonne Carter**, was born **November 19, 1931**, in **Eugene, Oregon**, and died **January 4, 2011**, in Spokane at age 79. Her obituary says her family moved to Spokane shortly before she entered high school at **Lewis and Clark High School**. She attended **Washington State University** for one year before marrying her first husband, **Vernon Carter**.

After time on a farm in **Spangle, Washington**, and then back in Spokane, she resumed college studies at **Eastern Washington University** in 1964 and was the **outstanding graduate in the English department** three years later. She then taught **English and Humanities at North Central High School for 18 years**.

The 1970 *Tamarack* identifies **Mrs. Yvonne Carter** and **Mr. Edward Luders** as teaching **Humanities**, described as one of the new classes introduced that year at North Central. Her obituary also notes that she was active in both the **Spokane Education Association** and **Washington Education Association** during her teaching career.

She divorced in 1970 and, in 1976, married **Allan C. "Ace" Edmunds**, a retired Air Force brigadier general and Spokane civic figure. Alan Edmunds's obituary also confirms that he and **Yvonne Carter** married in Spokane in 1976 and lived there for 34 years. After retiring from teaching, Yvonne had a second career in **real estate**.

Who visited every continent except Antarctica, and introduced International Week as an NC Tradition?

Theme Song: “Oye Como Va” by Carlos Santana



Santana - Oye Como Va (Official Audio)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J7ATTjg7tpE&list=RDJ7ATTjg7tpE&start_radio=1



From Row: Doug Thompson, Cheryl Wunderlich, Russ Bensch, Sue Saling, Dave Waddell, Shirley Brown, Larry Ross, Sue Blum, Walter Cane, Row 2: Karl Ford, Denise Mitchell, Denise Wroble, Jose Vaughn, Carlos Cane, Jill Fink, Nana Kelle, Trudi Larson, Merry Simpson, Thelma Gaudin, Row 3: Cheryl Strong, Jackie Lindner, Sally Burns, Pat White, Jackie Becker, Nadine

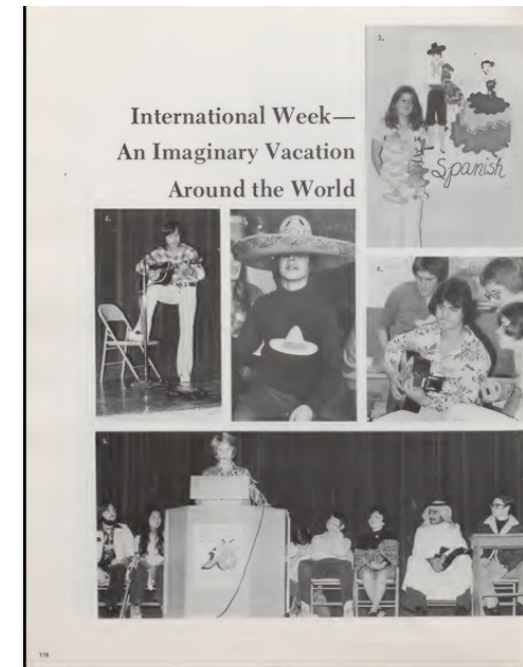
International Club

International Club is composed of the German, French and Spanish components of our foreign languages. The club was organized in 1962 to promote further interest in the foreign language field and was guided throughout the year by Mrs. Lynette McGarry, faculty adviser.

Officers were, Front Row: Dave Waddell, Back Row: Vivian Houston, Charlene Borch and Carolyn Coney



Cheryl Wunderlich gives important instructions to new members



From our 1976 Tamarack ->



1968 Tamarack

Age 29

1970 Tamarack



Age 31

1974 Tamarack



Age 35

1971 Tamarack



Age 32

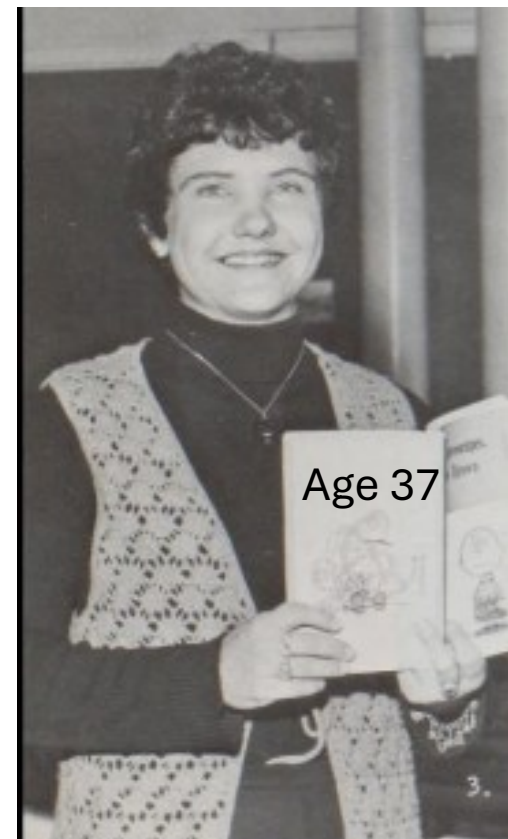
1972 Tamarack Age 33



1975 Tamarack Age 36



**1976
Tamarack**



Age 37

1973 Tamarack
Age 34





Age 29
in 1968

<https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/spokesman/name/zoe-mcgarry-obituary?id=28474323>

The full name appears to be **Zoe Lynette McGarry**, born **Zoe Lynette Squires**. She seems to have gone professionally by **Lynette McGarry**, which matches the *Tamarack* captions.

Zoe Lynette McGarry (Squires) died on **October 29, 2009**, after a brief illness, at age **70**. Her obituary describes her as a Spanish and French teacher whose love of travel helped shape her career. It says she taught for many years in Spokane at **Lewis & Clark, North Central, and Shadle Park High Schools**, and also taught abroad in **Liberia** and **Singapore**.

Her education record appears to include a **1961 University of Idaho degree**, where the commencement program lists **Zoe Lynette Squires, Buhl, cum laude**. A 1963 LSU thesis record lists **Zoe Lynette Squires** as author of *An Analysis of the Psychological Novels of Augustin Yáñez*, which fits a Spanish-language/literature teacher.

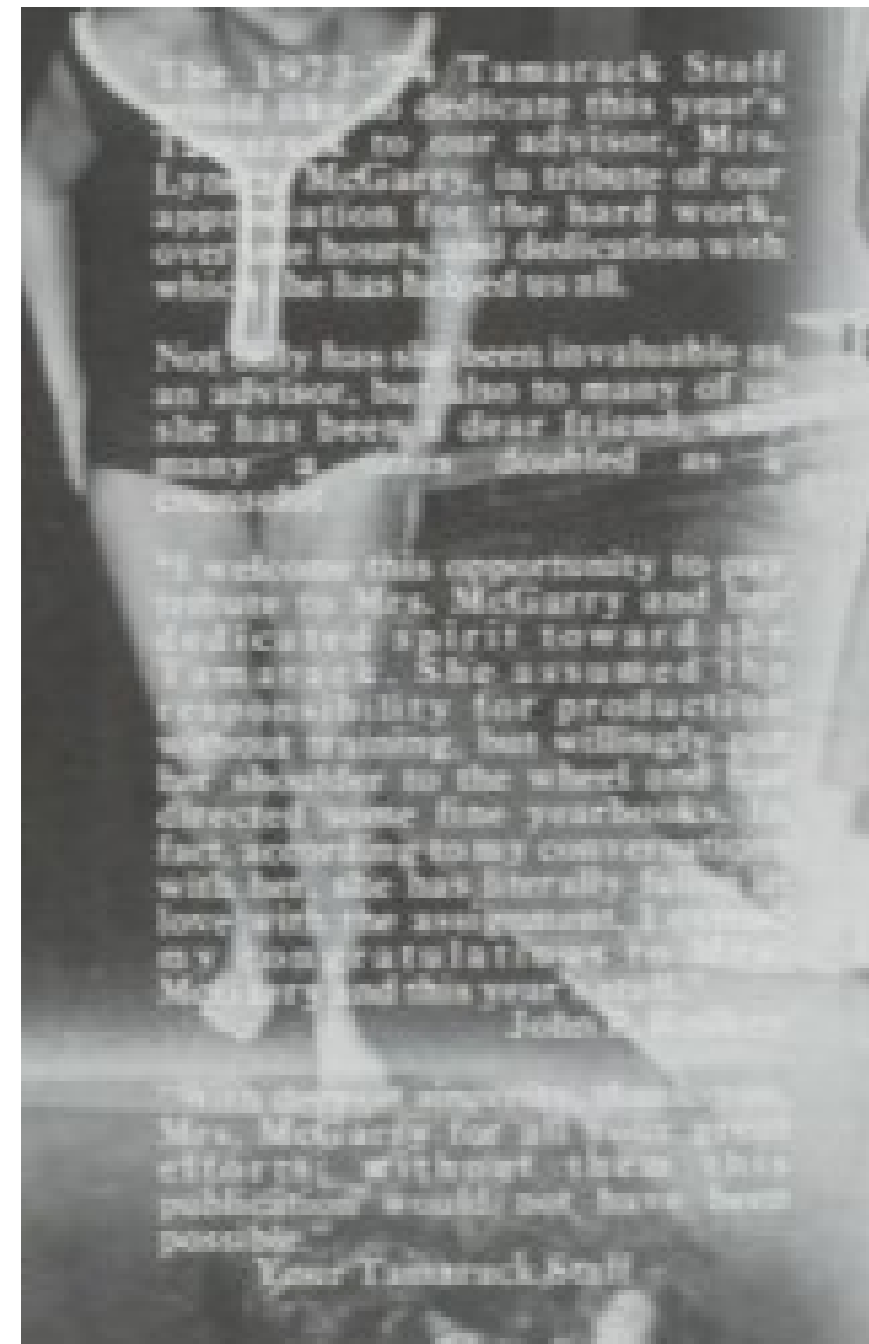


Age 37
in 1976

https://books.google.com/books/about/An_Analysis_of_the_Psychological_Novels.html?id=_65BzwEACAAJ&utm_source=chatgpt.com

The 1967 *Tamarack* lists **Lynette McGarry** in **Language Arts / International Club** contexts, and the 1968 *Tamarack* identifies her as a **faculty adviser** in yearbook/*Tamarack* material. The 1970 *Tamarack* says “Juniors on *Tamarack* listen as advisor Mrs. Lynette McGarry explains layout design,” showing her role with the yearbook staff as well as language teaching. The 1976 *Tamarack* refers to her as **“Lynette McGarry — creator of International Week,”** which is a wonderful detail for your reunion slide.

Her obituary strongly emphasizes travel and cultural engagement. It says she visited every continent except Antarctica, had a gift for treating strangers as friends, and remained active in civic, cultural, and social activities. It also says she was remembered by “thousands of students whose lives she enriched.” Guestbook comments specifically remember her as a Spanish teacher at NC in the early 1970s an



1974
Tamarack



RM. 6 5 TH. GRADE — LINWOOD SCHOOL — MARCH, 1969 CHATEAU SPOKANE

Top Row			Middle Row			Bottom Row		
1. Mark Mellgren	2. Clifford Rosset	3. Brad Hallock	4. Mike Oakman	5. Brian McMillan	6. Scott Ooms	7. Bill Worstell	8. Jennifer Williams	9. Debra Capendall
10. Nancy England	11. Mike Sherwood	12. Kevin Uldell	13. Don Miller	14. Terry Rosden	15. Jeff Halstead	16. Lizann Hupp	17. Rene Stolt	18. Holly Brumley
19. Patricia Snyder	20. Cindy Pierson	21. Paul Wagner	22. Jeff Blackwell	23. Bob Bryan	24. Jeff Hall	25. Bill Barker	26. Kathy Murphy	

Fifth Grade 1969

~11 years old 🇺🇸 Education & Military Career

•**Academic Background:** He grew up in Washington, graduating from Coulee Dam High School. He later attended Washington State College (now WSU) where he was a member of the Theta Chi fraternity, before ultimately earning both his Bachelor's and Master's Degrees from Gonzaga University in Spokane. [1]

•**Spokane Educator:** He was a proud, long-term educator for Spokane School District 81. He taught regional youth—including your 1969 5th-grade class at Linwood Elementary—for many years before officially retiring from the school district in 1984. [1]

•**Military Service:** Much like your 6th-grade teacher Mr. DeMartino, Mr. Sherwood spent a parallel lifetime devoted to military service. He served in the U.S. Army and honorably retired at the rank of **Lieutenant Colonel Sherwood**. [1]

🚗 Personal Life & Passions

•**Interests:** Outside of the classroom and the military, he was a classic car enthusiast, an avid hunter, and a fisherman. His family noted that his absolute happiest moments were spent boating and relaxing with family at the lake. [1]

•**Family:** At the time of his passing, he was survived by Jean, his wife and best friend of 61 years, alongside his three children (Stewart, Robin, and Anne) and his grandson, Luke. [1]



Brian McMillan



Scott Ooms



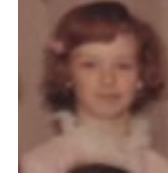
Bill Worstell



Nancy England



Patricia Snyder



Rene Stolt



Jeff Hall



Jeff Blackwell



Bob Bryan



Mark Mellgren



Paul Wagner

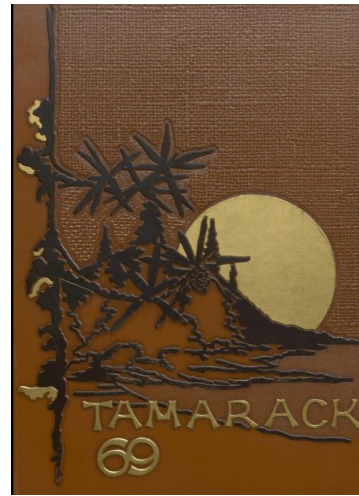


Jeff Halstead



SPL Yearbooks North Central 1969

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1974/page/n47/mode/2up>





Sixth Grade
1970
~12 years old

 Brian McMillan	 Bill Worstell	 Paul Wagner
 Nancy England	 Patricia Snyder	 Debbie Rawlins
 Jeff Hall	 Steve Dunn	 Bryan McKeehan
 Tammy Leone	 Susie Fiksdahl	 Karen Snell

My Classmates		
Top	Middle	Bottom
Brian McMillan	Leslie Shivers	Jeff Hall
Bill Worstell	Tammy Leone	Mike Mayfield
Paul Wagner	Bryan McKeehan	Steve Dunn
Cliff Naset	Steve Smith	Sharon Johnson
Dick Bates	Jim Swain	Susie Fiksdahl
John Price	Dale Post	Gail Green
Nancy England	Jeff Holstead	Karen Snell
Patricia Snyder	Cindy Kilburn	Cathy Ewell
Susan Bryan	Teanette Lee	Kathy Murphy
Debbie Rawlins		
Mr. DeMartino		

The identity of your 6th-grade teacher from Linwood Elementary is **Lieutenant Colonel Joseph Robert DeMartino**. Public historical records from Spokane and military archives confirm his distinguished service as a **World War II veteran, Air Force officer, and former prisoner of war**. [1, 2]

The following verified biographical details and public record sources can be used for your class slide:

 **Military Service & POW History**

- World War II Captivity:** As a young serviceman during WWII, he was captured and held as a prisoner of war. Records show he survived the brutal captivity before being liberated and returning to the United States.
- Air Force Career:** He continued his dedication to the military long after the war, eventually rising to the rank of **Lieutenant Colonel** in the United States Air Force. [1]
- Spokane Officer Base:** Military society listings, including a 1955 directory preserved from the Spokane Chronicle on MyHeritage, place Major Joseph R. DeMartino active among regional Air Force officer circles while stationed in the area. [1]

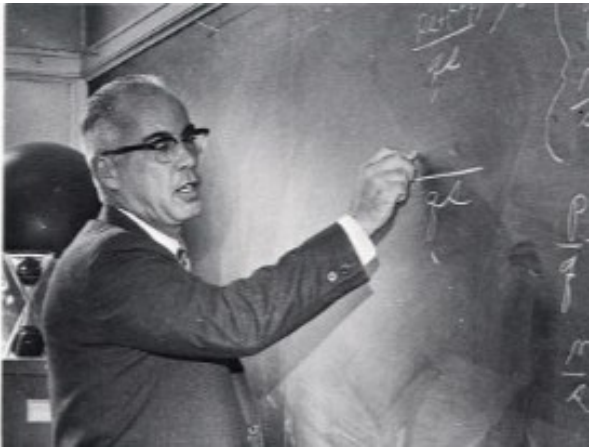
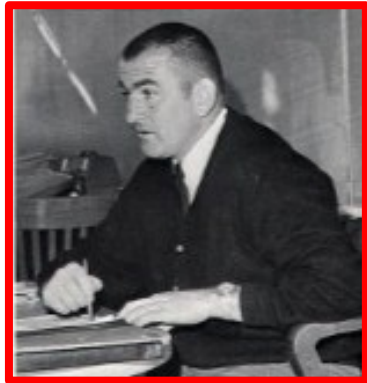
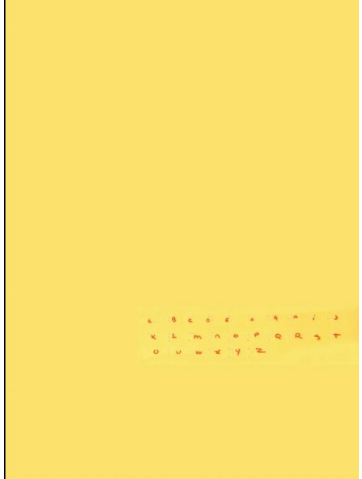
 **Obituary & Burial Records**

- Spokane Passing:** Lt. Col. DeMartino passed away at the age of 62 on January 11, 1984, in Spokane, Washington.
- Obituary Citation:** His original death notice and funeral announcements were published in the local newspaper on January 12–13, 1984. You can view indexed registry listings for his service via the [Joseph Robert DeMartino Profile on MyHeritage](#), which details his memorial service held at St. David's Episcopal Church on North Wall Street in Spokane. [1]

It's 1970, and can you
Guess the four new
additions to the team?

SPL Yearbooks North Central 1970

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1970/mode/2up>



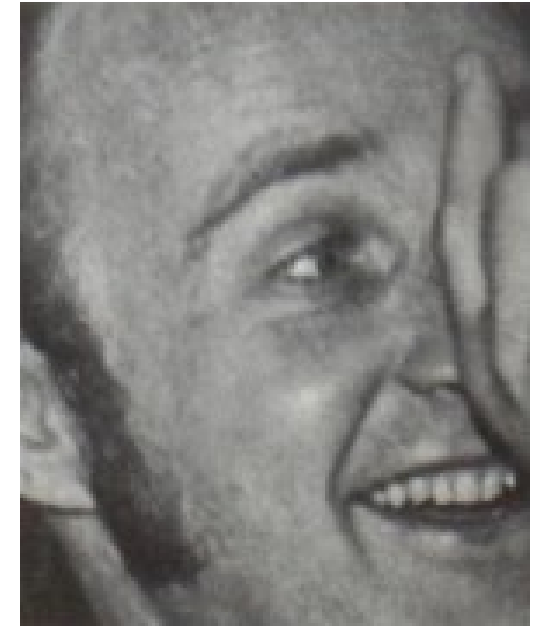
1970 Tamarack Age 26



1971 Tamarack Age 27



1972 Tamarack Age 28



1973 Tamarack



Age 29

1974 Tamarack



Age 30

1975 Tamarack Age 31



1976 Tamarack Age 32



Who served in the Washington State Legislature as first a State Representative from 1979 to 1982 and later as a State Senator from 1983 to 1990?

**1970
Tamarack**

Age 26



1976 Tamarack Age 32



Gerard "Jerry" Eamon de Valera Hughes passed away in Santa Rosa, California, on August 9, 2022, at the age of 78. He was an elected member of the Washington State Legislature representing Spokane before retiring to raise his children and later became a beloved public high school teacher.

Life & Career Timeline:

- **Early Life:** Born in New York on February 16, 1944, to Irish immigrant parents, Jerry grew up in Rockaway Beach and later relocated with his family to San Francisco, where he excelled at baseball at St. Ignatius High School.
 - **Education & Inspiration:** He attended Gonzaga University in Spokane, where a speech by President Kennedy inspired him to pursue public service.
 - **Political Career:** He entered the Washington State Legislature and served two terms representing Spokane.
 - **Teaching & Legacy:** After stepping away from state politics, he went on to teach history and become a beloved public high school educator (such as at North Central High School) before moving back to California in his later years.
- You can read more about his life and leave messages for the family on his official [Legacy.com Obituary Page](https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/sfgate/name/gerard-hughes-obituary?id=36249010) or view the registry of condolences on the [Spokesman-Review Obituary Page](#).

<https://www.legacy.com/us/obituaries/sfgate/name/gerard-hughes-obituary?id=36249010>

Jerry Hughes served in the Washington State Legislature as a State Representative from 1979 to 1982 and later as a State Senator from 1983 to 1990. Prior to his political career, he taught history at North Central High School in Spokane, Washington.

Biographical Details

- **Early Career & Teaching:** Before entering state politics, Jerry Hughes worked as a public high school history teacher at North Central High School in Spokane, WA.
- **Political Run:** Although he made an unsuccessful run for State Representative in 1976, he successfully ran for the State House representing Spokane in 1978.
- **Legislative Service:** He served in the Washington House of Representatives before moving to the Washington State Senate, serving from 1983 through 1990.
- **Later Life:** After stepping down from the legislature, Hughes went on to teach political science at Gonzaga University in Spokane.

Because he served in office decades ago and is a private citizen, comprehensive biographical archives or an obituary for him are not widely published online. To track down further specific details or verify public records, you can review his legislative profile via the Washington State Legislature or research past Spokane news archives.

Who served in the Washington State Legislature as first a State Representative from 1979 to 1982 and later as a State Senator from 1983 to 1990?



16. HIGH SCHOOL BOWL: John Robertson, Bill Worstell, Bob Lenius, Marco Barbanli, Mark Robertson, Doug Buckley, Jerry Hughes, Coach.

Mr. Hughes Anecdotes

Who manfully shouldered responsibility and demonstrated accountability after monitoring a notorious disputed North Central student-body-president election in our very own Class of 1976?

1976: The Bicentennial, Student Autonomy, and Social Shift

The year of your graduation—1976—marked the **U.S. Bicentennial** and arrived on the heels of massive social upheavals, including the Vietnam War, the Civil Rights Movement, and Title IX (passed in 1972).

- The Educational Philosophy:** The rigid structures of the 1950s gave way to student-centered learning, elective-heavy curricula, and a massive push for gender equity in sports and academics.

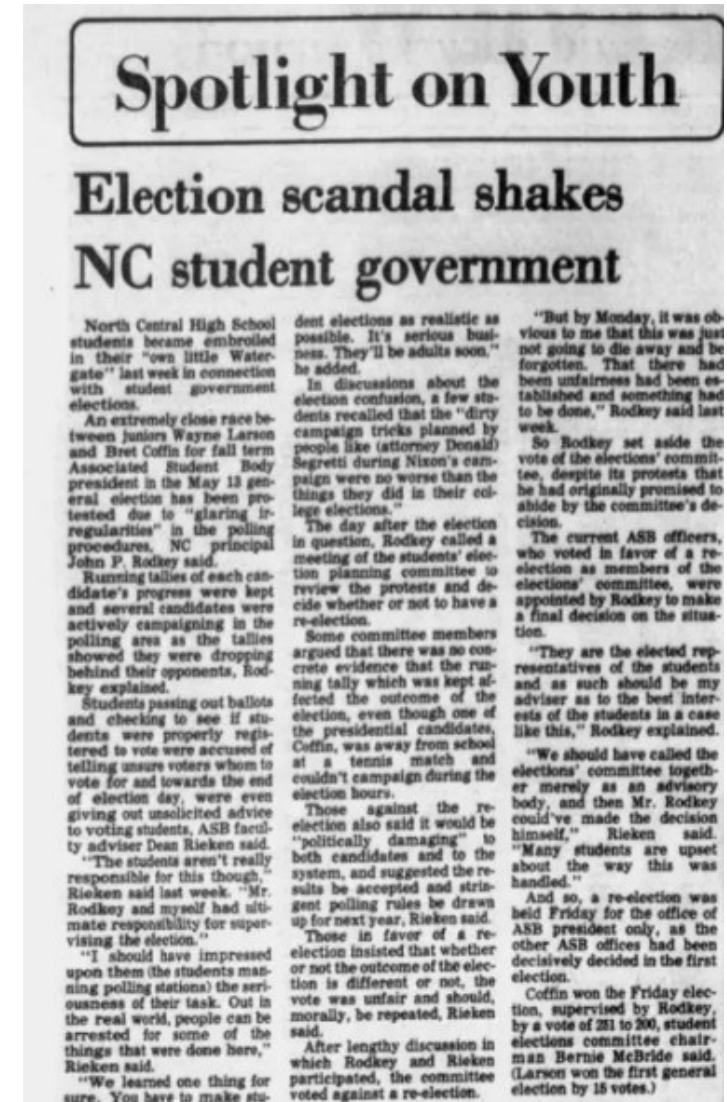
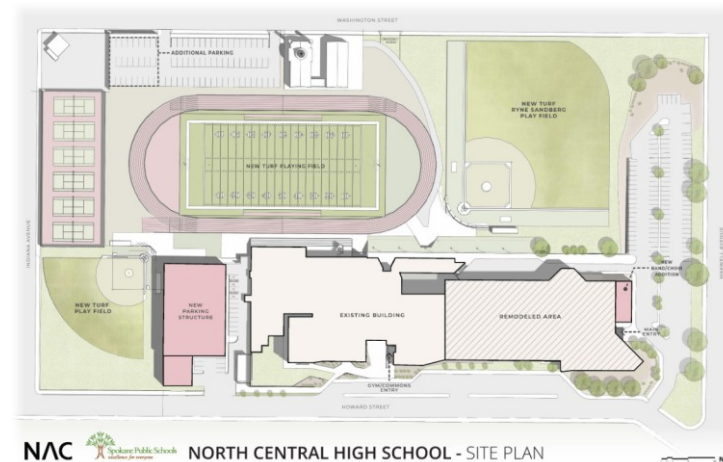
- The Environment:** The atmosphere at NC was alive with the expressive, independent energy of the 1970s. Students exercised a level of political autonomy and social awareness unseen in previous generations—even mirroring real-world complexities, such as the [historic student body election controversy](#) that rocked the school in May 1976 over active campaigning and registry irregularities. This era marked the final years of the fabled original building, which was razed shortly after in 1981 to make way for a more functional, modern facility.



Alice Cooper - "School's Out" (Lyric Video)

Theme song from 1970: “School’s Out”, by Alice Cooper
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rcEbSkaAqkg&list=RDrcEbSkaAqkg&start_radio=1

<https://www.togetherspokane.org/nc-modernization>



<https://www.spokesman.com/stories/2026/may/23/his-day-in-history-north-central-high-school-rock/>

1970 Tamarack Age 30



1971 Tamarack Age 31



1973 Tamarack Age 33
Age 33



1972 Tamarack Age 32



1974 Tamarack Age 34 **1975 Tamarack** Age 35



1976 Tamarack Age 36



Who manfully shouldered responsibility and demonstrated accountability after monitoring a notorious disputed North Central student-body-president election in our very own Class of 1976?

Yes — I found one likely educational-history clue, and it makes your “he looks young in 1970” impression very plausible.

The likely match is **Melvin Dean “Dean” Rieken/Ricken**, born **September 1, 1940**, in Red Oak, Iowa. A genealogy/newspaper-index page gives a 1962 notice saying he had graduated from **Emmett High School in 1958** and was then a **senior at Idaho State College**, majoring in **English education**. It also says he was a member of **Blue Key**, a national honor fraternity, and **Sigma Nu**. The same page has later records under **M. D. Rieken**, so I think this is probably your Dean Rieken, though the page uses the spelling “Ricken” in places. ([Miller Family Genes](#))

That gives a very reasonable age estimate:

If born September 1940, Dean Rieken would have been 29 during most of the 1969–70 school year, turning 30 in September 1970.

He would have been about **34–35** during the 1975–76 school year.

That fits the attached 1970 image very well. It also fits a path like:

Emmett High School, 1958 → Idaho State College English Education, likely class of 1962/63 → teaching career by the late 1960s → North Central English / Senior Composition / ASB adviser by the 1970s.

The public North Central trail is consistent: the 1970 *Tamarack* indexes **Dean Rieken** on several pages, and the 1975 *Tamarack* indexes **Rieken, Dean** on pages 34 and 92. ([Internet Archive](#)) Later public payroll records list **M. Dean Rieken** as a Spokane teacher from **1999 through 2002**, which suggests a long Spokane Public Schools career. ([OpenPayrolls](#))

For your slide or notes, I’d phrase it cautiously:

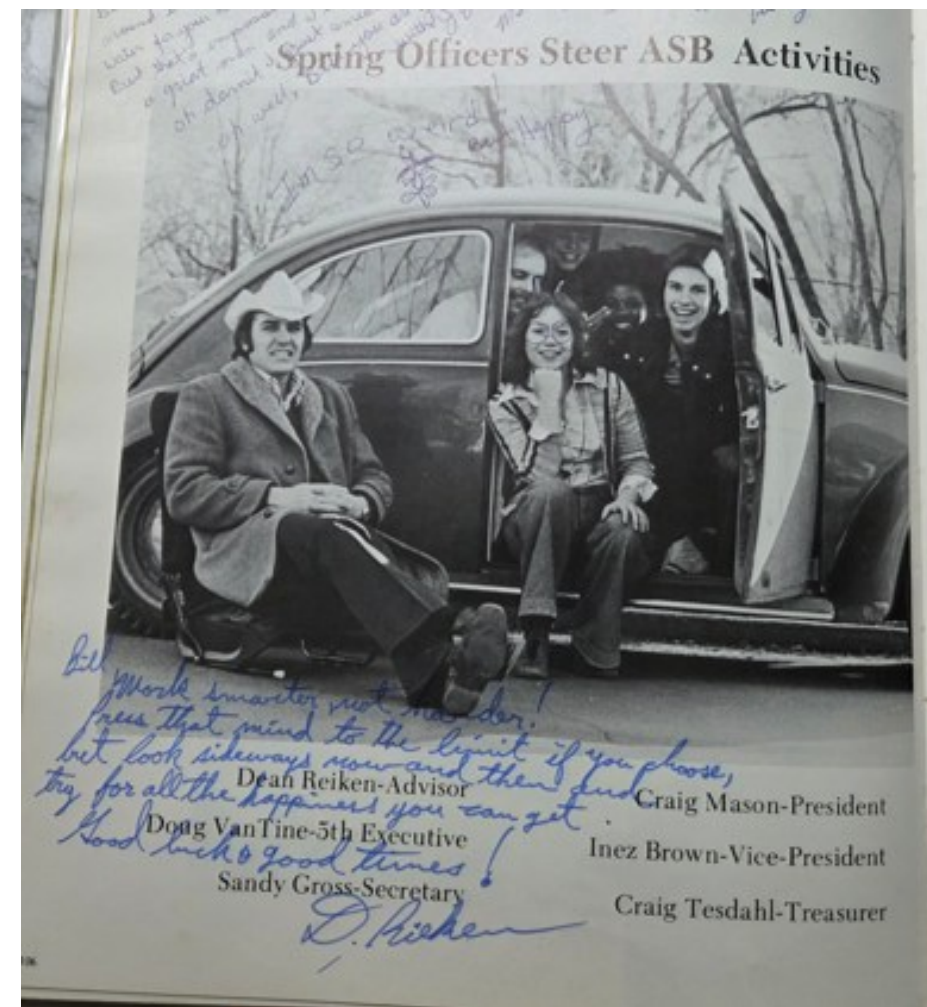
Dean Rieken — English / Senior Composition

Likely Melvin Dean Rieken, born 1940; Emmett High School graduate, 1958; Idaho State College English Education major, early 1960s. If this identification is correct, he was only about 29–30 in the 1970 *Tamarack* photo and about 35 during Bill’s senior year. He appears in North Central *Tamarack* records by 1970 and later served as English teacher, Senior Composition teacher, and ASB faculty adviser.

I would mark the birthdate/college detail as **probable but not fully school-confirmed** until verified from an Idaho State yearbook, alumni record, or Spokane Public Schools personnel source.

Theme song from 1970: “School’s Out”, by Alice Cooper

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rcEbSkaAqkg&list=RDrcEbSkaAqkg&start_radio=1



Bill, Work smarter not harder! Press that mind to the limit if you choose, but look sideways now and then and try for all the happiness you can get. Good luck & good times! D. Rieken

It's Mr. Rieken!

Who manfully shouldered responsibility and demonstrated accountability after monitoring a notorious disputed North Central student-body-president election in our very own Class of 1976?

The name appears to be **M. Dean Rieken**, usually shown in school contexts simply as **Dean Rieken**. I found **good public documentation of his North Central role**, but **no confirmed obituary or death record**. Your earlier research notes say public records show **M. Dean Rieken** still working as a Spokane teacher through at least **2002**, and explicitly note that no official obituary or conclusive online death record had been found.

The North Central yearbook trail places him there before your senior year. The **1970 *Tamarack*** OCR lists **Dean Rieken** in the faculty material near Lynette McGarry and other NC teachers. ([Internet Archive](#)) By **1976**, he was prominent enough in student government to be quoted as **ASB faculty adviser** in a *Spokesman-Review* account of the disputed North Central student-body-president election. The article says the election was invalidated after alleged voting irregularities, and quotes Rieken saying that in the outside world people could be arrested for some of what had happened; he also took some responsibility for not impressing on students the seriousness of the process. ([Spokesman-Review](#)) A public payroll index also lists **M. Dean Rieken** as a **Spokane teacher** from **1999 through 2002**, so his Spokane Public Schools career appears to have continued long after the 1970s. ([OpenPayrolls](#)) I would avoid using private-address/background-check material in a public reunion deck, but the name and age clues suggest this may be **Melvin Dean Rieken**, born around **1940**; I would treat that as tentative unless confirmed from a school, alumni, or obituary source.

A careful slide-ready caption:

<https://www.classmates.com/siteui/yearbooks/4182717980>

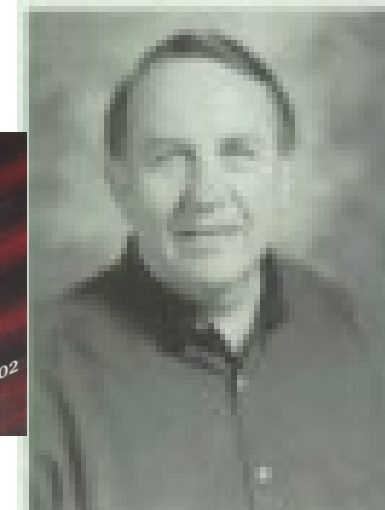
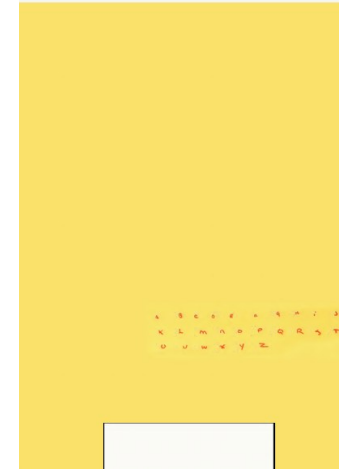
Dean Rieken — English / Senior Composition / ASB Adviser

North Central High School English teacher, documented in the *Tamarack* record by 1970 and remembered by 1976 students for Senior Composition. In May 1976, he was quoted in *The Spokesman-Review* as the ASB faculty adviser during a disputed student-body election, a small but vivid glimpse of his role in NC civic life. Public payroll records suggest M. Dean Rieken continued as a Spokane teacher through at least 2002. No confirmed obituary has been found, so birth and death dates should be left blank unless verified from school archives or family sources.

Short version for the presentation:

Dean Rieken — English & Senior Composition

NC English teacher and ASB faculty adviser, documented in the 1970s *Tamarack* record and still listed as a Spokane teacher decades later. A confirmed obituary has not yet been found.



Dean Rieken, Language Arts



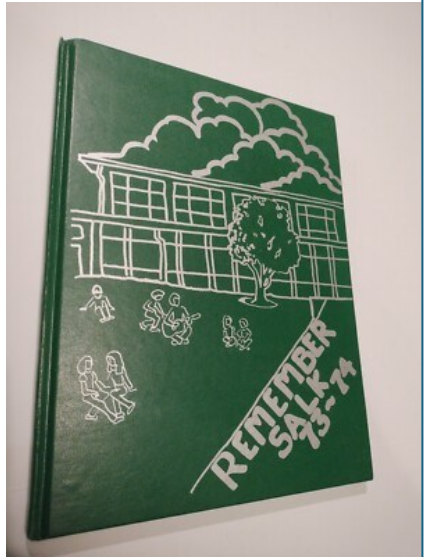
Kim Rieken, Social Studies

In the outside world people could be arrested for some of what had happened...
We've come a long way from the student courts of the early 1950s in a quarter century...

Who manfully shouldered responsibility and demonstrated accountability after monitoring a notorious disputed North Central student-body-president election in our very own Class of 1976?

Mr. Rieken Anecdotes

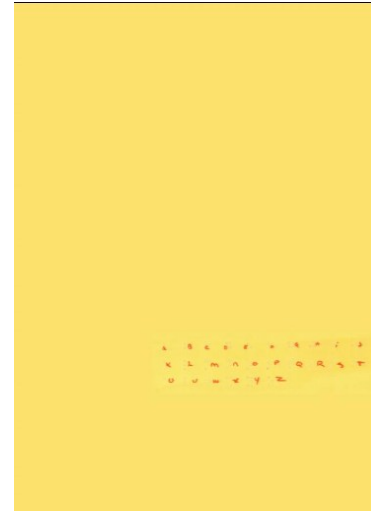
Who went on later to be a principal at Salk Middle School?



I attended Salk for 7th-9th grades from 1970-1973

The Math Department there was great, among other things. I broke my left arm (Ulna) there twice – first time on the playfield in a lunchtime mob playing “Smear the Queer”. Second time I was receiving an illegal body slam on the mats in Wrestling practice. We just kept going. I had a paper route back then – next to Jim Stratton’s one – and I could take it.

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1970>



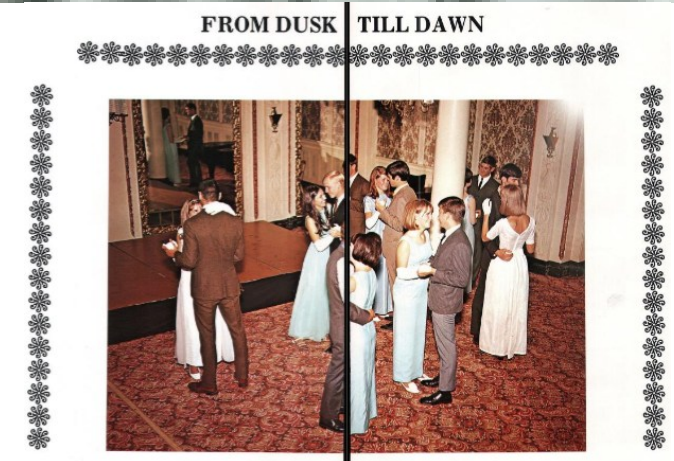
Carpenters "We've Only Just Begun" on The Ed Sullivan Show

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9hJCr9cq5co&list=RD9hJCr9cq5co&start_radio=1

Theme song from 1970: “We’ve Only Just Begun”, by the Carpenters



Supplying music for a dance and mixer is our own band, The General Delivery, consisting of guitarist Richard Coleman and Paul Barclay and drummer Mark Seibert.



1970 Tamarack Age>22



1971 Tamarack Age>23



1972 Tamarack Age>24



1973 Tamarack Age>25



1974 Tamarack Age>26



1975 Tamarack Age>27



1976 Tamarack



Who went
on later to
be a
principal
at Salk
Middle
School?

Who went on later to be a principal at Salk Middle School?



Dear Bill,
What an exciting four years you have ahead
and what promise for a fine future. Live them
to the fullest – drain the cup. It was a pleasure
to have you in Senior Lit.- thank you for your
many contributions.
Peace + love, Mrs. H.

Mary Haugen was an English/theater teacher at **North Central High School** in the mid-1970s. She began at NC as an English and drama teacher in **1975/1976**, later moved into administration, served as principal of **Salk Middle School**, received the **Washington Award for Excellence in Education**, and retired in 2000.

The Salk record is strong. A 2000 *Spokesman-Review* article says Pam Scott took over for **Salk Principal Mary Haugen**, who had “retired last year after **13 years at the helm**” of the North Side middle school. That places Haugen as Salk principal roughly **1986/1987–1999**.

Her recognition is also documented. In 1999, the state superintendent’s office recognized **Salk Middle School principal Mary Haugen** in the **Washington Award for Excellence in Education**, and she was the **only nominee from Spokane School District 81**. <https://www.spokesman.com/stories/1999/may/06/finch-plans-dance-performance/>

Several *Spokesman-Review* articles show the character of her Salk leadership. In 1996, after the Moses Lake school shootings, Haugen and Assistant Principal Les Johnson visited every class to discuss bullying and safety; the article describes Salk as having a well-established program to address teasing, taunting, and fighting. In 1999, she praised Salk’s peer-mediation program, saying students often resolve problems better when peers help them find their own solutions.

Who went on to later be a principal at Salk Middle School?

I would **tighten Mrs. Haugen's NC tenure** this way:

Mary Haugen — English / Drama

Earliest public *Tamarack* evidence I found: **1970**.

Present in NC *Tamarack* indexes through at least **1976**.

Later principal of Salk Middle School, where she served about **13 years**, retiring around **1999/2000**, and was recognized in 1999 in the Washington Award for Excellence in Education program. ([Internet Archive](#))

For **where to find her in the yearbooks**, the searchable yearbook OCR gives these index locations:

I would not say “began career at NC in 1975” anymore. Your own yearbook search has now pushed her back to **1970**, and the Salk-principal material still works as her later career arc. A cleaner version:

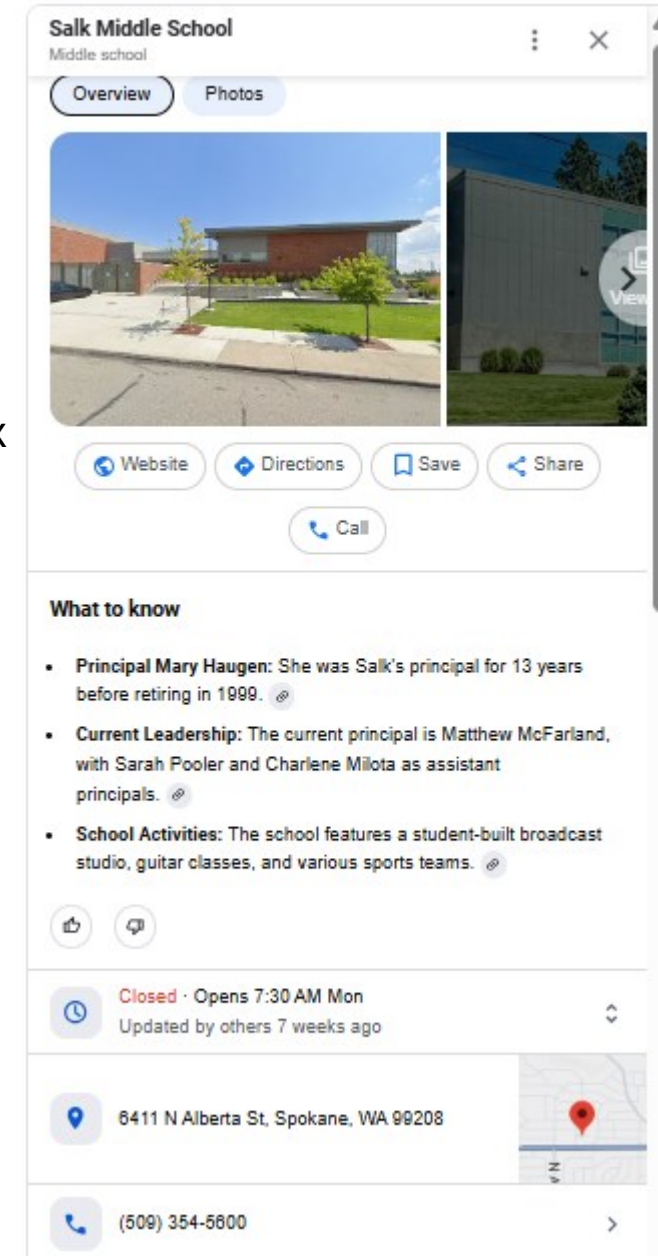
Mary Haugen taught English and drama at North Central by **1970** and remained there through at least **1976**. She later became principal of Salk Middle School, serving roughly 13 years and retiring around 1999/2000. In 1999 she was Spokane School District 81's sole nominee for the Washington Award for Excellence in Education. Her later work at Salk emphasized student safety, peer mediation, and direct attention to student life.

For a **theme song as she joined the NC faculty**, my first choice would be:

“We've Only Just Begun” — The Carpenters, 1970.

That one fits the handwritten message in your slide — “What an exciting four years you have ahead...” — almost perfectly. It was released as a Carpenters single in 1970.

([Wikipedia](#))



Mary Haugen went on to become one of the most prominent female administrators in Spokane Public Schools (District 81), serving for years as the Principal of Salk Middle School. [[1](#), [2](#)]

Tracing her exact academic origin reveals that she is a home-grown product of the regional pipeline, completing her undergraduate education at **Eastern Washington State College (EWSC)** and later obtaining her advanced administrative credentials through **Whitworth College**.

Her Educational Background & Timeline

Using the data points from your spreadsheet—which indicates she started at North Central in **1970** as a young teacher under the age of 25—her trajectory maps tightly to the regional university programs of the late 1960s:

- Undergraduate Degree (EWSC):** Mary Haugen earned her Bachelor of Arts in Education from **Eastern Washington State College** (Cheney) in the **Class of 1968**.

- The Master's and Administrative Track (Whitworth):** While teaching English and Literature at North Central throughout the 1970s, she utilized the prominent local night-school pipeline at **Whitworth College**. She earned her Master’s Degree in Education and her Principal's Credentials there. This allowed her to transition directly from classroom teacher to building administrator.

Her Career Evolution: Returning to Your Old Stomping Grounds

Though you knew her as a high school English teacher at NC, her legacy in District 81 is deeply tied to the very junior high school you attended:

- Salk Middle School Leadership:** By the 1990s, she rose to become the **Principal of Salk Middle School**. [[1](#), [2](#)]

- A Trailblazer in District 81:** During her tenure at Salk in the late 1990s, she was famously noted in local news records as **the only female principal** running an upper-level (middle/high school) building in the entire Spokane Public Schools system. [[1](#), [2](#)]

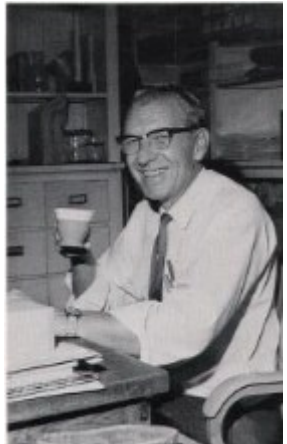
- Her Leadership Style:** Local newspaper archives from *The Spokesman-Review* highlight her as a deeply compassionate but firm administrator. She gained recognition for implementing "looping" programs to keep struggling students with the same teachers to prevent them from failing, and navigated high-profile standardized testing overhauls with immense grace. [[1](#), [2](#)]

Where Was She Originally From?

Mary Haugen was an Inland Northwest native, originally hailing from the **Spokane/Inland Empire region** itself. Unlike many teachers who were recruited from the Midwest or coastal Washington during the post-war population boom, she grew up locally, attended local schools, and dedicated her entire 30+ year professional career exclusively to educating North Spokane families across North Central and Salk.

SPL Yearbooks North Central 1971

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1971/mode/2up>

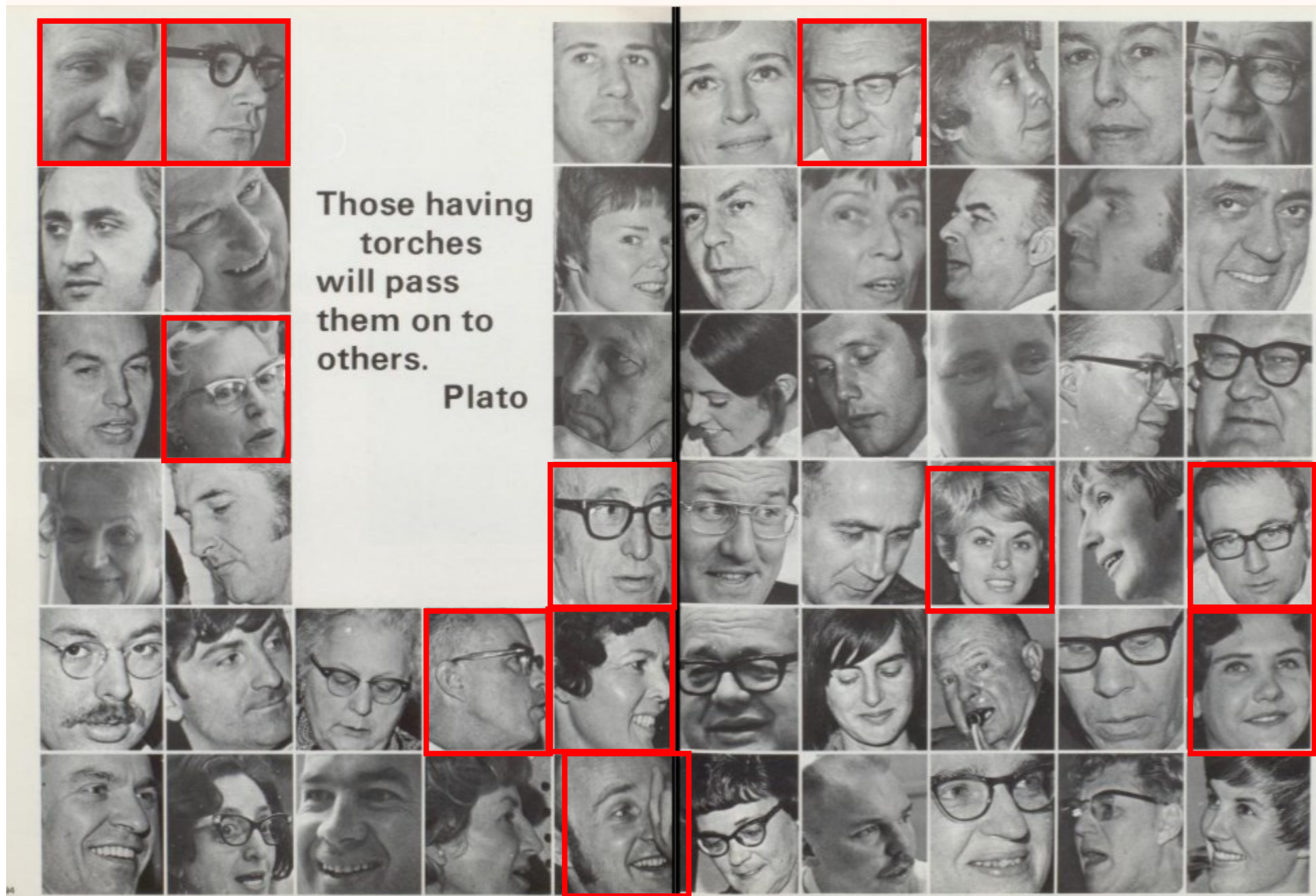




SPL Yearbooks North Central 1972

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1972/mode/2up>





Those having
torches
will pass
them on to
others.
Plato



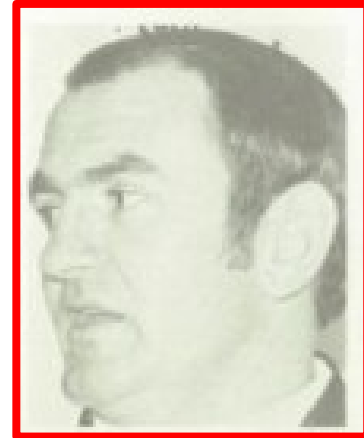
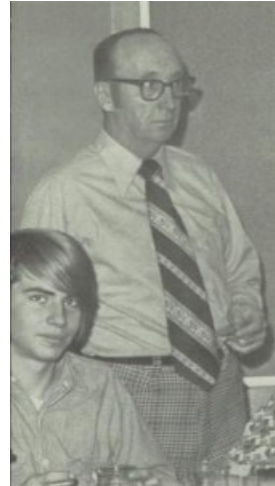
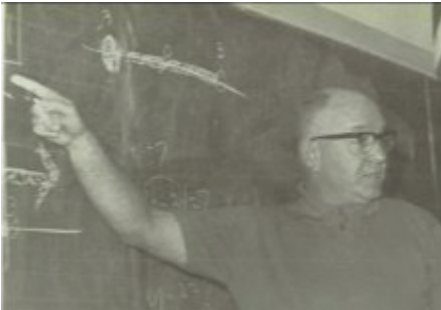
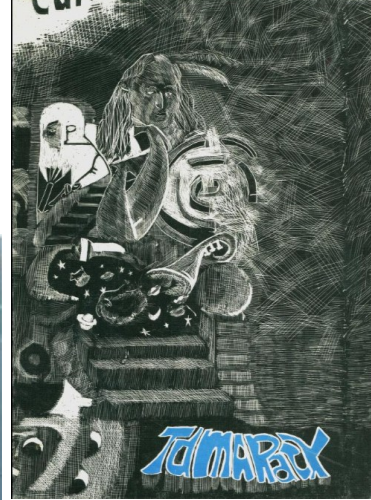
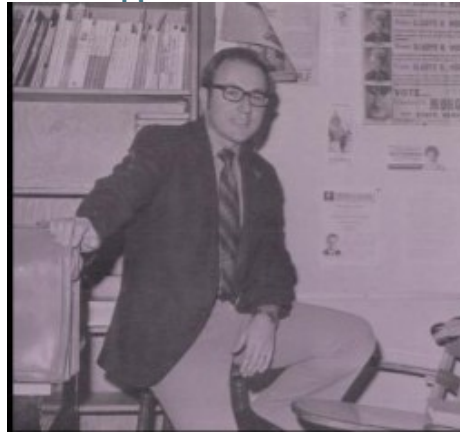
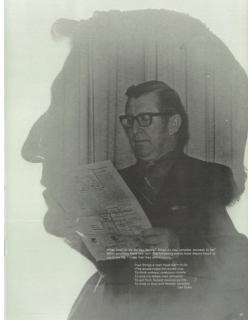
<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1972/mode/2up>

**Can you find familiar
faces in the crowd?
Any I missed?**

Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?

SPL Yearbooks North Central 1973

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1973/page/n105/mode/2u>



Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?



Black Sabbath - Iron Man

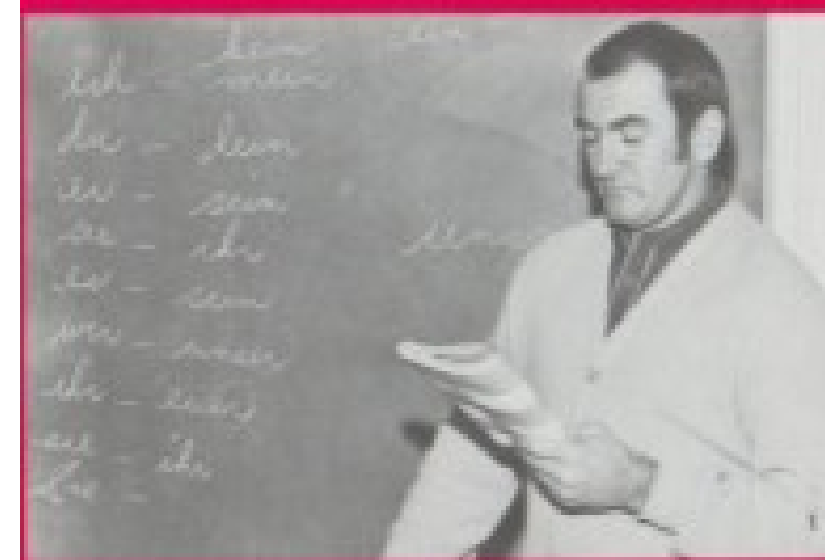
Theme song: “Iron Man” by Black Sabbath

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fKbvkUtvFzk&list=RDfKbvkUtvFzk&start_radio=1



Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?

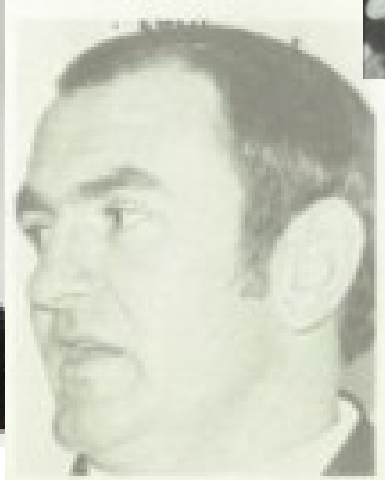
1974 Tamarack



1976 Tamarack



**1973
Tamarack**



1975 Tamarack



Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?

Michael WEIR Obituary

Michael (Mike) Weir was born February 20, 1939, to Ralph and Mary Weir in [Spokane, WA](#), and passed away on February 9, 2023, at the age of 83 from complications of surgery/septic shock. He was raised in Spokane and graduated from North Central High School in 1957. After high school, he served in the Army playing football and was stationed in Germany. Upon returning home to Spokane, he was a heavy machine operator on construction projects. He later went to college on the GI Bill and got his teaching degree from Eastern Washington University and his master's degree from Whitworth University. He had a long career teaching German and English at North Central High School as well as coaching many kids in football, wrestling, and softball. He had a positive influence on so many high schoolers who would stop him as adults and share the impact he made on them. He spent his summers off from teaching by working at Murphy Brothers and Inland Asphalt and was excellent and skilled at operating heavy machinery for road construction projects. In addition to these jobs, he was also an administrator for night school for continuing education for adults. He retired from teaching in 1997.

He married Sharon (Holt) in 1965 and they celebrated 57 years of marriage before her death last March. They had two daughters, Teri and Molly. Mike was a hardworking family man who enjoyed many hobbies and pursuits. He loved restoring classic cars into beautiful showpieces. Through the years he enjoyed snow skiing, hunting, racquetball, golf, working out, watching all the sports, and keeping his yard and cars immaculate. After retirement, he became a master woodworker and built many beautiful things that we will always treasure. It felt like there wasn't anything he couldn't do or fix or build.

It was so fun to see Mike as a Papa and he had a very special relationship with each of his grandchildren. He could be seen at many a dance recital, baseball game, cheer competition, school program, Hoopfest, football game, and all the other things his grandkids were involved in. So many of his grandkids' friends also called him Papa, and he was the fun grandpa who would bring treats and support all the kids. Mike truly had a heart of service and would do anything for his family and friends. He was constantly helping others with home, yard, and car repairs, driving friends to the airport, shoveling driveways for neighbors, and just being available for anyone who needed help. He was the hardest-working man we knew. He was gracious and appreciative and the kind of man that had so many friends that you couldn't go anywhere without him running into people he knew. He loved the Lord and was a lifelong Christian who attended mass regularly and was always interested in others and how he could pray for them.

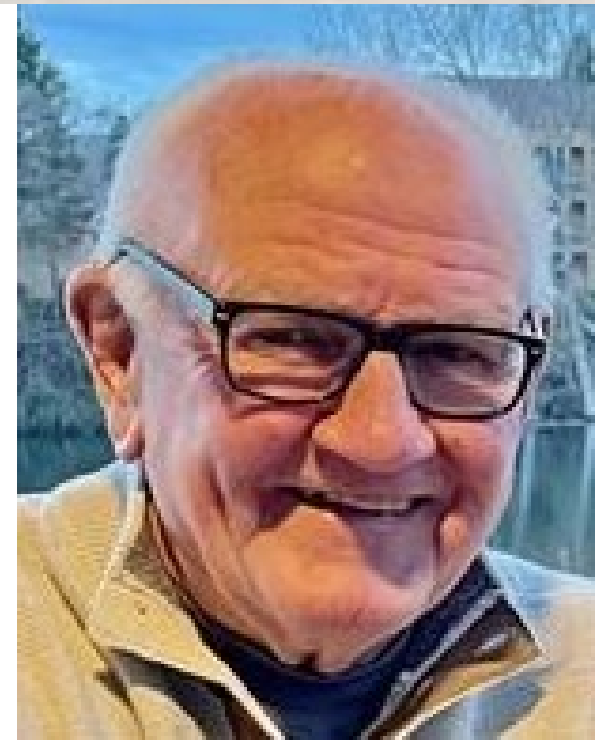
Mike is survived by his two daughters and their families who adored him: Teri (Fulton) and husband Bob and their kids Courtney and Blake; and Molly (Bergan) and her husband Jason and their kids Abby, Luke, and Lexi. He is also survived by his siblings Mary Ann Scott, Judy Lennemann, and Ralph Weir. He is preceded in death by his wife of 57 years: Sharon Weir. He is also preceded in death by his siblings Joy Ruple and Larry Weir.

Please join us for a Funeral Mass at The Cathedral of Our Lady of Lourdes on Friday, March 3, 2023, at 10 am: 1115 West Riverside, [Spokane, WA](#), 99201. There will be a celebration of life reception at the church afterward. Please consider making a donation to Joya Child & Family Development, 1016 N Superior St, [Spokane, WA](#) 99202, in Mike's name for his granddaughter Lexi Bergan. Mike's online memorial page can be found at www.holycrossofspokane.org.

To plant trees in memory, please visit the [Sympathy Store](#).

Published by Spokesman-Review from Feb. 16 to Mar. 15, 2023.

Age 37 in 1976 (NC Class of 1957)



Grandpa Coach Weir

Who was a heavy machine operator on construction sites, before teaching at NC and during summers while he was teaching at NC?

Coach Weir Anecdotes

SPL Yearbooks North Central 1974



Who met his future wife in the All-City Band?



Theme song: "Old Days" by Chicago

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fKbvkUtvFzk&list=RDfKbvkUtvFzk&start_radio=1



Who met his future wife in the All-City Band?

A 2023 *Spokesman-Review* feature identifies **John Luppert** and **Nan Comeaux Luppert** as former Sacajawea Middle School music students from the school's first year, 1960. John said he originally attended Irving Elementary but wanted to attend Sacajawea because choir teacher Richard "Dick" Skok was becoming band director there. He and Nan met in the All-City band clarinet section, later attended Lewis and Clark High School, and married in 1968. ([Spokesman-Review](#))

The same article says both John and Nan graduated from **Eastern Washington University** with education degrees. Nan used music in teaching Spanish, French, and English for 17 years. John **taught band and orchestra for 11 years** before moving into another career, but he remained active musically as an early member of the **Spokane Jazz Society**, now the Spokane Jazz Orchestra, for about **25 years**. ([Spokesman-Review](#))

The North Central yearbook trail supports his NC role. The 1975 *Tamarack* OCR includes **John Luppert**, matching your attached 1975 image, and the 1976 *Tamarack* OCR includes **"Band Photos — John Luppert"** in the music/yearbook context. ([Internet Archive](#))

A slide-ready caption:

John Luppert — Band & Orchestra

North Central High School band/orchestra teacher in the mid-1970s. A Spokane music student himself, he attended Sacajawea Middle School in its first year, met his future wife Nan Comeaux in the All-City band clarinet section, and later earned an education degree from Eastern Washington University. He taught band and orchestra for 11 years, including at North Central, then moved into another career while remaining active in Spokane music as an early Spokane Jazz Society / Spokane Jazz Orchestra member for about 25 years.

Short version:

John Luppert — Instrumental Music

NC band/orchestra teacher, Eastern Washington University education graduate, Sacajawea music alumnus, and longtime Spokane Jazz Society / Spokane Jazz Orchestra musician.

Theme song: "Old Days" by Chicago
Recorded in 1975.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pmz6BqBsk9w&list=RDPmz6BqBsk9w&start_radio=1
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pmz6BqBsk9w&list=RDPmz6BqBsk9w&start_radio=1

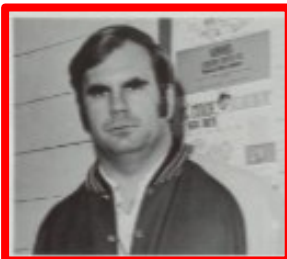


Band, Stage Band, and Luppert Autograph

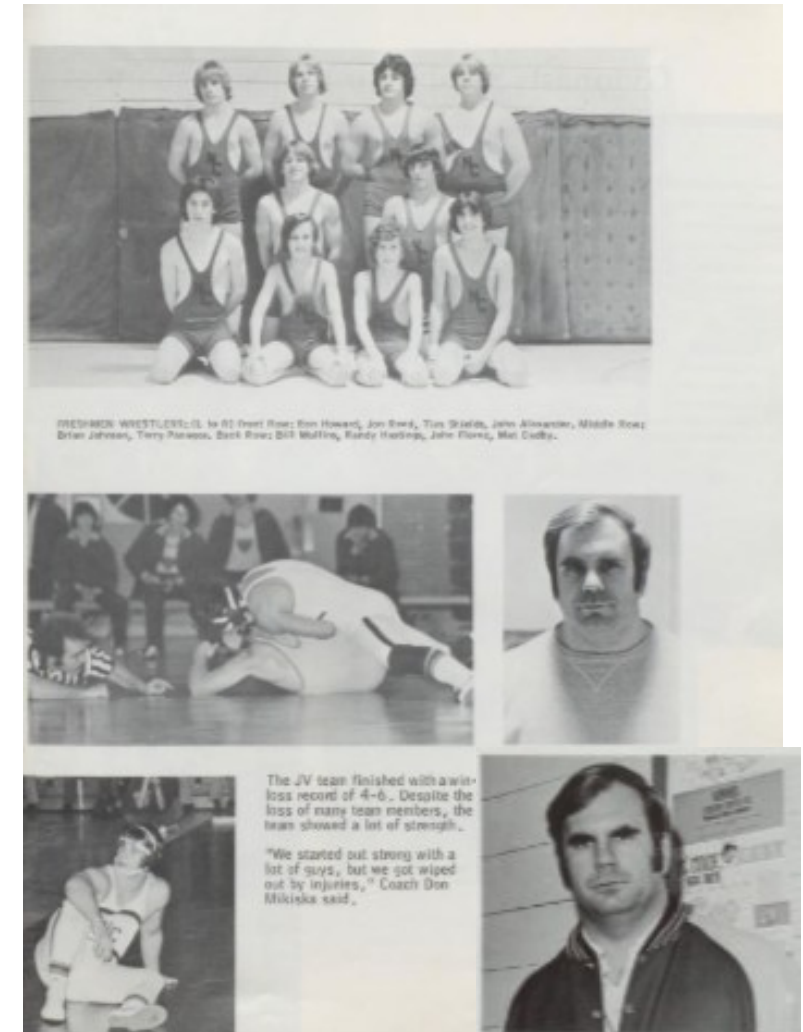
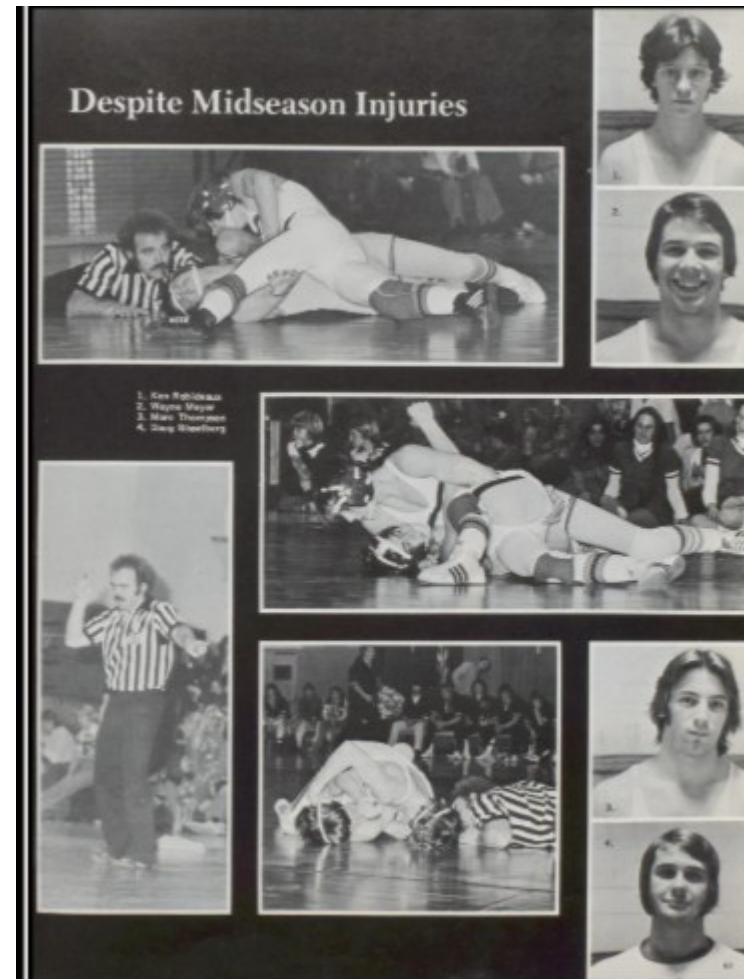
Who coached wrestling at
Othello and Ferris as well as
NC, and coached AA Othello to
a state championship?

SPL Yearbooks North Central 1975

<https://archive.org/details/SPLYearbooksNorthCentral1975/mode/2up>



Who coached wrestling at Othello and Ferris as well as NC, and coached AA Othello to a state championship?



I remember pressing on and being pressed from below by JV wrestlers looking to take my weight class

Theme song: "Pick up the Pieces" by The Average White Band

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xpflST8xWm8&list=RDxpflST8xWm8&start_radio=1

Who coached wrestling at Othello and Ferris as well as NC, and coached AA Othello to a state championship?

Deceased Classmate: Mikiska, Don (Teacher)

Date Of Birth:

Date Deceased: 5-2004

Age at Death: 59

Cause of Death:

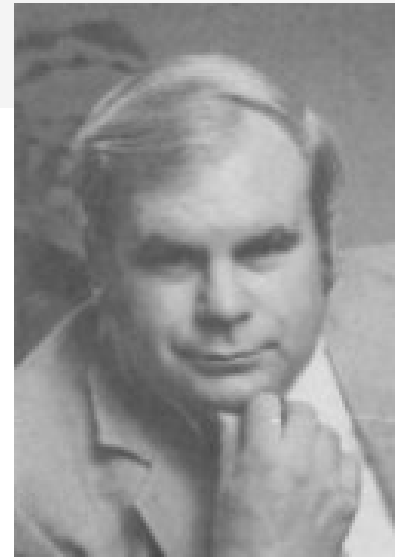
Classmate City: Spokane

Classmate State: WA

Classmate Country: USA

Was a Veteran: No

https://www.classcreator.com/Spokane-Washington-Joel-E-Ferris-1963-2016/class_profile.cfm?member_id=5002215&utm_source=chatgpt.com



Joel E Ferris High School Classes of 1966 - Present

Ferris is using “classcreator” software www.classcreator.com



24,357 Classes now online!

Featured Class Sites

Coach Mikiska's first year at NC was 1975

Survived By: His wife died in 2001. Survivors include two sons, Bob and Mike Mikiska; his companion, Marcia, and her two daughters, Jenny and Laura; and four grandchildren.

Donald V.E. Mikiska, 59, who was born in San Jose, Calif., died Tuesday. He graduated from Whitworth College in 1967 with a degree in social studies and received his Master of Arts degree in teaching the following year. Mr. Mikiska taught in Washington for 31 years, the last 26 in Spokane, mostly at Ferris High School. While the wrestling coach in Othello, Wash., he was named Washington's Coach of the Year for AA schools in 1970. He led the school to a state championship in 1974. He married Christine Castle in 1975, and the couple made their home in Spokane. Mr. Mikiska enjoyed the outdoors, hunting and fishing and was involved at Fourth Memorial Bible Church. Published on 5/17/2004